Chapter 1: Introduction

The System

This system is based on the world of the xianxia novel Reverend Insanity (aka Master of Gu) by Gu Zhen Ren. In short, it is a high-magic system where most characters and all players are spellcasters called Gu Masters. Spells are contained within creatures called Gu, which can be stored inside a Gu Master's body. Each Gu has a specific function, and the way your character will play is going to constantly change as your personal collection of Gu changes. If you specialize in fire path and later decide you'd rather beat your enemies to death with strength path, you can sell your Gu and buy, find, or create new ones to fulfill that purpose, or dual cultivate the paths for a unique playstyle.

The Aperture

The aperture is a sort of extra-dimensional space located in a Gu Master's stomach. Around the age of puberty, people can awaken their aperture by coming into contact with Hope Gu. Not everyone is lucky enough to be able to awaken their aperture, but those that do are henceforth called Gu Masters. People without an awakened aperture are called mortals, and are just regular people.

The aperture is a simple sphere bounded by walls and filled with a sea of primeval essence, a resource used to activate Gu as well as to cultivate. Cultivation consists of attacking your aperture walls with this primeval essence, eventually breaking them and moving on to a new realm. Gu Masters begin at rank 1 and can cultivate to rank 5. Each rank is considered a large realm, and are subdivided into 4 small realms: initial stage, middle stage, upper stage, and peak stage. After rank 5, there are still ranks 6 through 9, but that is the realm of Gu Immortals and the rules change massively. In this system, the maximum rank attainable is rank 5 peak stage.

You can store Gu in your aperture no matter their size, and there is no limit to the number of Gu that can be stored in your aperture. The aperture is accessible to its owner at any time through their thoughts, but other creatures can only access someone else's aperture after they are dead or through the use of special Gu.

Primeval Essence

Primeval essence is the main resource used by Gu masters to activate and refine Gu as well as cultivate to increase their strength. The representation of primeval essence you see here is an approximation, as the resource quickly becomes quite complex when factoring in the rank and realm of the user alongside the rank of the Gu.

A Gu Master's aperture has a maximum amount of primeval essence, determined by their aptitude. At the initial stage of each rank, a Gu Master has a number of portions of primeval essence equal to their aptitude. A Gu Master at rank 2 initial stage with a 30% aptitude (D-Grade) has a maximum of 30 portions of primeval essence.

When out of combat, the recovery rate is 10% of the Gu Master's maximum primeval essence every hour. Each small realm above initial stage doubles the maximum number of portions available.

At higher ranks, your primeval essence is significantly more potent than even peak stage of the rank below you. For simplicity, activating any Gu of a rank below your own costs a single portion of primeval essence.

As a bonus action, you may leak the aura of your primeval essence. Any creature within 10 meters of you can sense this aura and immediately identify the rank and stage of your primeval essence.

Primeval Stones

Small, smooth stones naturally formed from primeval essence, primeval stones are the main currency in the Gu world. On your turn, you can absorb the essence of a number of primeval stones equal to the number of hands you have as a **Combat Action** . You must have one hand free for each stone being absorbed.

For each primeval stone being absorbed, you gain {5, 4, 3, 2, 1}[1] portion(s) of primeval essence, and the stone is destroyed in the process, crumbling into dust.

You can carry up to 250 primeval stones on your person, but many storage type Gu exist to hold additional stones.

[1] *When you see curly brace notation, it represents your rank, or the rank of the Gu if it appears in a Gu's description. In this case, it means expending a primeval stone restores 5 primeval essence if you are rank 1, 4 if you are rank 2, and so on.*

Refinement

Gu can be created out of materials and other Gu in a process called refinement. See the *Gu* chapter for more details.

The World

The Gu world is a massive, flat disc, consisting of 5 regions. The source material is pretty inconsistent with size, but it is safe to say each region is at least 6 or 7 times the surface area of the Earth. The 5 regions are as follows:

- Northern Plains: Flat grassland dotted with nomadic tribes of various sizes. Conflict is commonplace and the Gu Masters here are the most adept at fighting.
- Western Desert: A dry wasteland with cities gathered around its oases. Lone cultivators are very uncommon.
- Southern Border: An uneven, mountainous region with familial clans settling on mountainsides. The setting of this system.
- Eastern Sea: Vast ocean dotted with archipelagos. Conflict is less common due to difficulty in reaching other settlements, allowing its inhabitants to focus on cultivation and gaining wealth. Many lone cultivators.
- Central Continent: The most powerful of the five regions and home to the Heavenly Court. Has a mix of the other four regions' geography (i.e. a normal continent).

Since the world is a disc, Southern Border does not border Northern Plains, but it does border the other regions. The same goes for the other outer regions, with only Central Continent connecting to all of them.

Mortals

People without an awakened aperture cannot use Gu. Their status is very low, and in most places a Gu Master can outright kill any mortals that disrespect them. Despite that, mortals do a great deal of work to provide food and resources to the clan, and cannot be wantonly murdered without reproach from righteous path forces.

Righteous and Demonic

Gu Masters identify as part of either the demonic path or righteous path. Demonic does not necessarily mean evil, just that the Gu Master does not follow the rigid systems of community. Of course, many demonic path Gu Masters ARE evil and more than willing to hurt the innocent to further their own goals. Similarly, righteous path Gu Masters are not necessarily good, they just follow the rules of society. While many have ideals of justice and virtue, the more powerful righteous path Gu Masters exploit this societal responsibility for their own gain, and are often willing to commit evil deeds to further their goals, just in more subtle ways than the demonic path.

Inheritances

Inheritances are a common aspect of the Gu World's culture; a Gu Master's ideals can live on long after their death by leaving an inheritance of Gu, refinement recipes, and information to be found in the future. Some inheritances are frought with difficulty, fully capable of killing those that seek to claim them. Others are safe but with measures to ensure the inheritor is someone worthy of the prize. Sometimes a Gu Master just leaves some Gu in a cave with food and hopes for the best.

Setting

Given the size of the world and the fact that each region has its own local gu, flora, and fauna, I've chosen to localize this system to the Southern Border. You can certainly design a campaign in one of the other regions using this system as a framework though.

Chapter 5 is dedicated to Southern Border, its clans, and geography. It is heavily recommended for the Game Master to read it.

The Dice Mechanic

Skill Tests

Skill tests are rolled when a character would like to do an action that:

- has a chance of failure
- has a chance of success

The GM should be able to determine if an action is possible for your character to do, as well as if the action should be an automatic success.

Dice

Dice are notated d[sides]; a d4 is a four sided die. The td10 is a 10 sided die where each value is a tens place (10, 20, 30, etc). If instead of the number of dice, the die is annotated with an R (Rd12), then the number of dice is equal to the rank of the Gu. This system uses d4, d6, d8, d10, td10, d12, and d20.

The d100 Skill tests are rolled on a d100; to roll a d100, roll a d10 and a td10. The td10 represents the tens place while the d10 represents the ones place. So if you roll an 80 and a 5, your roll is 85. Rolling a 10 on the d10 is just a zero, so rolling 90 and 10 would just be 90. Finally, rolling 00 on the td10 and a 10 on the d10 is 100.

Penalties and Bonuses

Penalties and bonuses are a number added or subtracted from the number you roll on the die during a skill test. The GM can add either to represent the difficulty of the check, using the table below as a guideline. Penalties and bonuses do not have to be round multiples of 10, but they typically are.

Penalty/Bonus	Difficulty
+120	Impossible (Traveling against the Reverse Flow River)
+100	Unheard of (Refining an Immortal Gu)
+80	Extreme Difficulty (Convincing a Wisdom Path master to change their plans)
+60	Impossible for most without the use of Gu (Convincing a Wisdom Path master to change their plans)
+40	High Difficulty (Convincing a Wisdom Path master to change their plans)
+20	Difficult (Cultivating with minor distractions)
0	Challenging (Cultivating in a secret room)
-20	Slightly Challenging (Refining a common Gu)
-40	Simple (Identifying poisonous plants around your clan's walls)
-60	Trivial (Haggling a merchant to take a few primeval stones off a large price)

Advantage and Disadvantage

If you have advantage on a test, roll an additional td10 and take the lower of the two. You can stack advantages as long as they come from different sources. Disadvantage works the same way, but you take the higher of the td10 rolls.

Help

You can help another creature with a skill test as a combat action. You must be able to explain what action you are taking to help them on the skill test, and if the GM allows it they can give the helped creature up to a -30 bonus on their skill test, depending on the action taken.

Degrees of Success/Failure

A success automatically has 1 degree of success, and a failure has 1 degree of failure. For every 10 you roll below/above your skill value, you gain an additional degree of success/failure, respectively. Some skill tests, such as an opposed Deception/Insight roll, do not take degrees of success into account; they're either deceived or they aren't. Many tests, however, will have different effects based on the degrees of success or failure.

Critical

When you roll at or under 1/10 of your skill's value (rounded down, minimum 1) on the die, you've landed a critical. Criticals are automatic successes, though degrees of success are still calculated like normal with a minimum of 1. Some skills have a critical success effect built into them, though the GM can always add a special additional success to any test you critically succeed.

If you score a critical with an attack roll, the attack deals double the damage it normally would.

Fumble

Fumbles occur when 99-100 is rolled on the die for a skill test. If your skill value is above 99, you only fumble on a roll of 100 for that skill. Fumbles are an automatic failure, though degrees of failure are still calculated like normal with a minimum of 1.

Opposed Tests

When competing with your skills against another creature, the two of you may be called to make an Opposed Test. You both roll a skill test, which can be for the same or different skills, and compare results. Critical successes beat any non-critical roll, and fumbles lose to any non-fumble roll. Then, the player with the most degrees of success or least degrees of failure wins. If they're tied for degrees of success/failure, then the lower number on the die wins. If they're still tied, the Opposed Test ends in a tie if possible. If the Opposed Test can't be tied, then the involved parties make the test again until they do not tie.

Running the Game

"Today I step on grass; later I shall step on mountains and rivers!"

Materials

To run the game, you will need a full set of dice including a d4, d6, d8, d10, td10, d12, and d20. Additionally, each player will need a character sheet and something to write with. This game is intended to be played with miniatures on a grid.

The Game Master

Your role as GM is difficult, but ultimately rewarding. Your most important job is making sure everyone at the table is having fun, but that includes yourself. Come to an agreement with your players before running the game to see what you and them want to get out of the game. Also, remember that it is not you against the players. You're playing the antagonists and will certainly try to kill them. But you're also creating a challenge for the players to surmount, and you have the right to be excited when they do.

You will be switching quickly between the roles of storyteller, roleplayer, and rulemaker.

Storyteller

You are the story. If your players are staying in the clan's walls and quietly cultivating, it's your fault if they grow bored and don't know what to do. Maybe an overbearing elder puts his hand on the scale, improving one player's cultivation and suppressing another's. A beast tide could put their cultivation on hold as they struggle to defend the clan and gain battle merits. And it's worth knowing where each event fits into your larger campaign. The Gu World is massive and dangerous, so what are the villains doing in the meantime?

Rulemaker

There are lots of edge cases where a rule just doesn't work. When that happens, you make a ruling on how it should work. Listen to your player's input if they don't agree, but you have the final say as GM.

Awarding Experience

There are two avenues of progression in this game: Experience and cultivation.

Experience is used to purchase talents and increase attributes, while cultivation improves a player's raw power by increasing their pool of primeval essence and allowing the use of higher rank Gu. Experience is awarded for overcoming challenges such as by fighting beasts and other Gu Masters, but can also by awarded for engaging in intrigue. The amount of experience awarded should be reflective of the overall difficulty of the encounter, with an average of 8-12 experience per session.

Encounter Difficulty

Combat encounters can be judged by the **Challenge Rating** (CR) of all creatures in the encounter. The lowest CR a creature can have is 0, representing mortal threats like common wolves and humans without any Gu. CR then jumps to 11. The first digit represents the rank of the threat, and the 2nd digit represents the estimated strength of the threat from 1-5. 1 represents initial stage, 2 middle stage, 3 upper stage, and 4 peak stage. A 5 means the threat is especially strong for its rank and may even be able to challenge weaker threats in the rank above it. CR caps at 54, for no mortal Gu Master could ever pose a threat to a Gu Immortal.

Character Creation

In this game, you will create and play a Gu Master. Gu Masters are human beings who have awakened their aperture, a kind of extradimensional space within the stomach that can contain Gu and primeval essence. The first thing you ought to mark down is your starting rank. For first-time players, it is recommended to start at rank 1 initial stage. You, your group, and the game master should also determine if you want to follow the righteous path, living and working with a clan, or if you'd like to tread the demonic path, living free in the world with no masters. Your path can always be changed later on, as demonic Gu Masters seek safety and resources, and righteous Gu Masters grow disillusioned and yearn for freedom.

Experience

You start with 500 experience to spend on character creation. Any experience left over afterwards is removed from the game, so that you start your first session with 0 experience. Experience can be spent to increase your Attributes and Skills, as well as to purchase talents (though talents cannot be purchased at character creation). At character creation, attributes cannot be raised above 50 and skills cannot be increased above 80.

- 1 point in any attribute costs 10 experience to increase up to 50, and 15 experience thereafter.
- 1 point in any skill (except Knowledge) costs 2 experience to increase.
- 5 points in Strength or any single Knowledge skill costs 6 experience.

Primary Attributes

Primary attributes are a generalized measure of your body and mind. The base values of each of your skills are derived from these attributes. All Attribute scores start at 20 before you spend any experience to improve them. Improving an attribute also increases the value of all derived skills and secondary attributes.

Agility - Agility is used to dodge attacks, fight in close quarters, and to maneuver in the air.

Fortitude - Fortitude determines your Hit Points, Perseverance, and Strength.

Cognition - Your intelligence and reasoning skills. Used to create refinement recipes, remember information, and to fight in both close and ranged combat.

Wisdom - Wisdom increases your speed of cultivation, how often you succeed when refining Gu, and awareness of your surroundings.

Attitude - Attitude represents your understanding of human nature, relationships, and emotions. A higher attitude makes it easier to deceive and persuade others, and to know when others are deceiving you. It also is a minor factor in your Perseverance.

Secondary Attributes

Secondary attributes either have a flat base value or are derived from your primary attributes.

Health

You have a pool of Hit Points equal to your Fortitude. You can read about how damage, dying, and injury works in Chapter 4: Combat.

Movement

Your Movement is the number of meters you can move in a turn. Your Movement is 4 meters + 5% of your Agility (rounded down).

Strength

Your body's physical power. Strength is often overlooked by Gu Masters, as even rank 1 Gu can overpower the strongest of mortals. But battles are unpredictable, and when primeval essence runs dry Gu Masters may resort to a fistfight. Though this statistic is more relevant at rank 1, some Gu Masters choose to use Gu to enhance their strength and rely on their

own muscles to pound their enemies into meat paste. Your Strength score begins equal to your Fortitude and affects the amount of damage you deal with attacks where your physical strength is a factor.

If your Strength attribute is ever reduced to 0, you immediately fall unconscious. If it remains 0 for a minute straight, you die.

Perseverance

Your Perseverance is your ability to endure great pain and stress, and is equal to the sum of your Fortitude and 1/2 of your Attitude, rounded down. Perseverance is rolled when you hit 0 Hit Points.

Soul

Your Soul score is a literal representation of the strength of your soul. Your starting Soul value is 10. Refining Gu, cultivating, and controlling beast groups all drain the strength of your soul, while sleeping restores it. Many Soul Path Gu also use the strength of your soul to determine their strength when activated. If your current soul ever hits 0 points, you die. When you sleep, your soul recovers 10% of its maximum (rounded down) for every hour spent sleeping. Sleeping for at least 10 hours fully rejuvenates your soul, regardless of rounding.

Your soul begins at 10, the single-man soul. Many Soul Path Gu can strengthen your soul and increase this value. Whenever your soul takes 1/2 or more of its maximum value in soul damage (rounded down) on a single turn, roll 1d6 and reduce the maximum value of your soul by that amount.

When your soul reaches strength 100, you have the ten-man soul. It has the proper strength to sustain damage; you no longer lose maximum soul when you take more than 1/2 of your souls maximum in soul damage.

When your soul reaches strength 1,000, you have the hundred-man soul. If you have not refined your soul using Gu, this is the maximum strength achievable. If your soul increases in strength above 1009 without being refined, your soul explodes and you die, with resurrection being impossible.

When your soul reaches strength 10,000, you have the thousand-man soul. This is the limit for mortal Gu Masters and cannot be raised higher.

If your current soul is less than half of its maximum, you have the *fatigued* condition.

Luck

Players begin with 1 maximum luck point. Luck can be spent to force you or another creature to reroll a skill test directly after the roll, or to add a -50 bonus to a skill test you're making, before the roll. If you've expended a luck point on a skill test, you cannot spend another on the same skill test. You regain luck points up to your maximum at the start of each session.

Activations

When you take the **Activate Gu** combat action, you can activate a number of Gu equal to your Activations. You have a number of Activations equal to 5% of (Wisdom + Cognition), rounding down to a minimum of 1. To make this calculation easier, consider that for every 20 score you have in both attributes, this number will increase by 1. *Shang Liu has a Cognition of 46 and a Wisdom of 37. With a total of 83 and every 20 combined score giving 1 Activation, brings his total Activations to 4.*

Aptitude

Your Gu Master's aptitude is incredibly important to their cultivation and battle strength. A higher aptitude means greater primeval essence, meaning your Gu Master can fight for longer and cultivate quicker. Aptitude is mostly immutable, but some Gu exist to raise or even lower a Gu Master's aptitude.

Choosing your Gu Master's aptitude is a decision that will significantly shape their journey. Higher aptitudes offer undeniable advantages in cultivation speed, primeval essence, and clan support, but they come with the heavy burdens of increased clan expectations, heightened scrutiny, and potential danger. Lower aptitudes, while slower in cultivation, afford your Gu Master greater freedom, fewer obligations, and opportunities to forge their own path.

It is also worth considering the other players in your group. If one player is an A-grade aptitude and another is D-grade, your ranks will most likely diverge dramatically in the early to mid stages. This difference is not insurmountable, but it may not be enjoyable for the weaker Gu Master. It's recommended for the group to decide on 2 adjacent grades and have each player pick one of the two.

Aptitude is just an arbitrary grading of the amount of primeval essence a Gu Master's aperture can store. After choosing your aptitude, roll a d20, subtract 1 from the result, and add it to the minimum essence percentage of your grade to determine your personal maximum primeval essence.

For example, Shang Liu chooses A-grade aptitude and rolls a 4 on his d20. Subtract 1 to get 3 and add that to the minimum of 80%. Shang Liu therefore has 83% as his maximum.

Grade - A: 80%-99% **Grade - B:** 60%-79% **Grade - C:** 40%-59% **Grade - D:** 20%-39%

Attainment

Attainment is your understanding of the different Gu paths. That includes your knowledge of refining, using, and identifying Gu of the same path. You can find the different Attainments in the Talents section (Chapter 2. Progression), and your character begins the game with 50 free experience invested in a single path.

Starting Items

All characters start with a Gu Master robe, a Vital Gu of rank 1, and 25 primeval stones. At the GM's discretion (for price and availability) you may trade your starting primeval stones for additional rank 1 Gu.

Lifespan

If your character reaches age 100 without using *Lifespan Gu*, they die.

Skills

Your character's Skills represent their learned abilities and proficiencies, whether that be in combat, dialogue, or cultivation. The base value of the skill is dependent on what attribute(s) it is derived from, shown in the parenthesis. Remember to increase your skill values whenever you purchase points in the corresponding attribute.

Close Combat (1/2 Agi + 1/2 Cog) - Close Combat does not only include fighting hand-to-hand, it relates to any fighting that occurs within 2 meters of you. Many attack Gu can be used at range or in close combat, and this skill represents your ability to make attacks at a close range. Melee attacks are always made with your close combat skill.

Ranged Attack (Cog) - If an enemy is further than 3 meters from you, your non-melee attacks will be made with the Ranged Attack skill.

Athletics (1/2 Str + 1/2 Agi) - Athletics is used for strength related actions such as pushing a boulder, climbing a steep cliff, or swimming.

Pushing, Pulling, and Lifting You can push or pull any weight under 100kg without making a test, halving your movement (rounded down) if the weight is over 50kg. Above 100kg you must make an **Athletics** skill test with a -40 bonus, increased by +10 for every 50kg over 100.

Dodge (Agi) - Dodge is used as a reaction to avoid attacks made against you, either melee or ranged.

When you succeed a Dodge test, you MUST move at least 1 meter and at most 1/2 your movement (rounded down) in any direction.

Flying (Agi) - A Gu Master may live his entire life without taking to the skies, but to those that do, this skill is a necessity. Without a decent flying skill, a Gu Master can be easier to hit in the air than they would be on the ground.

The source of your flight tells you how many meters you can move per turn.

Refinement (Wis)

Even with a complete recipe, refining Gu is an arduous process, requiring precision and constant vigilance. When refinement fails it triggers a backlash which can hurt or even kill you and your Gu. Your refinement skill determines how complex of recipes you can follow, and how often your refinement fails.

Deduction (Cog)

Deduction is used to create and refine Gu recipes as well as to develop killer moves; the combination of multiple Gu used simultaneously to deliver a very potent effect. It can also be used to investigate your surroundings for clues.

Some Gu have the [**Deductive**] keyword. When activated, these Gu unlock a special **Deduction** action. To take it, you must spend an hour deducing a specific subject and make a **Deduction** skill test. Penalties and Bonuses are determined by the amount of supporting information available to you. The subject can be something that occured in the past, such as who might have committed a murder, or something happening in the present or future, like why a rival clan purchased a huge amount of an unusual refinement material. Deductions cannot create information out of thin air, and a success does not necessarily mean your deduction is correct if you lack a key piece of evidence. For every degree of success on the check, however, you gain one additional conclusion about the subject.

Persuasion (Att)

Persusasion can only be used on non-player characters. Persuasion tests are used to sway a character through your words.

Deception (Att)

Deception can only be used on non-player characters. Your ability to manipulate and deceive others.

Intimidation (Att)

Intimidation can only be used on non-player characters.

Haggle (Att)

Haggle can only be used on non-player characters. Difficulty is based on the target's feelings towards you, and grants a discount on a purchase of 5% for every degree of success on the test. A critical counts as an additional degree of success.

Insight (Wis)

Used to judge a character's body language and intonation. A successful insight test involves learning a character's intention and scrutinizing their body language, and in most cases will not straight up say whether a character is lying or not.

Awareness (Wis)

Your ability to notice hidden objects. If you're meticulously searching an area, use deduction, but to notice an out of place detail while walking past a building you would use awareness.

Cultivation (Wis)

The higher your cultivation skill, the less damage you will take to your soul during cultivation, and the quicker your cultivation will increase.

Knowledge (Cog)

Knowledge is separated into a few categories:

- Gu - There are an uncountable number of different Gu in the world, and this skill helps to identify them. In a fight, it can mean life or death.
- Southern Border - Your understanding of the geography, flora, and fauna of Southern Border. It can be assumed that all characters will have knowledge of the areas surrounding their clan, but when journeying beyond familiarity this skill can be used to identify beasts, plants, and natural formations.
- Clans - Small, medium, large, and super-sized clans dot the mountains and valleys of Southern Border. This skill represents your knowledge of their names, power structures, specialties, and commerce.

Chapter 2 - Progression

Cultivating

The process of increasing your rank in small and large realms is called cultivating. To cultivate, you must meditate and will the primeval essence in your aperture to attack and weaken the aperture walls. To do so, first figure out how many portions of primeval essence will be required to break through the realm. For small realms, the amount is given by the table below. For large realms, the amount is (1000 * target rank) portions.

Stage	Name	Aperture Wall	Wall Hit Points
1	Initial	Light membrane	1000 * rank
2	Middle	Water membrane	4000 * rank
3	Upper	Stone membrane	8000 * rank
4	Peak	Crystal membrane	None

When you're attempting to break through a small realm the walls retain any damage done by your primeval essence, thus you can slowly break through over time. For every hour you spend cultivating, you can expend a number of portions up to your aptitude plus your natural recovery, reducing the health of the aperture walls by an equivalent amount. This means that if you are at your maximum primeval essence, your primeval sea would be completely exhausted after 1 hour of cultivation at initial stage, 2 at middle stage, and 4 at upper stage.

When you're trying to break through from peak stage of a rank to the next rank, first take your primeval essence recovery rate and subtract (15 * target rank) to represent the natural recovery rate of your aperture walls. If the number you calculated is 0 or greater, you can move on to the next step. If it is negative, you'll have to increase your recovery rate via consuming primeval stones or use a Gu that assists in cultivation to break through to the next stage.

You must cultivate for 24 hours straight with no breaks in order to break through to the next rank. For every 10 essence per hour you recover greater than the natural recovery rate of your aperture walls, this time is reduced by 4 hours, to a minimum of 8 hours.

For every 4 hours spent cultivating, whether breaking through a small or large realm, make a **Cultivation** skill test with a bonus/penalty according to the table below. If you fail, your soul takes damage equal to the degrees of failure.

Target Rank	Modifier
1	-20
2	-10
3	none
4	+10
5	+20

When you successfully break through a small realm, your maximum portions of primeval essence is doubled but you retain your current number of portions. When you break through a large realm, your primeval sea is completely emptied of the previous rank's primeval essence and your maximum primeval essence is reset to your aptitude.

Consuming Primeval Stones

You can expend primeval stones to hasten your cultivation, and you may do so to assist in breaking through both small and large realms. You may expend any number of primeval stones per hour spent cultivating, increasing your recovery rate by {5, 4, 3, 2, N/A} for each stone consumed per hour when breaking through large realms, or dealing {5, 4, 3, 2, 1} damage to the aperture walls for each stone consumed when breaking through small realms. This depends on your current rank, not the target rank. Primeval stone expenditure must remain constant each hour when breaking through large realms; you cannot use 5 stones the first few hours and then stop using stones for the remainder of the duration.

Spending Experience

In addition to progressing through cultivation, you also get more skilled as a Gu Master as time passes. The GM will award experience at the end of each session, recommended to be between 8-12 experience. Experience earned in this way can be stockpiled, and a few Gu are even be able to consume it as a resource. At the GM's discretion, the players will be allowed to spend their accrued experience at a particular time. Typical situations to allow spending of experience are either when the party is safe and able to rest, or whenever they increase their cultivation.

Downtime

Gu Masters have many different activities available to them during downtime. Cultivation is described in this chapter, but you can also spend time creating refinement recipes for Gu, improving refinement recipes, actually refining Gu, deducing killer moves, or studying and practicing. Details on refinement recipes and killer moves are given in Chapter 3: Gu.

Studying

To study, you must first acquire a teacher or their recorded instructional material such as a book or Information Path Gu. Your progress is quickened or slowed depending on the quality of your teacher or reading material.

For every 8 hours spent learning with a tutor, you invest 2, 5, or 12 experience, depending on if the teacher has *Fundamental*, *Intermediate*, or *Master* Attainment (respectively) in the path you are trying to learn.

Skilled tutors are available for hire in most mid to large-sized clans; Those with *Fundamental* Attainment charge around 50 primeval stones, while those with *Intermediate* Attainment charge around 200 primeval stones per 8 hour session. Masters of a path are difficult to find, often being highly ranked or very old lone cultivators. Many are in charge of entire forces, and unwilling to teach for mere primeval stones if anything at all. If you do find a master willing to teach you, they will often ask for a favor in return.

When learning a path from recorded material, the experience gained is halved (to a minimum of 1), and is dependent on the Attainment of the author when it was created.

Learning Talents

You can also learn Talents from others as long as they have purchased the Talent and you fulfill any requirements for it. For every 4 hours you spend being instructed, you gain 5 experience that can only be used to purchase the Talent being learned. You must be personally instructed to learn Talents and cannot learn them from books and other recorded material. You can learn Talents and Refinement Techniques in this way, but not Path Attainments.

Instructing Others

Personally instructing others can be fulfilling and a good learning experience. You gain 1 experience every 8 hour session spent teaching an Attainment. When you successfully teach someone else a Talent, you gain 2 experience.

Talents

Charger

Cost: 20 experience

When you take the *Sprint* combat action, you may make a single punching attack or activate a Gu with a range of *Touch* at some point during your turn. If you make a punching attack and it hits, the target is thrown backward a number of meters equal to 1% of your Strength attribute (rounded down), to a minimum of 0. Making the attack or activating a Gu with a range of *Touch* expends the remainder of your movement.

Combat Absorption

Cost: 30 experience

You can multitask on absorbing primeval stones in the heat of combat. Absorbing the essence of primeval stones now costs a bonus action instead of a combat action.

Flurry

Cost: 20 experience

Requires Fundamental Strength Path Attainment

You gain access to the **Flurry** combat action.

Flurry: For every arm you have, make two punching attacks against a creature within 1 meter. You gain a +20 penalty to **Dodge** skill tests and **Close Combat** skill tests made to parry attacks until the start of your next turn.

Flying Master

Cost: 45 experience

Taking flight no longer expends one of your Maneuvers per turn. Your **Flying** skill is permanently increased by 20 points.

Glib

Cost: 60 experience

Your Attitude attribute is permanently increased by 5. You gain advantage on **Haggle** and **Persuasion** skill tests.

Martial Artist

Cost: 15 experience

Can be purchased up to 3 times

You gain a -5 bonus to **Close Combat** and **Dodge** skill tests while not wielding any weapons.

Multitasker

Cost: 40 experience

Can be purchased up to 3 times

You can sustain an additional Gu every turn without incurring damage to your soul.

Multi-Weapon Fighting

Cost: 20 experience

You can make a number of melee attacks as part of a melee attack combat action as you have wielded weapons, with a +10 penalty to each attack. When wielding only 2 weapons, this penalty is removed.

Natural Muscle Training

Cost: 15 experience

Can be purchased up to 5 times

Your Strength attribute is permanently increased by 9 and your Fortitude attribute is permanently increased by 1.

Not So Fast

Cost: 25 experience

You may make the *Grapple* combat action as an attack of opportunity. You still have disadvantage on the **Close Combat** skill test if the target triggered your attack of opportunity with a **Dodge** skill test.

Pain Tolerance

Cost: 10 experience

Requires Intermediate Strength Path Attainment

Can be purchased up to 3 times

Cannot be learned through downtime

Your maximum hit points are increased by 5, and you gain a -10 bonus to all **Perseverance** attribute tests.

Partial Artist

Cost: 80 experience

You've had an epiphany and internalized the idea of Painting Path. Choose a single Gu with the [**Dao**] keyword (whether you own it or not). You may be under the effects of that Gu even if its path is not compatible with the paths of your other [**Dao**] Gu. Whenever you break through a small or large realm, you may replace your chosen Gu with a different one.

[Path] Scholar

Cost: 10 experience

Requires Fundamental [Path] Attainment

You gain a -20 bonus to **Knowledge (Gu)** skill tests made to identify [Path] Gu.

Sentinel

Cost: 25 experience

Whenever a creature within your melee range makes a melee attack against your ally, you may use the *Parry* reaction against it. You gain a -10 bonus to all **Close Combat** skill tests made as part of the *Parry* reaction (including the follow-up attack).

Tough

Cost: 60 experience

Cannot be learned through downtime

Your base hit points are equal to twice your Fortitude.

Reactive Flight

Cost: 15 experience

As a reaction to being sent *airborne*, you can activate a Gu that grants a flying speed and immediately execute a maneuver for free.

Weapon Training

Cost: 15 experience

Can be purchased up to 3 times

When you purchase this talent, pick a class of mundane weapons (swords, spears, bows) or a single Gu.

You gain a -10 bonus on close combat and ranged attack rolls made with the chosen weapon for each time you've purchased this talent and selected that weapon. If a Gu is very close in form to the chosen weapon, you still get this bonus. This usually includes higher ranked versions of the same Gu.

Well Fed

Prodigious Size is common for those who align with food path

Cost: 20 experience

Requires Fundamental Food Path Attainment

Can be purchased up to 3 times

Cannot be learned through downtime

Your Fortitude is permanently increased by 5, your weight is increased by 25 kilograms, and your movement is reduced by 1. If you purchase this talent 3 times, your size becomes [**Large**].

Wrestling Techniques

Cost: 20 Experience

Requires Fundamental Strength Path Attainment

You gain a -10 bonus to **Athletics** skill tests resulting from a *Grapple* combat action. When you successfully grapple a creature, you may make a single punching attack against them as part of the *Grapple* combat action.

Refinement Techniques

Refinement techniques are used to improve the Gu refinement process in many different ways, such as reducing the difficulty, duration, or even material cost of a refinement recipe. Only one refinement technique can be used on a recipe at a time.

Batch Refinement

Cost: 25 experience

Requires Intermediate Refinement Path Attainment

You gain access to the Batch Refinement refinement technique. When you use the Batch Refinement refinement technique, you gain a +20 penalty to **Refinement** skill tests, and every cost of the recipe is quadrupled (including Gu). If you succeed the **Refinement** skill test, you produce 5 of the Gu; you must roll the failure die separately for each Gu.

Bellows Stove

Cost: 15 experience

Requires Fundamental Wind Path Attainment

You gain access to the Bellows Stove refinement technique. When you use the Bellows Stove refinement technique, you gain a -20 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests. If you fail the refinement, the damage of the backlash is increased by 2. This refinement technique can only be used to refine Fire, Food, and Wind Path Gu.

Brute Force

Cost: 25 experience

Requires Master Strength Path Attainment

You gain access to the Brute Force refinement technique. When you use the Brute Force refinement technique, you gain a -40 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests, and the failure die of the recipe is forced to be a d2. If the recipe belongs to Strength Path, the failure die is instead a d3. This refinement technique cannot be used to refine Wisdom Path Gu.

Dice Falling Waterfall

Cost: 10 experience

Requires Fundamental Luck Path Attainment

You gain access to the Dice Falling Waterfall refinement technique. When you use the Dice Falling Waterfall refinement technique, you must roll the failure die twice and take the lower result. Upon successfully refining a Gu with this technique, you gain a luck point. This refinement technique cannot be used to refine Rule Path Gu.

Dual Refinement

Cost: 20 experience

Requires Intermediate Refinement Path Attainment

You gain access to the Dual Refinement refinement technique. When you use the Dual Refinement refinement technique, you may refine two unique Gu at the same time. The Gu must be of the same or compatible paths (see Ch. 3, Gu) and their recipes must have the same duration. You make only one **Refinement** test, but otherwise treat the refinement as if they were two separate refinements.

Extended Refinement

Cost: 10 experience

Requires Fundamental Refinement Path Attainment

You gain access to the Extended Refinement refinement technique. When you use the Extended Refinement refinement technique, you gain a -20 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests, and the duration of the recipe is increased by 8 hours. This refinement technique cannot be used to refine Time Path Gu.

False Refinement

False refinement was invented by Thieving Heaven Demon Venerable, enabling the production of counterfeit Gu.

Cost: 20 experience

Requires Intermediate Refinement Path Attainment

You gain access to the False Refinement refinement technique. When you use the False Refinement refinement technique, you gain a -10 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests, and the primeval stone cost of the recipe is reduced by 75% (rounded down). When you successfully refine a Gu using the False Refinement refinement technique, the refined Gu is *counterfeit.* It cannot be activated, but otherwise appears exactly the same as the real version of the Gu. Gu used to appraise the counterfeit must be of a rank equal to or higher than your degrees of success (maximum 5) on the **Refinement** skill test in order to determine it is a fake.

Hairy Man Heaven and Earth

Condenses Gu from Heaven and Earth, opposed to Human Isolation Style. This technique is normally known only to Hairy Men, and takes great practice to perform.

Cost: 50 experience

Requires Master Refinement Path Attainment

You gain access to the Hairy Man Heaven and Earth refinement technique. When you use the Hairy Man Heaven and Earth refinement technique, you gain a -30 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests, and the failure die of the recipe

is increased by 2 stages (d4 -> d8, d6 -> d10...). This refinement technique cannot be used to refine Human Path Gu.

One After Another

Cost: 25 experience

Requires Fundamental Wood Path Attainment

You gain access to the One After Another refinement technique. When you use the One After Another refinement technique, you gain a -30 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests, and the duration of the refinement is increased by 4 hours. This refinement technique can only be used to refine Wood Path Gu.

Reduction

Cost: 20 experience

Requires Intermediate Food Path Attainment

You gain access to the Reduction refinement technique. When you use the Reduction refinement technique, the primeval stone cost of the recipe is reduced by 50% (rounded down). If you fail the refinement, the damage of the backlash is reduced by 1.

Research

Cost: 25 experience

Requires Intermediate Wisdom Path Attainment

You gain access to the Research refinement technique. Whenever you successfully refine a Gu using the Research refinement technique, you gain a -20 bonus on your next **Refinement** test made to improve that recipe. This bonus does not stack.

Sacrifice

Cost: 10 experience

Requires Intermediate Blood Path Attainment

You gain access to the Sacrifice refinement technique. Whenever you use the Sacrifice refinement technique, you may take any amount of damage directly to your hit points. This damage cannot be reduced or negated in any way. The primeval stone cost of the recipe is reduced by 100 * (sacrificed hit points), to a minimum of 10% of the recipe's primeval stone cost.

Sauté

Cost: 15 experience

Requires Fundemental Food Path Attainment

You gain access to the Sauté refinement technique. When you use the Sauté refinement technique, you gain a -10 bonus to all **Refinement** tests, and increase the primeval stone cost of the recipe by 50% (rounding down). For every Gu used in the recipe, roll 1d10. If you roll a 1, that Gu is not consumed during the refinement.

Shower

Cost: 15 experience

Requires Fundamental Water Path Attainment

You gain access to the Shower refinement technique. When you use the Shower refinement technique, you gain a -10 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests, and the duration of the recipe is reduced by 50%. This refinement technique can only be used to refine Blood, Poison, and Water Path Gu.

Starfall

Cost: 15 experience

Requires Fundamental Fire Path Attainment

You gain access to the Starfall refinement technique. When you use the Starfall refinement technique, you gain a -10 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests, increased to -20 when refining Fire Path Gu. This refinement technique can only be used to refine Fire, Light, Lightning, and Space Path Gu.

Yin Yang

Cost: 20 experience

You gain access to the Yin Yang refinement technique. When you use the Yin Yang refinement technique, you may refine two unique Gu at the same time. Their recipes must have the same duration, and the paths of the Gu must be one of the following pairs:

- Fire and Ice Path
- Space and Time Path
- Strength and Wisdom Path
- Light and Dark Path
- Earth and Wind Path
- Luck and Information Path

You make only one **Refinement** test, but otherwise treat the refinement as if they were two separate refinements.

Attainment

It's difficult to use and improve Gu of a path you aren't familiar with. Oftentimes, a Gu Master that achieves Master Attainment in any path gains fame for their accomplishment, and may be contacted by other forces to refine Gu or complete difficult tasks related to the path.

Attainment in each path is tracked on your character sheet by the amount of experience invested in it. Whenever you can spend experience to purchase talents or improve your attributes and skills, you may choose to invest experience in specific paths. When you reach the threshold of invested experience in a path, you gain the Attainment as if it were a Talent. This means once you have invested 250 total experience in a path, you will have *Fundamental*, *Intermediate*, and *Master* Attainment in that path. You can also gain experience in a path by creating and improving recipes, deducing killer moves, and refining Gu that belong to that path. Every character starts with 50 experience invested in a single path.

[Path] Attainment

Fundamental

Threshold: 50 experience

You gain an additional bonus action that can only be used to activate a single [Path] Gu on your turn.

Intermediate

Threshold: 120 experience

Your understanding of [Path] has reached a qualitative change, and you gain the following benefits:

- You gain a -20 bonus to all **Refinement** and **Knowledge (Gu)** skill tests to refine or identify [Path] Gu.
- You gain a -20 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests made to improve or create refinement recipes for [Path] Gu.
- You gain a -10 bonus on **Deduction** skill tests made to deduce killer moves if they have a [Path] Gu in its core.

Master

Threshold: 250 experience

Your understanding of [Path] reaches the apex of mortal comprehension. You gain the following benefits:

- You gain a -40 bonus to all **Refinement** and **Knowledge (Gu)** skill tests to refine or identify [Path] Gu.
- You gain a -40 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests made to improve or create refinement recipes for [Path] Gu.
- You gain a -20 bonus on **Deduction** skill tests made to deduce killer moves if they have a [Path] Gu in its core.

Chapter 3 - Gu

Humans are the spirit of all living beings and Gu are the essence of Heaven and Earth. Mortal Gu represent fragments of the great Dao, or laws of Heaven, and are ranked from 1 to 5, just like mortal Gu Masters. Gu come in many different forms, with bugs being a common motif, but there are just as many that take the forms of beasts and objects. Gu can be either wild or refined; wild Gu usually refers to those birthed from natural primeval essence. These can come into being in any manner of places as long as the conditions are right. Sometimes they are carried by beasts, or roaming the earth alone, or staying sedentary in the place they were born. Refined Gu are those under the direct control of a Gu Master. They obey the user's commands without fail, even destroying themselves with a single thought. The Gu Master can acquire refined Gu by refining wild Gu, creating them themselves using their Refinement skill, or acquiring them from others. Refined Gu may become wild Gu if their master is killed, but this process takes some time.

Gu are separated into different categories based on the effect created when they are activated. These categories have minimal mechanical importance but give a good idea of the Gu's purpose.

Attack - Shooting a blade, controlling someone's mind, or softening a person's bones are all attacks. If the primary use of the Gu is to kill or apply negative effects to a person against their will, it is an attack.

Manifestation - Creates an object under the user's control. Can be permanent or temporary.

Guard - Forms a defensive barrier with the primary focus being blocking attacks.

Celerity - Enhances speed or maneuverability.

Divination - Gathers information, whether from a short distance or across the continent. Investigative Gu that increase a user's perception are included, as well as those that surveil areas or probe into people's minds.

Concealment - Hides the user's presence in any number of ways.

Tonic - Gu with a restorative effect. There exist tonic Gu for humans, beasts, and even other Gu.

Container - If objects can be placed inside, the Gu is typically a container. They can store objects, gu, and sometimes even people. Convenient for storing items and resources safely within your aperture.

Catalyst - A catch-all category for Gu that can be used to supplement other Gu and actions. Gu that increase the likelihood of refinement success, improve cultivation speed, or amplify the effects of other Gu are all catalysts.

Carver - Carves dao semi-permanently into the recipient. The most common carvers belong to strength and information path, used to increase a user's strength and create binding agreements, respectively.

Below is a sample statblock for the rank 1 *Moonlight Gu*. This is the signature Gu of the Gu Yue clan, and cannot be found anywhere else in Southern Border.

Moonlight Gu

Rank 1 Attack (*This signifies that the Gu is of Rank 1, and is an Attack-type Gu*)

Cost: 5 portions (*This Gu costs 5 portions to activate for a rank 1 Gu Master. Rank 2 and above Gu Masters instead only spend 1 portion*)

Range: 10 meters

Health: 10 (*This Gu has 10 health. If it hits 0, it dies*)

Food: Moon orchid petals (3 primeval stones) (*This gu eats moon orchid petals. Since it is a rank 1 Gu, it eats every 3 days. When you have access to a market, you can substitute the materials with 3 primeval stones.*)

Effect: You hurl a flat, crescent-shaped beam of light. Make an attack roll with a -10 bonus. On a hit, deal 6 rending damage.

Vital Gu

The first Gu you refine gains the [**Vital**] keyword and becomes your Vital Gu. Yours and your Vital Gu's lifeforces are connected, and if your Vital Gu should die, you would as well. The Vital Gu has a major advantage, however; It cannot die due to backlash during refinement, instead dropping to 1 hp and being unusable in refinement until its hit points are

restored to their maximum. This makes your Vital Gu a very important choice for progression, as you can attempt to refine it to a higher rank many times without worrying about its death.

To change your Vital Gu, you must spend a day in closed cultivation with the new Gu. When you change your Vital Gu, your current hit points are reduced to 1 as you suffer backlash. Your Vital Gu can be of any rank.

Rank

Mortal Gu have a rank of 1-5. Some Gu exist only at a single rank, others are found at several ranks, and others can only be raised in rank through refinement. For example, the rank 1 Dog Enslavement Gu can enslave a single dog. Rank 2 dog enslavement Gu can enslave a Hundred Beast King dog, rank 3 can enslave a Thousand Beast King dog, and so on, with each being found on increasingly strong dogs. The higher the rank of the Gu, the rarer it is, and their strength increases exponentially.

Gu above rank 5 are called Immortal Gu. Most can only be activated with Immortal Essence, though a few have other costs that can be paid by mortals. Forgetting mortal Gu Masters, even Rank 6 Gu Masters may live their entire life without owning an Immortal Gu. Each one is unique, and for however long it exists in the world, nobody else can refine a copy. When one appears, many Gu Immortals will fight to the death to get their hands on it, and when they fight, many tens of thousands of mortals can and do die in the crossfire.

Series

Some Gu belong to a series that spans multiple ranks. Some have additional effects based on their rank and will be listed separately. Others just scale up in numbers and will be under the same listing. If several values are inside curly braces, they represent the value at different ranks. If a Gu exists at ranks 3-5 and creates {1, 10, 100} fireballs, then it creates 1 fireball at rank 3, 10 at rank 4, and 100 at rank 5.

Price

Price is largely dependent on the rank of the Gu in question, but the market also needs to be considered. Relic Gu, for example, are quite rare and of an enormous help to a Gu Master's cultivation, which makes them significantly more expensive than other Gu of the same rank. Smelly Fart Gu, on the other hand, is practically worthless except as a refinement material, and thus would be cheaper than other Gu of the same rank. Use the prices below as a starting point.

Rank	Price
1	100
2	500
3	5,000
4	50,000
5	1,000,000+

Rank 4 and rank 5 Gu are significantly rarer than Gu of rank 1 to 3. It may be difficult to find a seller, and you may even encounter schemes and resistances from your opposition when trying to buy them.

Primeval Essence Costs

Gu statblocks will have a number of portions it costs to activate. This assumes you are of the same rank as the Gu. If your rank is lower than the Gu, your primeval essence is too weak, and the Gu costs 4 times as many portions to activate for every rank above you the Gu is. If you are Rank 2 and try to activate a Rank 4 Gu that costs 10 portions, instead it will cost you 160 portions. If the Gu is below your rank, it only costs a single portion of your primeval essence to activate.

Wild Gu

Wild Gu are found in the wilderness, typically in an environment rich with Dao of the Gu's path. Wild Gu have a speed of 8 meters (except [**Steed**] Gu with their own movement statistic) and will attempt to evade capture, including by activating themselves using natural primeval essence. Wild Gu can see through *concealments* of a lower rank than itself, and have an **Awareness** skill of 10 * rank.

Refining Gu

Refining Gu can refer to two processes; the first is turning a wild Gu or a Gu refined by someone else into your own. The second is the act of following a recipe to create a new Gu. You cannot activate a Gu that is wild or belongs to someone else, unless the owner is willing. When a Gu you have refined is killed or refined by someone else, you immediately feel the connection between you get severed (but don't gain information on whether it was killed or refined).

Refining Existing Gu

When refining a wild Gu, the Gu must be subdued first. For smaller Gu this usually just involves catching it, but larger or more aggressive Gu may require you to weaken it in battle or through other means.

If the Gu is owned by someone else, they can weaken their will to allow you to refine the Gu for free. Otherwise, your will is pit against theirs. Make an opposed Wisdom attribute test against the owner of the Gu, with the higher ranked Gu Master gaining a -30 bonus for each rank they are above their opponent. If you win the test, the owner's will is driven out and you gain ownership of the Gu. If you lose, they retain control of the Gu, you take 1d4 damage to your soul, and you gain a stacking -10 bonus on subsequent rolls made to refine the Gu.

Once a wild Gu is subdued, you must be touching it to refine it into your own. To do so, you must spend 50 portions of primeval essence. If the Gu is of a higher rank than you, it costs 4 times more portions to refine for each rank above you.

If the Gu is below your rank, it costs a single portion of primeval essence to refine.

If you do not have enough primeval essence to do so in one sitting, you may have to refine the Gu for a longer period, using your natural recovery and/or primeval stones to supply the rest of the required portions. Taking a break from the refinement causes it to fail, and the primeval essence used in the process is lost.

Recipes

Four Flavors Liquor Worm Gu *Four Flavors Liquor Worm Gu*

Rank: 2

Cost: 25 primeval stones, 2 Rank 1 Liquor Worm Gu, Spicy wine, sweet wine, bitter wine, sour wine

Additional Gu: none

Duration: 4 hours

Difficulty: -10 bonus

Failure Die: d10

Following a Recipe

Refinement recipes will have many required materials. Common materials are included in the recipe's primeval stone cost, assuming you have access to a market to purchase the materials. Rarer materials will be specified, and you may have to seek out a seller or go find these materials yourself. When you successfully refine a Gu that you have never refined before, you immediately invest {0, 1, 2, 3, 4} experience into your Attainment in the path of the Gu.

To begin refinement, you must have all the necessary materials on hand. If you know any refinement techniques (see ch.2 - Talents) you may select one. Make a **Refinement** skill test with a penalty or bonus according to the recipe's difficulty. If you've already successfully refined the Gu before, you gain a -20 bonus on the test. On a success, roll the failure die. If the number rolled is anything except a 1, you have succeeded in creating the Gu. If you do roll a 1, the refinement fails, representing the flat chance of failure all refinement recipes have.

On a failure, you lose all non-Gu refinement materials used in the refinement; you and all Gu being used in the refinement process take a backlash. If the failure was caused by a 1 on the failure die, the backlash is negated. Otherwise, you take damage to your soul equal to the degrees of failure. Every Gu being used in the refinement takes the same amount of damage to their health. If your Vital Gu would be killed in this manner, instead it drops to 1 hit point.

Refinement is an extremely precise and involved effort. For every 4 hours you spend refining Gu without a rest, you take 1 damage to your soul as you become fatigued.

Improving a Recipe

You can leverage your **Refinement** skill to reduce the cost, duration, difficulty, or failure rate of any Gu recipe. To do so, you must have *Fundamental* Attainment (see ch.2 - Talents) in the path of the Gu in question. When you successfully improve the recipe of a Gu, you immediately invest {1, 1, 2, 4, 8} experience into your Attainment in the path of the Gu.

Start by paying 4 times the total cost of the recipe, to represent the materials needed to practice and attempt to improve the recipe. You must also spend an amount of time equal to 4 times the duration of the recipe in refinement. This time does not need to be sequential, and you can take breaks as long as you need and however often you need. Then, make a **Refinement** skill test with a {-40, -20, 0, +20, +40} modifier. On a fumble, you do not succeed in improving the recipe and take damage to your soul equal to the degrees of failure multiplied by the rank of the recipe. On a failure, you do not succeed in improving the recipe, but don't face a backlash. On a success, you make a breakthrough and gain a new recipe for the Gu, with one of the following improvements:

- The failure die is increased by one step; d2 -> d4 -> d6 -> d8 -> d10 -> d12 -> d20 -> d100
- The difficulty is reduced by 10
- The primeval stone cost is reduced by 25% (rounded down)
- The duration is reduced by 4 hours

The recipe you've created is different from the previous one, and both can still be used and sold. You can improve a recipe a number of times equal to 5% of your **Refinement** skill, rounded down.

Alternatively, if you have a Gu with the [**Deductive**] keyword you may use the **Deduction** action to improve the recipe. You still must meet the Attainment requirements, and also must have a **Refinement** skill of {20, 20, 30, 40, 50} to attempt to improve a recipe with the **Deduction** action. This process takes {2, 4, 8, 12, 16} hours to perform.

Creating a Recipe

Creating a recipe is a collaborative effort between the player and GM. You should first approach the GM with the Gu you want to create a recipe for. This can be a Gu from the Gu Index or a unique Gu that the GM has approved, but you must have at least *Intermediate* Attainment in the path of the Gu. When you successfully create the recipe of a Gu, you immediately invest {1, 2, 4, 8, 20} experience into your Attainment in the path of the Gu.

You must spend a number of primeval stones on refinement materials and {8, 16, 24, 32, 40} hours practicing and experimenting; this time does not need to be sequential however. After spending the requisite time, make a **Refinement** skill test with a bonus or penalty according to the following table:

Rank	Bonus/Penalty	PS Cost
1	-20	800
2	0	8,000
3	+20	80,000
4	+40	600,000
5	+60	4,000,000

Alternatively, if you have a Gu with the [**Deductive**] keyword you may use the **Deduction** action to deduce the recipe. You still must meet the Attainment requirements, and also must have a **Refinement** skill of {20, 30, 40, 60, 80} to attempt to create a recipe with the **Deduction** action.

If you succeed the skill test, a recipe for the Gu is created. All that is left to do is actually design the recipe. The recipe begins with the following statistics and you can improve it by spending Recipe Points.

Sample Recipe *Sample Gu*

Rank: {1, 2, 3, 4, 5}

Cost:

Rank	Cost
1	150 PS
2	750 PS
3	7,500 PS + 1 Rank 3 Refinement Material
4	75,000 PS + 2 Rank 4 Refinement Materials
5	1,500,000 PS + 2 Rank 5 Refinement Materials

Additional Gu:

If this recipe upgrades a Gu to the next rank, that Gu goes here. You may also forcefully add a Gu to the refinement recipe so long as it is of the same path as the Gu being refined. If you do so, you gain 1 Recipe Point if the Gu is of rank {N/A, 1, 2, 3, 4} or 3 Recipe Points if the Gu is of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5}. You cannot add a Gu of higher rank into the refinement recipe.

Duration: 16 hours

Difficulty: {+10, +20, +40, +60, +100}

Failure Die: {d4, d4, d4, d2, d2}

When you succeed in deducing a recipe you have a number of Recipe Points equal to your degrees of success on the test, with a critical success counting as an additional degree of success. Spending a Recipe Point on the recipe does one of the following:

- The failure die is increased by one step; d2 -> d4 -> d6 -> d8 -> d10 -> d12 -> d20 -> d100
- The difficulty is reduced by 10
- The primeval stone cost is reduced by 25% (rounded down)
- The duration is reduced by 4 hours

Once you have spent all Recipe Points, the recipe is complete!

Feeding Gu

Gu are living beings and need to be fed. What they eat is determined by the Gu, while how often they eat is determined by the rank. Some Gu will have a number of primeval stones in parenthesis next to their food. If you have access to a market, you can spend that number of primeval stones for a feeding. Gu also cannot be fed during combat.

Rank	Interval
1	3 days
2	7 days
3	30 days
4	250 days
5	10 years

If the food does not have a primeval stone cost next to it, that does not mean it is impossible to purchase, just that it is a rarer material. You can find your own out in the Southern Border, or seek out a seller of rare items.

To track food, mark the Gu's feeding interval in days inside the "Days Until Feeding" column on your Gu sheet. Every time a day passes in game, subtract 1 from the number. When the Gu eats, set it back to the original feeding interval. If it hits -1, the Gu starves to death. You can feed a Gu outside of combat whenever you wish as long as you have the materials.

Detonating Gu

As a reaction or at any time during their turn, a Gu Master can self-detonate any Gu owned and refined by them with a single thought. The Gu Master must be conscious to do so, and can detonate as many or as few Gu as they want, from any distance. If the Gu is being suppressed, such as by the land spirit of a blessed land, the Gu Master cannot self-detonate it.

Otherwise, the chosen Gu instantly die, with no other effects. If the Gu has a self-detonation ability, it does not trigger, since the Gu was not activated.

Healing Gu

Gu have a pool of hit points, and thus need to be healed when damaged. Most Gu heal back to full health when they are fed. Some Gu can only be healed by other Gu or an obscure process.

Stacking Effects

In most cases, the effects of different Gu will stack, whereas the effects of the same Gu will not. Even if a Gu Master owns multiple Golden Breeze Gu, they cannot sustain both at the same time to double the healing effect. If multiple Gu would transform the same body part, the most recently applied effect takes precedence.

Gu against Gu

Sometimes the effects of Gu will be pit against one another. In most circumstances, the higher rank Gu's effect takes precedence. If both are the same rank, the defending Gu should block the effect. For example, if a Gu Master is attacked by Rank 2 Vein Burst Gu, but has strengthened his blood vessels with Rank 2 Iron Artery Gu, then he would be unaffected, despite neither Gu explicitly mentioning the interaction. Invisibility and concealments are considered the defender when pit against divinations.

The Gu system has a lot of moving parts, and it would be unfun and tedious if every effect listed every possible counter and use case. When there's uncertainty about whether a Gu would affect a target, use common sense, and if that fails the GM will have to make a ruling.

Gu Keywords

Deductive

When activated, [**Deductive**] Gu unlock a special *Deduction* action. To take it, you must spend 4 hours to deduce a specific subject or a killer move and make a **Deduction** skill test. Penalties and bonuses are determined by the amount of supporting information available to you. You can stack the effects of a number [**Deductive**] Gu to the same *Deduction* action according to your Wisdom Path Attainment, given in the following table:

Attainment	Maximum [**Deductive**] Gu
None	1
Fundamental	2
Intermediate	3
Master	5

A specific subject can be something that occured in the past, such as who might have committed a murder, or something happening in the present or future, like why a rival clan may have purchased a huge amount of an unusual refinement material. At the GM's discretion, you can also deduce plans of action, such as moneymaking schemes or attack plans. Deductions cannot create information out of thin air, and a success does not necessarily mean your deduction is correct if you lack a key piece of evidence. For every degree of success beyond 1 on the check, however, you gain one additional conclusion about the subject.

You may also use the *Deduction* action to create or improve refinement recipes. When you do so, you make the **Refinement** skill test like normal and add whatever effects are provided by the [**Deductive**] Gu you are using, including bonuses.

Dao

Gu with the [**Dao**] keyword contain much higher traces of dao than most mortal Gu. Dao of different paths naturally conflict, and a Gu Master cannot gain the effect from a [**Dao**] Gu if they are already under the effect of a [**Dao**] Gu of a non-compatible path. If a Gu belonging to Transformation Path has the [**Dao**] keyword, it belongs wholly to transformation

path and is compatible with all other paths. Transformation Path Gu may instead have the [**Dao: [Path]**] keyword, indicating that the Dao belongs to a different path and inherits that path's compatibilities. For example, Earth Chief Zombie Gu, which has the [**Dao: Earth**] keyword, can only be combined with [**Dao**] Gu of Metal, Transformation, or Wood Path.

Using the same [**Dao**] Gu multiple times does not stack the effect. You may also not apply multiple [**Dao**] Gu to the same body part. Most [**Dao**] Gu will specify what body part they carve dao into, from the following options:

Full Body - [**Dao**] Gu with the [**Transformation**] keyword affect your full body, but you can still apply [**Dao**] Gu to other body parts as long as you still have that functional body part.

Head

Brain

Eyes - Whether the Gu affects one eye or both, it counts as augmenting your eyes.

Ears - Whether the Gu affects one ear or both, it counts as augmenting your ears.

Torso

Heart

Lungs

Aperture

Arms

Hands

Legs

Feet

Skin

Muscles - Can be a specific muscle or the entire muscular system. Beast Strength Gu are an exception, as they can strengthen muscles and still be combined with compatible muscle affecting [**Dao**] Gu.

Blood

Bones

Tendons

Nervous System

Circulatory System

If the Gu does not list a body part then it has no body part restrictions.

Defensive

[**Defensive**] Gu can be activated as a reaction to any event.

Expendable X

[**Expendable**] Gu are destroyed after X uses. If there is no number, the Gu can only be used a single time before it is destroyed.

Extinct

[**Extinct**] Gu no longer appear naturally in the world and require extinct refinement materials for their most common recipes. **Refinement** and **Deduction** skill tests made to create a recipe for an [**Extinct**] Gu are made with an additional +60 penalty.

Fast

[**Fast**] Gu have a movement of 12 meters instead of 8.

Ingredient

Unique to Food Path, [**Ingredient**] Gu can be used to apply effects to meals you prepare. To prepare a meal, you must spend an hour cooking; expend 1 primeval stone worth of materials and the total primeval essence cost of involved [**Ingredient**] Gu. The number of [**Ingredient**] Gu you can apply to the same meal is dependent on your Food Path Attainment. You cannot prepare a meal unless you have at least *Fundamental* Food Path Attainment.

Each meal can feed 5 creatures.

Attainment	Maximum Ingredients
Fundamental	2
Intermediate	3
Master	5

The effects of a meal last for 8 hours, and a creature can only be under the effect of one meal at a time.

Investigative

Most [**Investigative**] Gu are divinations that are used to detect your surroundings for creatures, Gu, or even specific objects. The keyword will always be followed by the sense it augments; there are [**Investigative: Sight**] Gu, [**Investigative: Hearing**] Gu, and [**Investigative: Detect**] Gu. Sight and hearing are self explanatory, and you cannot see or hear through these Gu if you have the *blinded* or the *deafened* condition, respectively. Detect Gu transmit the locations of whatever Gu, objects, or creatures the Gu is meant to detect to your mind, and do not require the use of any of your senses. If you use an [**Investigative: Detect**] Gu while *blinded* to detect the location of a creature, the +50 penalty to **Close Combat** and **Ranged Attack** skill tests from the *blinded* condition is reduced to a +20 penalty.

[**Investigative**] Gu can ignore stealthing effects from Gu of a lower rank than themselves, such as invisibility, illusions, and obscuring effects (smoke). Some Gu with stealth effects will specify a different rank range of [**Investigative**] Gu that can see through their effect though, with that number taking priority.

Low Vitality

[**Low Vitality**] Gu do not regenerate hit points when they are fed. Most will clarify the necessary Gu or process used to recover their health instead.

Piercing

[**Piercing**] Gu can pierce through any material that lacks dao. The only barriers with dao would be either immortal refinement materials or barriers created by Gu. Mundane armor worn by a creature struck by a [**Piercing**] attack does not reduce the damage of the attack, and the armor takes damage equal to the damage of the attack to its hit points.

[**Piercing**] Gu can also make attacks against targets fully obscured by cover with a +20 penalty. If the target is only partially obscured by cover, attacks made with a [**Piercing**] Gu against them do not have the usual penalty.

Shield

When you take damage, that damage is first assigned to any active Gu with the [**Shield**] keyword so long as the Gu can block that damage type. If you have multiple [**Shield**] Gu active and it isn't immediately clear which one would block the attack first, you may decide in what order damage is assigned. If you use a [**Shield**] Gu to reduce damage, the Gu takes that damage to its hitpoints.

If a [**Shield**] Gu would die from sustaining an attack while active, you may use a reaction to deactivate the Gu at 1 hit point, taking the remaining damage to your hit points or another [**Shield**] Gu.

Size

If size is not listed, the Gu is the most common size, [**Tiny**]; that of a large insect. If the Gu is [**Small**] it is the size of a child, and [**Medium**] is the size of a man. [**Large**] Gu take up 4 squares when outside of your aperture, and [**Huge**] Gu take up any area greater than 9 squares.

Size	Modifier to Hit
Tiny	+40
Small	+20
Medium	0
Large	-20
Huge	-40

Steed

A [**Steed**] Gu can be ridden while outside your aperture. While mounted, your movement is replaced with the [**Steed**] Gu's movement statistics.

Supplementary

Supplementary Gu can change the properties of your subsequent activations. When used outside of killer moves, [**Supplementary**] Gu have no effect on Gu of a higher rank than itself. When used as supplementary Gu in a killer move, you will require a number of the same [**Supplementary**] Gu to properly apply the effect equal to 2^(killer move rank - [**Supplementary**] Gu rank).

Supplementary Gu inherit the [**Sustained**] keyword when used to augment [**Sustained**] Gu.

Sustained

You must pay the cost of [**Sustained**] Gu at the start of each of your turns as long as you keep the effect active. Paying the cost does not use one of your activations. While a Gu is being sustained, it cannot be activated (because it is already active). If you are sustaining more than 1 Gu at the same time, take 1 damage to your soul for every Gu being sustained above your **Activations** attribute at the start of each of your turns.

You may stop sustaining a Gu at any time, whether or not it is your turn. If you fall unconscious or are *stunned*, you automatically stop sustaining all Gu. When you stop sustaining a Gu, you cannot activate that Gu again until after the end of your current turn.

Transformation

Gu and, more commonly, killer moves with the [**Transformation**] keyword completely change the body of the user, granting it different attributes. The most common attribute changed is hit points, though some change other attributes like movement and strength. If your hit point or soul maximums are changed by a [**Transformation**] Gu, keep track of how much health or soul you had before the transformation. When the transformation ends, either by being reduced to 0 hit points/soul or by deactivating the Gu, Your attributes return to their state before the transformation, including current hit points/soul. You may only ever be under the effect of one [**Transformation**] Gu or killer move at a time.

If your transformation is reduced to 0 hit points, all Gu involved deactivate and any remaining damage from the attack is dealt to your hit points. If the transformation was permanent and is reduced to 0 hit points, you remain in the transformation and roll to see if you enter *Final Stand* (see Ch. 4, Combat).

Undodgeable

[**Undodgeable**] attacks cannot be avoided by moving, such as with the **Dodge** reaction. A creature can still take the **Dodge** reaction against an [**Undodgeable**] attack, but it will only move them and not avoid the attack.

Unreactable

Attacks made with [**Unreactable**] Gu are too fast for the defender to react in time. When a creature uses a reaction in response to the activation or effect of an [**Unreactable**] Gu, their reaction is delayed until after the Gu's successful activation and application of its effect.

Unrefinable

[**Unrefinable**] Gu exclusively appear naturally in the world. **Refinement** skill tests made to create the recipe of an [**Unrefinable**] Gu automatically fail.

Vital

A Gu Master can only have 1 [**Vital**] Gu at a time. If a Gu with the [**Vital**] keyword dies, the owner of the Gu dies as well. When taking damage from refinement backlash, a [**Vital**] Gu cannot be brought below 1 hit point. The [**Vital**] keyword is applied automatically to the first Gu a Gu Master refines, but you can spend a day in closed cultivation with a new Gu to transfer the [**Vital**] keyword to the new Gu, removing it from your old Vital Gu. When you change your Vital Gu, your current hit points are reduced to 1 as you suffer backlash.

Creating Unique Gu

While I've made an expansive list of many of the Gu paths, in reality there is a basically unlimited number of Gu. Once you're more familiar with the system and balance, you're encouraged to make your own Gu. Here are some guidelines;

- Gu type (attack, guard, celerity, etc.) has no mechanical effect and only exists for easier categorization.
- Rank 5 Gu are at the peak of the mortal realm, and have the power to clear sections of a battlefield single handedly, while rank 1 Gu are sometimes strong enough to kill a person. Keep in mind that a Gu of higher rank should have an advantage over lower ranked Gu.
- The rules already account for the differing primeval essence quality between ranks. Costs are proportional to the power of the Gu within its rank. A rank 1 Gu with a high cost can be similar in strength to a rank 2 Gu with low cost.
- Health is usually only relevant to Gu with the [**Shield**] or [**Steed**] keywords or for refinement. Gu with higher health are more likely to survive backlash from refinement and are thus more viable for improvement. Most Gu should have between 1-6 health, but [**Shield**] Gu start from 40-80 health at rank 1 and scale to 1000-1500 at rank 5.
- Range can be Self, Touch, or a distance in meters.
- Duration can be permanent or have a specified duration. Duration can be in the form of time (minutes/hours/days/years) or with respect to the turn. If the Gu applies an effect for 1 turn, its typically better to say "until the end of your/their next turn." This is because the number of turns remaining on an effect ticks down at the end of the creature's turn; if you buff yourself on your turn, and the duration of the effect is 1 turn, it would disappear at the end of your turn.
- Overall, the strength of the Gu should be relative to all these factors. If it is more expensive in primeval essence, has a short range, eats expensive food, and/or has major drawbacks to its use, the power of the Gu should be increased relatively. This can mean more damage, more health (for [**Shield**] Gu), making the Gu harder to counter, and so on. A Gu that costs 2 portions, eats dirt, and affects 1km better have a much weaker effect than other Gu in its rank. Adding the [**Expendable**] or [**Low Vitality**] keywords can also be used to balance a Gu that's on the stronger side.

Most importantly, be creative! There is a Gu for any purpose you can think of. There are Gu suited to cure any affliction, make any attack, cause any event that you can think of. Some Gu might seem practically useless, but they can always be used to improve some killer move or refine a new Gu.

Compatible Paths

Blood Path: Enslavement Path - Transformation Path - Water Path - Wood Path

Dark Path: Poison Path - Space Path - Theft Path - Transformation Path

Earth Path: Metal Path - Transformation Path - Wood Path

Enslavement Path: Blood Path - Soul Path - Theft Path - Transformation Path

Fire Path: Food Path - Light Path - Lightning Path - Metal Path - Transformation Path - Wind Path

Food Path Fire Path - Poison Path - Strength Path - Transformation Path

Ice Path: Transformation Path - Water Path - Wind Path

Information Path: Rule Path - Transformation Path - Wisdom Path

Light Path: Fire Path - Lightning Path - Sound Path - Transformation Path

Lightning Path: Fire Path - Light Path - Transformation Path - Wind Path

Luck Path: Rule Path - Transformation Path

Metal Path: Earth Path - Fire Path - Strength Path - Sword Path - Transformation Path

Poison Path: Dark Path - Food Path - Transformation Path - Wind Path - Wood Path

Refinement Path: Soul Path - Transformation Path - Wisdom Path

Rule Path: Information Path - Luck Path - Transformation Path

Soul Path: Refinement Path - Transformation Path - Wisdom Path

Sound Path: Light Path - Sword Path - Transformation Path

Space Path: Dark Path - Time Path - Transformation Path

Strength Path: Food Path - Metal Path - Soul Path - Transformation Path

Sword Path: Metal Path - Sound Path - Transformation Path

Theft Path: Dark Path - Enslavement Path - Transformation Path

Time Path: Space Path - Transformation Path - Wisdom Path

Transformation Path: Compatible with all paths

Water Path: Blood Path - Ice Path - Transformation Path - Wood Path

Wind Path: Fire Path - Ice Path - Lightning Path - Poison Path - Transformation Path

Wisdom Path: Information Path - Refinement Path - Soul Path - Time Path - Transformation Path

Wood Path: Blood Path - Earth Path - Transformation Path - Poison Path - Water Path

Enslavement Path

Enslavement path Gu Masters are a huge asset to a clan. In battle, a single enslavement path Gu Master can be worth many other Gu Masters of the same rank, as they use Enslavement Gu to dominate the minds of beasts and even other Gu Masters to be used as a personal army. Enslavement path is an uncommon one to follow, however, as it costs a great deal of resources to maintain an army of beasts.

The unorthodox nature of enslavement path requires its own section in this book; this section will cover using Enslavement Gu, maintaining an army, and directing them on the battlefield. To follow the enslavement path, a Gu Master must have a strong soul foundation or else their results will be very limited.

Enslavement Gu

There are two different Enslavement Gu (not to be confused with Gu of Enslavement Path): - [Beast] Enslavement Gu exist for pretty much all wild beasts; in the Southern Border, wolves and boars are a common target, but some Gu Masters create armies of horses, monkeys, goats, and even birds. [Beast] Enslavement Gu usually cover a specific animal type; Wolf Enslavement Gu can enslave wolves, vermillion flame wolves, shark fin wolves, etc., but they cannot enslave dogs, which are of course enslaved with a Dog Enslavement Gu. - Slavery Gu is used to enslave other humans and variant-humans.

Controlling Your Army

Individuals Commanding individual beasts is tedious and quickly drains the soul. When you individually control a creature, you take its turn for it, and take 1 damage to your soul at the end of its turn. You can choose to individually control any beast that is not part of a horde (beast kings must be individually controlled while part of a horde). If you do not take an enslaved beast's turn, it acts like a wild beast and is under the GM's command, but will usually follow what the horde is doing and never attack friendly creatures.

Hordes If you have at least 100 beasts under your control, they must be separated into *Hordes*. A Horde of beasts has no minimum amount, but each must be led by the proper beast king, enslaved by you. The beast king leading the horde is the *Commander*. The maximum number of ordinary beasts in a horde is listed below:

Hundred Beast King: 100 Thousand Beast King: 1,000 Myriad Beast King: 10,000 Beast Emperor: 100,000 Mutated Beast King: 100 Mutated Beasts of the same type as the *Commander*

- Beast kings of a lower classification can be included in the horde of a greater beast king, but can only be controlled individually.
- Beasts that aren't part of a horde can only be controlled individually.
- In combat, creatures enslaved by you act directly after your turn.

As long as you have at least one beast or Gu Master under your control and within control range, you gain access to the *Direct* **Combat Action**. ### Direct (*Combat Action*) You give up to one order to each of your hordes. At the end of your turn, you take 1d12 damage to your soul for every order given this way.

Orders

Defend The horde stays in its current position, attacking any creatures that enter their square or an adjacent square.

Attack

Killer Moves

When multiple Gu are combined into a single effect it is colloquially known as a killer move. Killer moves have a core of 1 or more same-ranked Gu as well as any number of supplemental Gu.

Blood Vision

Rank 4 Divination Killer Move Core Gu: Rank 4 Blood Sense Gu, Rank 4 Blood Brother Gu Supplementary Gu: Rank 3 Hundred Meter Gu x 2, Total Activations: 4 Activation Cost: 49 portions Keywords: [**Investigative**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Any creatures within 100 meters have their blood tainted with yours. For 24 hours, these creatures are considered your siblings by blood path methods. While this killer move is sustained, you can sense the exact location of any of your blood relatives within 100 meters.

Components of a Killer Move

Core Gu Core Gu are the most important part of a killer move, and determine the main paths, rank, and general effect of the killer move. Looking at the Rank 4 killer move Blood Vision, shown above, It uses Rank 4 Blood Sense Gu and Rank 4 Blood Brother Gu as its core. Blood Brother Gu can turn a creature into your blood relative, and Blood Sense Gu senses the location of blood relatives nearby, so a natural effect would be to both transmute the blood of and sense nearby creatures. These are also both Blood Path Gu, and thus the killer move belongs to Blood Path as well. Finally, the Rank of the killer move is equal to the highest ranked Gu among the killer move's core.

Supplementary Gu Supplementary Gu are used to amplify or mutate the effects of the core Gu. Supplementary Gu can be of a different path and even a higher rank than the core Gu, but do not change the overall rank of the killer move. A Gu with the [**Supplementary**] keyword has a specific effect when used as a supplementary Gu for a killer move. That being said, any Gu can be used as a supplementary Gu as long as you can justify its use and detail its effect on the killer move. These effects should be minor changes to the killer move; If you want to add a Gu that would completely change the nature of the killer move it should go into the Core Gu.

Activations The activations stat is simply the number of Gu in the Killer Move. More complicated killer moves use many Gu and are more taxing on the user's soul. For each Gu over your Activations attribute, your soul takes 1 damage upon activation. Every Gu in the killer move counts towards your number of currently sustained Gu if the killer move has the [**Sustained**] keyword.

Activation Cost The combined primeval essence cost of all Gu in the recipe. This number assumes the user is of the same rank as the killer move. If the user is of a higher or lower rank, adjust the cost accordingly.

Expendable Gu

Gu with the [**Expendable**] keyword can be involved in a killer move even if killer moves themselves cannot have the [**Expendable**] keyword. When you activate the killer move, just expend the [**Expendable**] Gu as if you had activated it.

Shields

If your killer move has the [**Shield**] keyword, you can only assign damage to Gu within the killer move that have the [**Shield**] keyword, and must still follow the damage assignment rules of the [**Shield**] keyword.

Restrictions

Killer moves cannot be constructed around single-use permanent buffs like Beast Strength Gu to make the permanent effect even stronger. Killer moves also cannot have any of the following keywords: [**Defensive**] [**Expendable**] [**Extinct**] [**Fast**] [**Ingredient**] [**Low Vitality**] [**Supplementary**] [**Unrefinable**] [**Vital**]

Deducing a Killer Move

To deduce a killer move, you must have *Fundamental* Attainment in the paths of all Core Gu. You should prepare the killer move with the GM first, making sure both of you agree on the Gu used and the final effect. Once you have the killer move prepared, your character has to then spend time experimenting to create the killer move. This takes 8 hours for each unique Gu in the killer move, whether it is core or supplementary. After spending the requisite time practicing, in a single session or multiple, make a **Deduction** skill test with a +10 penalty for each unique Gu in the killer move beyond 2. If you have a Gu with the [**Deductive**] keyword, you may deduce the killer move using that Gu to improve your skill test. If you succeed, the killer move is created and you immediately invest experience into any paths the Core Gu belong to equal to the sum of the ranks of all Core Gu belonging to that path. If you had deduced Blood Vision for example, you would invest 8 experience into Blood Path.

Activating a Killer Move

Killer moves can be activated with the **Activate a Killer Move** combat action, but can be quite taxing on the soul depending on their complexity. Pick a killer move for which you have all the Gu and enough primeval essence for all activations. For every activation in the killer move over your **Activations** attribute, take 1 damage to your soul. The killer move activates, applying its effect. If the killer move has the [**Sustained**] keyword, you take 1 damage to your soul any time you activate a Gu while sustaining the killer move.

Chapter 4: Combat

Initiative

At the beginning of combat, an initiative is rolled. If an enemy is within 2 meters of you, roll **Close Combat**. If not, roll **Ranged Attack**. The player with the most degrees of success goes first. In the case of ties, the lower number on the die goes first. If this is still tied, creatures controlled by a player go before non player characters. If the tied creatures are all player characters, they decide amongst themselves who goes first; if all are NPCs, the GM chooses. Continue this process for the rest of the combatants.

Surprise

Surprised creatures have a +20 penalty to their initiative roll and cannot take reactions until the start of their first turn.

Stealth

There is no stealth skill in the game. Many Gu render your personal sneaking skills worthless, and so most Gu Masters that wish to walk unobserved will use concealment Gu to do so. In the case either party is not using these Gu, the creature you are trying to sneak past makes an awareness check with a penalty or bonus determined by the GM for the circumstance, including the stealthing party's measures to hide themselves.

The Turn

One turn lasts 10 seconds. Gu Masters recover primeval essence at the beginning of each of their turns.

Start and End of Turn Effects

If you have multiple start or end of turn effects, you choose in what order they resolve. If an effect is applied to a creature for a specified duration, say 3 turns, the number of turns remaining ticks down at the end of the creature's turns, with the effect ending if it hits 0.

Action Economy

Gu Masters can take a **Combat Action**, two **Reactions**, a bonus action, and a movement on each of their turns.

Movement

You can move a number of meters on your turn equal to your movement. 1 meter of movement corresponds to moving 1 adjacent square, including corners. If you have a flying speed, you may forego this movement to execute a number of *Maneuvers* dependent on the flying Gu being used. If you are under the effect of multiple Gu that grant a flying speed, you must choose one Gu and use the flying speed and number of Maneuvers granted by that Gu.

You can move through a [**Small**] or larger hostile creature's square with a successful **Dodge** skill test, but cannot end your turn inside another creature's square (unless they are [**Tiny**]). Failing a **Dodge** skill test made to move through a hostile creature's square expends your remaining movement.

Jumping

Jumping costs half of your movement in meters, rounded up. If your movement is 0, you cannot jump.

Standing Jump From rest, you can jump a maximum of 10% of your athletics skill (rounded down to a minimum of 1) in meters upwards, or 2 meters forwards.

Long Jump If you move at least 1 meter in the direction of your jump before jumping, your forward jumping distance is equal to half your movement, rounded up.

Maneuvers

You may only execute a Maneuver if you have a flying speed. With the exception of *Take Flight*, you must be *airborne* to execute a maneuver. While *airborne*, you make **Dodge** skill tests with your **Flying** skill until you return to the ground, and use your flying speed when dodging. Penalties to your **Dodge** skill tests also apply to **Flying** skill tests made to dodge attacks.

Take Flight Taking flight can only be done when on the ground. You rise a number of meters into the air equal to half your flying speed, rounded down, and are now *airborne*.

Fly You move a number of meters equal to your flying speed in a straight line in any direction.

Dive You must be at least 5 meters above the ground to perform a *Dive*. Make a **Flying** skill test. On a success, you dive down a distance of up to triple your flying speed, and can move up to your flying speed in meters forward. When you finish a *Dive*, you may make a single weapon or punching attack or activate a Gu with a range of touch targeting a creature within your melee range. Whether you do or not, you can try to execute a *Land* maneuver or else rise 1 meter directly upward at the end of the dive.

If you make a weapon or punching attack at the end of your dive, it deals additional force damage equal to your flying speed.

If you fail the test, you dive directly downward a number of meters equal to your flying speed before regaining control. If this would cause you to hit the ground, you do so, are no longer *airborne*, and take 4 force damage for every meter you dove.

Evade Make a **Flying** skill test. On a success, all skill tests made to hit you with an attack are made with a penalty equal to +(your flying skill, rounded down to the nearest ten) until the start of your next turn. You can only make one Evade Maneuver each turn.

Land You land on solid ground. If executed at the end of a dive or atop *Difficult Terrain*, you must succeed a **Flying** skill test or else land *prone*.

Climbing

When climbing a surface, your movement is halved, rounded down to a minimum of 1 meter. If the surface does not have easy handholds like a ladder the GM may call you to make an **Athletics** skill test or else fall.

Swimming

Non-aquatic creatures consider water to be difficult terrain. A creature can hold its breath for a number of minutes equal to 10% of their Fortitude attribute (rounded down) before falling unconscious. If the creature remains unable to breath for the same period of time after passing out, they die.

When a creature enters the water, they gain the *doused* condition.

Difficult Terrain

If a creature is standing in difficult terrain, it costs 2 meters of movement instead of 1 to move to another square.

Combat Actions

Activate Gu

Your Activations can be used to activate Gu as well as to utilize the lingering effects of many Gu, such as directing manifestations. You may activate a number of Gu equal to your **Activations** attribute. You may activate each at any time during your turn, including in the middle of movement, but you cannot activate a Gu when it is not your turn. You may activate the same Gu multiple times, unless you are sustaining it. Using up your activations does not prevent you from activating Gu using your reactions.

Activate a Killer Move

Pick a killer move for which you have all the Gu and enough primeval essence for all activations. For every activation in the killer move over your **Activations** attribute, take 1 damage to your soul. The killer move activates, applying its effect. If the killer move has the [**Sustained**] keyword, you take 1 damage to your soul any time you activate a Gu while sustaining the killer move.

Melee Attack

Weapon Attack Roll a **Close Combat** skill test against an enemy within your weapon's range. On a hit, deal the damage of the weapon, +1 damage for every 20 points you have in Strength. Alternatively, you may forego a weapon attack to throw a weapon with a thrown damage property. Thrown weapons have a range of (5 + 5% of Strength) meters (rounded down).

Multi-Weapon Fighting When wielding more than 1 weapon, you can make a number of melee attacks equal to the number of wielded weapons instead of just 1. If you elect to do so, all melee attacks made have a penalty equal to +(number of attacks * 10). You cannot wield more weapons than you have hands.

Unarmed Strike When you take an unarmed strike combat action, you may make a punch attack for each arm you have, or a single kick attack or bite attack.

Punch: Roll a **Close Combat** skill test against an enemy within 1 meter. On a hit, deal 1 force damage, +1 damage for every 10 points you have in Strength. For every 5 damage dealt, even if it is reduced, you take 1 force damage directly to your hit points. Gu such as Metal Skin Gu and Copper Tendons Gu are typically used to prevent your own strikes from hurting you.

Kick: Roll a **Close Combat** skill test against an enemy within 1 meter. On a hit, deal 1 force damage, +1 damage for every 5 points you have in Strength. If the target is [Large] or smaller, it is knocked backwards a number of meters equal to 1% of your Strength attribute (rounded down, minimum 1) and lands *prone*. Upon striking a creature or object, the target and the creature or object crashed into both take force damage equal to 1% of your Strength attribute (rounded down, minimum 1).

Bite: You viciously bite the target. Roll a **Close Combat** skill test against an enemy within 1 meter. On a hit, deal 2 rending damage, +1 damage for every 5 points you have in Strength. The target is inflicted with *bleeding X*, where X is equal to 20% of the rending damage dealt to their hit points, rounded down (to a minimum of 0).

Called Shot

When you make an attack roll against a creature, you can choose to pick a particular body part, worn or carried item, or manifested body parts like wings as the target of your attack. A called attack roll is made with a penalty based on the size of the target; for an average person, their hands would be tiny, arms and the head are small, and the torso is medium.

Size	Modifier to Hit
Tiny	+40
Small	+20
Medium	0
Large	-20
Huge	-40

Grapple

Select an enemy of equal or lesser size in an adjacent square. Roll an opposed **Athletics** skill test against them. If you win, The creature is *restrained* and now occupies the same square as you while *restrained* in this way. While you are grappling a creature, you may not make kicking attacks and the number of free hands you can make punching attacks with using the **Melee Attack** action is reduced by 1.

You may expend your movement to make an **Athletics** skill test, with a +10 penalty for every 50 kilograms the grappled target weighs. On a success, you can move up to half your movement (rounded down).

As a bonus action, you can throw a target grappled by you as long as your Strength attribute is greater than their weight in kilograms. The distance you can throw them is a number of meters equal to 5% of the difference between your Strength attribute and their weight in kilograms, rounded down to a minimum of 1 meter. If the creature strikes another creature or object besides the ground, both take force damage equal to 3 + 10% of your Strength attribute (rounded down).

As a combat action, a grappled creature can attempt to break free, making an opposed **Athletics** skill test against the grappler. On a success, they break free.

Absorb Primeval Stones

On your turn, you can absorb the essence of a number of primeval stones equal to the number of hands you have. You must have one hand free for each stone being absorbed.

For each primeval stone being absorbed, you gain 5 portions of primeval essence, and the stone is destroyed in the process, crumbling into dust.

Hold an Action

You can choose to hold your Combat Action, specifying an action and a trigger for it to occur. When the trigger happens, you may use a reaction to take that Combat Action. If you are reacting to an opponent's actions, you must make an opposed skill test to see whose action occurs first, with the skill in question being **Close Combat** if within 2 meters of each other, or **Ranged Attack** if not. If you hold the **Activate Gu** action, you may only specify a single activation.

Triggers can be specific or broad, ranging from "when the opponent uses Fire Pellet Gu" to "when a creature makes any hostile moves".

Sprint

Taking the sprint action triples your non-flying movement until the end of your turn.

Reactions

You can react to most actions around you at any time other than during your turn. An exception is that you cannot react to someone activating a Gu, but you can react to them making an attack with one, manifesting an object with it, or applying any other effect. You cannot use multiple reactions to the same trigger, for example, dodging and activating a shield Gu when an attack hits you.

Activate a [Defensive] Gu

[**Defensive**] Gu can be activated as a reaction, including after its determined an attack has hit you, but only before the damage has been dealt.

Dodge

The dodge reaction can be taken when its determined an attack has hit you and before the damage has been rolled. Make a **Dodge** skill test; if you succeed, you successfully dodge the attack and take no damage. If you fail, you are hit and take the full damage of the attack.

When you succeed a **Dodge** reaction, you MUST move at least 1 meter and at most 1/2 your movement (rounded down) in any direction. If you are unable to move, you are also unable to take the dodge reaction. If 1/2 of your movement is insufficient to escape an area of effect attack, you are struck by the attack regardless.

If you use a reaction to dodge for any trigger except an attack hitting you, you immediately move at least 1 meter and at most 1/2 your movement in any direction.

Dodging provokes attacks of opportunity, but they are made with disadvantage.

Parry

The parry reaction can only be taken when its determined a melee attack has hit you and before the damage has been rolled. Make a **Close Combat** skill test with a +10 penalty, opposing the opponent's attack roll. If you win, you take no damage from the attack and can make your own melee attack against the opponent in turn as long as they are within your melee range. You can parry attacks made as part of the parry reaction.

Make an Attack of Opportunity

When a creature moves from inside your melee range to a square outside your melee range, you may make a melee attack as an attack of opportunity. If you make an unarmed attack, it cannot be a kicking attack.

Flying out of a creature's melee range still provokes attacks of opportunity.

Trigger a Held Action

When the trigger you specified upon holding a combat action occurs, you may take this reaction to use said action.

Detonate Gu Worms

As a reaction or for free at any time during their turn, a Gu Master can self-detonate any Gu owned and refined by them with a single thought. The Gu Master must be conscious to do so, and can detonate as many or as few Gu as they want, from any distance. If the Gu is being suppressed, for example by the land spirit of a blessed land, the Gu Master cannot self-detonate it. Otherwise, the chosen Gu instantly die, with no other effects. If the Gu has a self-detonation ability, it does not trigger, since the Gu was not activated.

Bonus Actions

Bonus actions are generally fast and low-effort, such as giving a creature a Gu from your aperture, opening an unlocked door, or pulling a lever.

Damage

When you take damage, subtract that amount from your current Hit Points, to a minimum of 0. When you hit 0 Hit Points, make a **Perseverance** attribute test. On a failure, you are *Dying*. On a success, you enter *Final Stand*.

Damage Types

- Force: Being struck with an object or force, such as Qi; piercing attacks are included but generally have the [**Piercing**] keyword
- Rending: Being cut or slashed.
- Cold: Low temperature attacks
- Heat: Fire and heat
- Poison: Damage taken as long as you are *poisoned* by a source; reduce all poison damage dealt to a creatures hit points by 10% of their Fortitude, rounding down.
- Shock: Electricity damage.
- Sonic: Sound-based attacks that bypass many shield Gu but are quite rare and typically weak
- Direct: Direct damage can be of any damage type and, as the name suggests, deals that damage directly to a creature's hit points. If a source says it deals damage directly to a creature's hit points, the damage cannot be assigned to any active [**Shield**] Gu, but some effects may still reduce it. Damage from bleeding is always direct.

If a source says you take damage to your soul, that number is subtracted from your current soul value; you take no damage to your hit points.

Damage Reduction

Many defensive Gu reduce the amount of damage taken from attacks. When damage is reduced by a flat number, the damage can be reduced to 0 unless the source of the damage is of greater rank than the source of the damage reduction. If

the source of the damage is of greater rank than the source of the damage reduction, the damage can be reduced to a minimum of 1.

Vulnerability

If a creature or object is vulnerable to a damage type, multiply any damage of that type dealt to their hit points by 2. If they have resistance, halve the damage dealt to their hit points, rounding down. If they are invulnerable to a damage type, they do not take the damage at all.

Resistance and invulnerability granted by a Gu can be reduced by Gu of higher ranks. When you take damage of that type from a Gu of higher rank than the one granting invulnerability, you instead are treated as if you had resistance. Similarly, if you only had resistance, you now do not reduce the damage dealt at all.

Immunity

If a creature is immune to a condition, it cannot be applied to them regardless of the rank of the source.

Instant Death

If you take an amount of damage equal to double your maximum hit points from a single source, you instantly die, and do not get to roll to see if you enter *Final Stand*.

Final Stand

While you have the *Final Stand* condition, you cannot move or take combat actions or reactions other than to activate Gu or hold your action to do so. If you take any amount of damage to your hit points while in *Final Stand*, you enter the *Dying* state and fall unconscious. If you gain any hit points while in *Final Stand*, you are no longer in *Final Stand* and can act as normal.

Dying

If you are *Dying*, you are unconscious. At the end of each of your turns, roll a **Perseverance** attribute test. On a success, you gain a **Perseverance Token**. On a failure, you gain a **Predicament Token**. Critical successes and fumbles grant 2 of the respective token. When you have 3 **Perseverance Tokens**, you are no longer *Dying* and instead enter *Final Stand*, and your **Perseverance** token count resets to 0. If you ever have 5 **Predicament Tokens**, you die. **Predicament Tokens** are permanent unless removed by a Gu.

Fall Damage

When falling from a height of more than 2 meters, you take 3 force damage for every meter you fell. If a creature has a flying speed when it becomes *airborne* from anything other than the *Take Flight* Maneuver, it may immediately move up to half its flying speed. If a creature does not have a flying speed when it becomes *airborne,* it immediately falls up to 500 meters. If the creature is still falling, it falls 500 meters at the end of each of its turns until it hits the ground.

Injury

When a creature takes damage to their hit points greater than or equal to half their maximum (rounded down), some damage types apply a special effect.

- Force:

d4	Effect
1 - Broken Arm	Unusable limb
2 - Broken Leg	-4 movement. -4 movement. If both legs are broken, your movement is reduced to 0.
3 - Internal Bleeding	*Bleeding 1*
4 - Concussion	*Dazed.* Cognition reduced by 15 for 3 days.

- Rending: *Bleeding 1*
- Cold: *Fatigued*
- Heat: *Burning*
- Shock: *Dazed*

Called Shot Injuries When you make a called shot and successfully hit a specific body part, if damage is dealt to the creature's hit points they take a corresponding injury.

- Hand: Broken Hand; disarmed and unusable
- Arm: Crippled Limb; Unusable
- Torso: Internal Bleeding; *Bleeding 1.*
- Leg: Crippled; -4 movement. If both legs are crippled, your movement is reduced to 0.
- Head: Roll 1d4

d4	Effect
1 - Brain Damage	Maximum Soul permanently reduced by 50% (rounded down)
2 - Blinded	*Blinded* until the end of their next turn
3 - Hemorrhage	*Bleeding 5*
4 - Concussion	*Dazed.* Cognition reduced by 15 for 3 days.

Natural Recovery

When you sleep, you regain 1 hit point for every hour spent sleeping.

Status Effects

Ablaze

A creature with the *ablaze* condition is completely engulfed in flames. An *ablaze* creature cannot have or gain the *burning* condition. If a creature with the *burning* condition gains the *ablaze* condition, the *burning* condition is removed. At the start of each of their turns, the creature takes 30 heat damage. If a creature takes heat damage to their hit points on a turn from the *ablaze* condition, at the end of the turn they must succeed a **Perseverance** attribute test or else fall unconscious. For creatures and Gu invulnerable or resistant to heat damage, consider damage dealt by the *ablaze* condition to be of the rank of the Gu that applied the *ablaze* condition, or rank 1 if the fire was natural. Being submerged in water removes the *ablaze* condition.

Bleeding X

Bleeding creatures take 1 damage directly to their hit points at the start of each of their turns for every stack of *bleeding*. This damage has no type and cannot be reduced by Gu. Levels of *bleeding* can stack additively from the same or different sources. For every hit point a *bleeding* creature restores, reduce the number of *bleeding* stacks they have by 1.

Blinded

Blinded creatures cannot see, have a +50 penalty to **Close Combat** and **Ranged Attack** skill tests, and cannot make **Awareness** skill tests that rely on sight.

Burning

Burning creatures take 10 heat damage at the start of each of their turns. For creatures and Gu invulnerable or resistant to heat damage, consider damage dealt by the *burning* condition to be of the rank of the Gu that applied the *burning* condition, or rank 1 if the fire was natural. Being submerged in water removes the *burning* condition. A creature can use their combat action to roll around on the ground, removing the *burning* condition.

Dazed

A *dazed* creature's activations stat is reduced by 2. At the end of their turn, they lose the *dazed* condition.

Deafened

A *deafened* creature cannot hear, has resistance to sonic damage regardless of rank, and cannot make **Awareness** tests that rely on hearing.

Doused

When a creature gains the *doused* condition, they immediately lose the *burning* and *ablaze* conditions if they have one of them. A creature with the *doused* condition is vulnerable to shock damage, resistant to heat damage, and immune to the *burning* condition. If a *doused* creature takes heat damage, they lose the *doused* condition. The *doused* condition lasts for 10 minutes.

Fatigued

A *fatigued* creature's movement is reduced by 3 meters and makes all **Dodge** and **Athletics** skill tests with a +20 penalty. The *fatigued* condition lasts until the creature rests for at least an hour.

Poisoned

Poison can have any number of effects, and a creature can gain multiple instances of the *poisoned* condition so long as each is unique.

Prone

A *prone* creature has a +30 penalty to all skill tests and automatically fails all **Dodge** skill tests. **Close Combat** skill tests made to hit a *prone* creature are made with a -10 bonus. **Ranged Attack** skill tests made to hit a *prone* creature are made with a +10 penalty. A creature can expend half their movement to stand up.

Restrained

A *restrained* creature's movement is 0. A *restrained* creature automatically fails all **Dodge** and **Flying** skill tests.

Stunned

A *stunned* creature cannot move or take any actions or reactions. At the end of their turn, they lose the *stunned* condition and gain the *dazed* condition.

Attacks

High Ground

Ranged Attack skill tests are made with a -10 bonus if the target is at least 5 meters lower than you in elevation.

Cover

If a creature is completely hidden behind cover from the attacker, they have full cover and typically are not a viable target for attacks. If the attacker uses a Gu with the [**Piercing**] keyword, however, they can make an attack against an obscured target with a +20 penalty. Divinations that reveal the exact location of a target remove this penalty.

If a creature is only partially obscured by cover, they have partial cover; they are a viable target, but attacks made against them are made with a +10 penalty. If the attacker uses a Gu with the [**Piercing**] keyword, however, there is no penalty to the attack roll.

Touch

You must be within 1 meter of a creature to hit them with an attack with a range of *touch.* Touch attacks can be reacted to, but [**Shield**] Gu do not block touch attacks unless noted in the Gu's description, such as Jelly Bubble Gu. You can target yourself with Touch attacks.

Area of Effect Attacks

When a creature is caught in an area of effect, they can dodge as a reaction, escaping the area of effect if they succeed and can move outside the area of effect.

Line

Lines have a height, width, and length. If the height is not specified, it is the same as the width. Usually, lines originate from a square adjacent to the Gu Master creating it, but some Gu such as Fire Curtain Gu allow the user to choose a source square. In that case, the source and end of the line must both be within the range of the Gu.

Radius

Circular area of effects will originate from a source square and have a radius. If an area of effect has a radius of 5 meters, it will effect the source square and any square that could be reached using 5 meters of movement from the source square. This translates to a square with a side length of 11 meters.

Chapter 5 - Southern Border

Culture

Geography

Notable Mountains

Wan Cheng Peak Wan Cheng Peak is less than 10 kilometers from Tie Clan, and atop it is built the Demon Suppression Tower. Demon Suppression Tower is a prison hundreds of meters tall and houses thousands of demonic path Gu Masters. It has metal path Gu formations protecting it from attacks. Most prisoners are subdued with the rank 3 Aperture Lock Gu, but rank 4 and even rank 5 Gu Masters are suppressed through an assortment of different methods.

San Cha Mountain San Cha Mountain is a collection of 3 peaks that rise into the sky like a pitchfork, with the middle mountain being the tallest. The area has some resources, and is often fought over by the Zuo and Che Clans. Unbeknownst to anyone, it is also the site of a combined inheritance belonging to three rank 5 Gu Masters, the Three Kings Inheritance. When the inheritance activates, pillars of light visible from across Southern Border shoot into the sky periodically from each peak, transporting potential inheritors from the peaks into the inheritance.

The Three Rivers

Jade Dragon River

Red Dragon River

Yellow Dragon River

Super Clans

Ba Clan

Chi Clan

Fei Clan

Shang Clan

Tie Clan

"Our Tie clan, since it was established, had been world-renowned for our bravery, unswerving determination and our iron-cold justice. For many generations, Tie clansmen had been upholding justice and striking down on criminals, in this course, countless people have shed blood and sacrificed their lives. The youths that have died here won't be the first and also won't be the last." - Tie Mu Bai, Ch. 370

Tie Clan stands as a central pillar to the Southern Border righteous path. Their investigators are deployed to solve crimes across the entire continent, and thousands of demonic path Gu Masters guilty of vicious crimes are locked up in Tie Clan's **Demon Suppression Tower** atop Wan Cheng Peak.

Wu Clan

Wu clan is known as the top force in Southern Border, led by rank 5 Strength Path Gu Master Empress Wu Ji.

Goods

Commerce

The marketplace breathes life into a continent dotted with tens of thousands of isolationist clans. Caravans owned by Shang Clan's many vassals travel millions of miles across Southern Border like a system of blood vessels, visiting a vast majority of the continent's clans. The caravan system disperses newly discovered Gu, beasts, and recipes into the economy, and great importance is placed on it by all Southern Border's righteous path. Robbing caravans is dangerous, and even the successful thieves are often hunted down by heroes or bounty hunters.

Makeup of a Caravan

Caravans vary greatly in size, but the smallest generally have 200 people. Shang Clan regulations require at least one rank 3 Gu Master on every caravan, but larger caravans are guarded by a rank 4. More Gu Masters are hired, split into teams, and assigned to sections of the caravan. The rest of the caravan's population is made up of mortals and slaves, used for menial labor. Rank 1 Gu Masters are given auxillary roles, as the dangers posed to a caravan are often more than they can handle.

Refinement Recipes

Refinement recipes have a listed market value, but that doesn't necessarily mean the recipe is worth that amount. The market value assumes that this recipe is not available anywhere and there are no extenuating circumstances. But if you have a new recipe for Dog Enslavement Gu when the Three Kings Inheritance opens, the actual selling price will shoot up. Once you sell it the first time, however, the price will naturally go down somewhat. You can sell the same recipe as many times as you want, after all. Generally, the selling price is reduced by 75% every time it is sold.

Refinement Materials

Areas attuned with with the natural Dao generate plants, animals, stones, and other materials infused with a miniscule amount of Dao. These materials can be used to feed or refine Gu, and the areas that produce these materials are coveted by organizations and individuals. There also exist immortal refinement materials with higher amounts of Dao, but these materials are priceless compared to mortal materials and significantly rarer.

Blood Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit	Rank
Crimson Willow Bark			
Hemorrhage Soil			
Hundred Beast King Blood			2
Thousand Beast King Blood			3
Myriad Beast King Blood			4
Mutated Beast Blood			4
Beast Emperor Blood			5
Mutated Beast King Blood			5

Dark Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit
Deep Onyx		

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Earth Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit	Rank
Gruel Mud			
Soft Purple Clay			
Rotting Swamp Mud			

Enslavement Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit
Luring Spruce Pheremone Gland		

Fire Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit
Smoldering Stones	10	kg

Ice Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Information Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Light Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Lightning Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Luck Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Metal Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Poison Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit
Golden Centipede Toxin	30	mL
Flower of Paradise Earth	400	flower

Refinement Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Rule Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Soul Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Sound Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Space Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Strength Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Sword Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit
Cutting Edge Grass	30	blade

Theft Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Time Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Transformation Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Water Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Wind Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Wisdom Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Wood Path:

Refinement Material	Cost (PS)	Unit

Gear

Armor

Armor is seldom seen in the Gu world, except when used by mortals. Armor is heavy and lacks the defensive strength of even some Rank 1 Gu, and thus has little demand. Still, some Gu Masters will use the effects of Gu to augment their armor for better protection.

When wearing armor, you gain a penalty to your **Dodge** rolls, but can soak up a bit more damage. Armor has a damage threshold and health statistic. Any force or rending damage dealt to you is reduced by the armor's damage threshold. Any force or rending damage dealt in excess of the damage threshold is dealt both to your hit points and to the armor's hit points. If the armor reaches 0 hit points, it breaks and becomes unusable.

Armor	DT	HP	Dodge Penalty	Movement Penalty
Leather Armor	4	20	+10	–
Iron Armor	8	32	+30	-1
Shield	4	15	–	–

Weapons

Most weapons used by Gu Masters are manifested by Gu, but many Gu can improve the effects of common weapons. If a weapon has a V under its "hands" attribute, it can be wielded in one or two hands, taking the former or latter damage number depending on how many you are wielding it with.

Weapons with a range longer than 2 meters are considered ranged weapons. When you attack with them, you roll **Ranged Attack** instead of **Close Combat** and do not add your strength to the damage. You make attacks with ranged weapons at disadvantage if the target is within 1 meter of you. Thrown weapons have a range of (5 + 5% of Strength) meters (rounded down).

Weapon	Damage	Range	Hands	Thrown Dmg
Knife	8 rending	1 meter	1	6 rending
Sword	12/15 rending	1 meter	V	–
Spear	10/16 force	1 meter	V	10 force
Staff	6 force	2 meters	2	–
Bow	6 force	12 meters	2	–

Beasts

There are an uncountable number of different beast species across Southern Border. Some of the more common ones are listed below. Beast statblocks are somewhat different than Gu Master statblocks. Beasts are missing several skills and attributes that they are incapable of using. As they do not have a Perseverance, when beasts reach 0 hit points they immediately die. They also do not have luck points, nor an aperture, and as such cannot activate Gu. Stronger beasts will have wild Gu worms living on or inside of them, however, and these Gu act independently, usually to assist the beast they live within. When the beast is in dire straits, however, most wild Gu will simply leave and try to escape.

Wild Gu on a beast king can choose to activate one time at any point on the beast's turn, or in reaction to a trigger if the Gu could ordinarily be activated as a reaction to the triggering effect.

Iron Beak Crane Swarm

Swarm of Ordinary Beasts

CR: 11

Immune to: *prone*, *restrained*

Attributes	
HP	60
Soul	20
Movement	4, 10 Flying
Strength	20
Agility	55
Fortitude	25
Cognition	5
Wisdom	30
Attitude	5

Skills	
Close Combat	40
Ranged Attack	10
Athletics	44
Dodge	55
Awareness	30

Combat Actions |

Multiattack. *Melee Attack, 1 meter* The Iron Beak Crane Swarm attacks 2 creatures within range (reduced to 1 if the Iron Beak Crane Swarm is below half its maximum hit points or soul). On a hit, deal 12 force damage. | Bonus Actions | **Swarm.** The Iron Beak Crane Swarm mobs a 2 meter radius (reduced to 1 if the Iron Beak Crane Swarm is below half its maximum hit points or soul) until the start of its next turn. All creatures in the area have the *blinded* condition and take 4 force damage at the start of each of their turns.

Iron Beak Crane (Hundred Beast King)

CR: 11

Attributes	
HP	45
Soul	6
Movement	5, 12 Flying

Attributes	
Strength	20
Agility	55
Fortitude	25
Cognition	25
Wisdom	40
Attitude	5

Skills	
Close Combat	60
Ranged Attack	10
Athletics	44
Dodge	55
Awareness	30

Combat Actions |

Beak. *Melee Attack, 1 meter* The Iron Beak Crane drills a target with its beak. On a hit, deal 12 force damage.

Wild Gu Roll 2d6 (rerolling duplicates) 1 - None

2 - Rank 1 Bullet Gu

3 - Rank 1 Copper Tendons Gu

4 - Rank 1 Golden Bell Gu

5 - Rank 1 Iron Needle Gu

6 - Rank 1 Silver Lining Gu

Iron Beak Crane (Thousand Beast King)

CR: 14

Attributes	
HP	80
Soul	10
Movement	5, 12 Flying
Strength	20
Agility	60
Fortitude	25
Cognition	40
Wisdom	40
Attitude	10

Skills	
Close Combat	75
Ranged Attack	10
Athletics	40
Dodge	60
Awareness	30

Combat Actions |

Beak. *Melee Attack, 1 meter* The Iron Beak Crane drills a target with its beak. On a hit, deal 20 force damage.

Wild Gu Roll 2d6 (rerolling duplicates) 1 - None

2 -

3 -

4 - Rank 2 Golden Bell Gu

5 -

6 -

Lightning Wolf

Ordinary Beast

CR: 0

Attributes	
HP	30
Soul	2
Movement	8
Strength	20
Agility	55
Fortitude	35
Cognition	5
Wisdom	30
Attitude	5

Skills	
Close Combat	45
Ranged Attack	10
Athletics	44
Dodge	55
Awareness	30

Combat Actions

- **Bite.** *Melee Attack, 1 meter* The lightning wolf bites a target. On a hit, deal 6 rending damage. If this damage is dealt to the target's hit points, they gain *bleeding 1.*

Lightning Wolf (Hundred Beast King)

CR: 14

Attributes	
HP	50
Soul	9
Movement	10
Strength	90
Agility	65
Fortitude	50

Attributes	
Cognition	5
Wisdom	30
Attitude	5

Skills	
Close Combat	50
Ranged Attack	10
Athletics	77
Dodge	65
Awareness	30

Combat Actions

- **Bite.** *Melee Attack, 1 meter* The lightning wolf bites a target. On a hit, deal 20 rending damage. If this damage is dealt to the target's hit points, they gain *bleeding 4.*
- **Pounce.** *Melee Attack, 3 meters* The lightning wolf expends half of its movement to jump on a creature. The target and the lightning wolf make an opposed **Athletics** skill test. If the lightning wolf wins, the target is knocked *prone.*

Wild Gu Roll 2d4 (rerolling duplicates)

1 - No wild Gu

2 -

3 -

4 -

Undead

Roaming Zombie

Attributes	
HP	80
Soul	-
Movement	5
Strength	70
Agility	20
Fortitude	80
Cognition	5
Wisdom	5
Attitude	5

Skills	
Close Combat	30
Ranged Attack	5
Athletics	55
Dodge	20
Awareness	5

Combat Actions **Multiattack.** The roaming zombie makes 2 **Claw** attacks.

Bite. *Melee Attack, 1 meter* The roaming zombie bites a target. On a hit, deal 15 rending damage.

Claw. *Melee Attack, 1 meter* The roaming zombie slashes a target. On a hit, deal 8 rending damage and apply the *poisoned* condition with the following effect:

- You take 4 poison damage directly to your hit points at the start of each of your turns

This effect lasts for 1 minute.

Features The Roaming Zombie is immune to mind manipulating effects.

The Roaming Zombie regains 8 hit points at the start of each of its turns.

The Roaming Zombie has immunity to the *bleeding*, *fatigued*, and *posioned* conditions.

The Roaming Zombie has vulnerability to heat and shock damage.

While exposed to direct light, the Roaming Zombie suffers a +20 penalty to all skill tests.

Gu Index

Gu are listed alphabetically by the path they belong to.

Blood Path

Blood path Gu often cost little to feed and are easy to refine, though many recipes require slaughter at huge scales. Its attack methods are brutal, and Blood Path is considered one of the strongest offensive paths. Hundreds of thousands of inheritances were left by a Rank 7 Gu Immortal, Blood Sea Ancestor, all over the Gu world. The righteous path shuns the evil and demonic methods of blood path, and many practitioners live imprisoned in Tie clan's demon suppression tower.

It's worth noting that an ordinary human has about 5 liters of blood in their body.

Blood Battle Gu

One of the lesser inheritances of the Blood Sea Ancestor contains Blood Battle Gu. Repeated use can cull a whole battlefield.

Rank 5 Attack

Cost: 150 portions

Range: 100 meters

Health: 2

Food: A 100,000 liter pond of human blood in a hole dug in Hemmorhage Soil

Effect: You rupture the hearts of all *bleeding* creatures within range. They have a chance to react before they instantly die. Immediately following, make 3 attack rolls for each creature affected. The range of these attacks is 15 meters, measured from the original target or the square they were in when they died. On a hit, deal 80 rending damage. If damage is dealt to a creature's hit points in this way, they gain *bleeding 5*. If the damage kills the target, you may make an additional 3 attack rolls with the same properties and measured from the square the target was in when they died.

Blood Blade Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Cost: 4 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 3

Food: 3 liters of blood

Effect: Your body shudders as a hundred wounds appear all over it. You take 8 unmitigatable rending damage directly to your hit points, and your blood streaks out like swords; all creatures within range take 100 rending damage, doubled against creatures grappling you or being grappled by you. If damage is dealt to a creature's hit points in this way, they gain *bleeding 2*.

Blood Brother Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 35 portions

Range: 1 meter

Health: 4

Food: 1 liter of mixed blood either from siblings or a parent and their child

Effect: Select a creature within range. As long as both you and them have an open wound, your blood twists and mingles in the air before shooting into each other's veins. You and the target are now permanently considered siblings by blood path methods.

Blood Demon Flower Gu

Rank 4 Carver

Cost: 35 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: 50 liters of blood Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Sustained**], [**Transformation**]

Effect: The roots of the blood demon flower pierce your flesh and wind around your limbs, and a great red flower sprouts from your head. Your flesh wrinkles and clings to your bones.

While sustained, you gain the following effects:

Your maximum hit points are 250.

Your movement is reduced by 2 meters.

You are not affected by any [**Dao**] Gu applied to your **Muscular System** or individual **Muscles**.

As a bonus action, you can burrow your roots into a corpse and consume its blood to regain 30 hit points.

When you use a combat action to make an unarmed melee attack, instead of striking with your fists you may extend your roots and attack up to 5 times. Your root attack range is 5 meters, and your root attacks deal 50 rending damage. If damage is dealt to a creature's hit points in this way, they gain *bleeding 3*.

At the end of each of your turns, make a **Perseverance** attribute test with a +20 penalty. On a failure, you gain

a **Blood Demon Flower Token** and your body becomes corrupted. If you ever have 10 **Blood Demon Flower Tokens**, your body is permanently transfigured into a blood demon flower.

As long as you have 9 or fewer **Blood Demon Flower Tokens**, every month you go without activating Blood Demon Flower Gu reduces the number of **Blood Demon Flower Tokens** you have by 1.

Blood Filter Gu

Rank 1-5 Tonic

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You immediately remove all instances of the *Poisoned* condition applied by Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower. After activating Blood Filter Gu, you vomit a brown clump of blood and toxins and cannot use reactions until the start of your next turn.

Blood Handprint Gu

Rank 5 Manifestation

Cost: 80 portions

Range: 50 meters

Health: 2

Food: 120 severed hands soaked in the blood of a beast emperor.

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: You manifest a [**Large**] 2 meter tall hand made of blood mist in an unoccupied square within range. While sustained, you may move the hand up to 10 meters through occupied or unoccupied squares as a bonus action or activation. Any creatures whose squares are moved through by the hand take 200 force damage. If this damage is dealt to their hit points and they have blood in their body, they turn into a puddle of blood and die.

Blood Hatred Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Blood Hatred Gu must be submerged in the blood of a single creature to be activated. All creatures within range must succeed a **Perseverance** attribute test with a +10 penalty or else gain a **Hatred Token**. Affected creatures have a dislike for the family line of the creature whose blood was used to activate Blood Hatred Gu. A creature with 3 tokens will refuse to consort with any members of the bloodline, while a creature with 5 tokens will seek to kill them on sight.

A creature can have up to 5 **Hatred Tokens** for a single bloodline.

Blood Pouch Gu

Rank 1-5 Container

Cost: 1 portion

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: {1, 4, 9, 16, 25} liters of blood

Effect: Activating Blood Pouch Gu while it is in a pool of blood causes the blood to be sucked inside the Gu, up to {10, 20, 100, 500, 50,000} liters. Otherwise, you can activate it to pour out any amount of blood. If blood from multiple creatures is contained inside Blood Pouch Gu, it gets mixed and loses properties such as blood relation.

Blood Qi Gu

Rank 1-3 Tonic

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: 1 liter of blood each from 3 unrelated humans

Effect: The target of this effect must have an open wound. You pour blood infused with qi into the wound, restoring {6, 15, 45} hit points to the target and restoring their blood.

Blood Rain Gu

Rank 3 Manifestation

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 1 kilometer

Health: 4

Food: 1 still beating heart

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Dense red clouds manifest high above you in the sky. Blood pours from them in a thick and warm hurricane,

covering the ground within range with a total of 1,000,000 gallons of blood.

Blood Sense Gu

Rank 2-5 Divination

Cost: 12 portions

Range: {1, 10, 100, 1000} kilometers

Health: 2

Food: {4, 9, 16, 25} liters of blood

Keywords: [**Investigative: Detect**]

Effect: You immediately sense the exact location of any creatures related to you by blood within range.

Blood Skull Gu

Rank 4-5 Carver

Cost: 90 portions

Range: 100 meters

Health: 1

Food: 10 liters of blood

Effect: You immediately absorb the blood of any dead creatures related to you by blood within range. For every {100, 10} corpses drained in this way, you gain 1% aptitude, up to a maximum of 99%. The corpses must have been dead for less than 24 hours.

Blood Steps Gu

A dark crimson cicada with no legs. When active, Blood Steps Gu burrows into the leg muscles.

Rank 3 Celerity

Cost: 9 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 3 liters of blood

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your movement is increased by 3 meters. Any squares you walk through while Blood Steps Gu is active become covered in slick blood and are *Difficult Terrain*. You also now stand and walk on blood as if it were solid ground, and can walk through bloody puddles created by Blood Steps Gu as if they were normal terrain.

Blood Substitution Gu

Rank 2 Manifestation

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: 100 g of dried blood

Effect: You create 10 liters of black blood around your feet that can be manipulated as if it were real blood by other Gu.

[**Upgrade Path: Bloodstained Robe Gu**]

Bloody Fabric Gu

Rank 3 Container

Next Rank: Bloody Visage Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 2 meters

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of silk soaked in blood (10 primeval stones)

Effect: Up to 50 liters of blood within range is pulled in a vortex towards you. It condenses into a tattered bloody robe around your body. Activate Bloody Fabric Gu again to destroy the robe, releasing the stored blood all around you.

If a *bleeding* creature is within range when you activate Bloody Fabric Gu, it takes 25 rending damage and you drain 100 milliliters of their blood for every level of *bleeding* they have.

If an ordinary human loses 2 liters of blood, they fall unconscious and are dying.

Bloody Visage Gu

Rank 4 Guard

Previous Rank: Bloody Fabric Gu

Next Rank: Bloodstained Robe Gu

Cost: 30 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of thousand beast king bloodsucker moth silk

Effect: Up to 50 liters of blood within range is pulled in a vortex towards you. It condenses into a bloody robe around your body that defends you from attacks. For every point of damage you take, the robe expends 100 milliliters of blood and you instead take no damage. If you activate the Gu while already wearing a robe created by Bloody Visage Gu, it can

only pull in enough blood to restore itself to the maximum of 50 liters.

If a *bleeding* creature is within range when you activate Bloody Visage Gu, it takes 25 rending damage and Bloody Visage Gu drains 200 milliliters of their blood for every level of *bleeding* they have.

If an ordinary human loses 2 liters of blood, they fall unconscious and are dying.

Bloodstained Robe Gu

Rank 5 Guard

Cost: 8 portions

Range: 25 meters

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of ten thousand beast king bloodsucker moth silk

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Up to 100 liters of blood within range is pulled in a vortex towards you. It condenses into a magnificent bloody robe around your body that defends you from attacks. Whenever you take damage, if the damage is less than 10 it is instead reduced to 0. For every 10 damage you take, the robe expends 1 liter of blood and you instead take no damage. While sustained, Bloodstained Robe Gu pulls blood within range as soon as it becomes available.

If a *bleeding* creature is within range when you activate Bloodstained Robe Gu and at the beginning of every turn while you sustain it, that creature takes 25 rending damage and you drain 500 milliliters of their blood for every level of *bleeding* they have.

When you stop sustaining Bloodstained Robe Gu, the robe remains on your body and still defends you from attacks, but no longer pulls nearby blood into itself.

If an ordinary human loses 2 liters of blood, they fall unconscious and are dying.

[**End**]

Bloody Veil Gu

Rank 1-4 Concealment

Cost: 45 portions

Range: 1 meter

Health: 2

Food: {4, 9, 16, 25} liters of blood from widowed women

Effect: A 1 meter radius sphere of rotating blood surrounds you. For 10 minutes, all creatures inside the sphere become undetectable to [**Investigative**] Gu of rank {2, 3, 4, 5} or less. The veil of blood is still visible, but makes no sound.

Flesh Bone Gu

Rank 3 Tonic

Cost: 80 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 1

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You touch a creature or corpse and its body instantly regenerates all missing body parts. If it is alive, it regains 30 hit points.

Man-Beast Life Burial Gu

Man-Beast Life Burial Gu is very useful for a rank 2 Gu Master wanting to reach rank 3. Unfortunately, its refinement recipe involves feeding a maiden Gu Master to a beast through the use of Beast Enslavement Gu.

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: 2 liters of virgin blood

Effect: Immediately convert 100 portions of your primeval essence into an equal number of portions of black steel primeval essence. Keep track of your current black steel primeval essence portions separately from your other portions of primeval essence. The sum of your natural and black steel primeval essence can never exceed your maximum primeval essence.

Black steel primeval essence cannot be used for any purpose other than to attack rank 2 aperture walls; each portion counts as 10 portions of primeval essence when used to cultivate. Every day at midnight, if you still have at least 1 portion of black steel primeval essence, your aptitude is permanently decreased by 1%.

Rising Dead Gu

Rank 4 Tonic

Cost: 250 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: You touch the fully intact corpse of a creature dead for no longer than 14 hours. The dead creature is returned to life at its maximum hit points.

Staunch Bleeding Gu

Rank 1 Tonic

Cost: 12 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: 5 cubic centimeters of skin

Effect: Reduce the number of *bleeding* stacks from a creature you touch by 3.

Thick Blood Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Self

Health: 6

Food: 100 g dried blood

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Blood** is permanently modified to coagulate much quicker than normal. Whenever you gain the *bleeding* condition, reduce the number of stacks of *bleeding* you receive by 1, to a minimum of 0. At the end of each of your turns, reduce the number of stacks of *bleeding* you have by 1, to a minimum of 0.

Vein Burst Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 2 meters

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Target creature within range has some of their blood vessels burst, taking 8 rending damage directly to their hit points.

A large quantity of Vein Burst Gu are required to refine the legendary Blood Battle Gu.

Dark Path

Subtle; the best concealments belong to Dark path. Marginally better defense than offense.

Dark Gu

Rank 1-5 Concealment

Cost: 20 portions

Range: {1, 2, 6, 20, 500} meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Space within range is filled with an inky, impermeable darkness while sustained. [**Investigative**] Gu of rank {2, 3, 4, 5, 5} and lower cannot see through darkness created by Dark Gu.

Dark Toss Gu

Rank 1-5 Concealment

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You touch a Gu and Dark Toss Gu wraps itself around it. Both that Gu and Dark Toss Gu cannot be detected by [**Investigative**] Gu at or below the rank of Dark Toss Gu. Dark Toss Gu can be deactivated by touching it and expending 1 portion of primeval essence.

Multiple Sword Shadow Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A fan of shadow swords fly sporadically in a line 6 meters wids and 10 meters long. Creatures in the area take 100 rending damage. Creatures have a +30 penalty on dodge tests made to avoid this attack. If this damage was dealt to their hit points, they gain *bleeding 6*.

Moonshadow Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Cost: 40 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 9

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Make an attack roll against a Gu Master within range. On a hit, their primeval sea is tainted and has only a quarter effectiveness, costing them 4 times as many portions to activate Gu as normal. To remove this effect, the defending Gu Master must empty their primeval sea completely.

Overlapping Shadow Gu

Rank 4 Catalyst

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Supplementary**]

Effect: The next time you activate a Dark Path attack Gu before the end of your turn, it deals double the damage it normally would. If the Gu has the [**Sustained**] keyword, its damage is only doubled until the start of your next turn.

Second Shadow Gu

A pitch black leafbug.

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 30 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: After the sun sets, your shadow permanently splits in two. You permanently have a second shadow, even in direct sunlight, extending 2 meters from you in a direction of your choosing, which you can change as an Activation on your turn. Creatures in contact with your Second Shadow are considered to be in your touch range and have a +30 penalty to **Dodge** skill tests made to dodge your touch attacks.

Shadow Bond Gu

Rank 2 Guard

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Choose a creature within range. While sustained, whenever you take damage to your hit points, if the target is within range they take the same damage directly to their hit points. If the creature leaves range, Shadow Bond Gu remains active and connected to the target, but temporarily stops reflecting damage.

Shadow Dog Pocket Gu

Rank 2-3 Container

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your shadow becomes the door to a pocket dimension that only living creatures can enter or exit. You may open and close the entrance at will, but it requires a creature to expend half of its movement to enter or exit. Your shadow pocket can hold up to {2, 5} [Medium] creatures or {1, 2} [Large] creatures. Creatures can remain inside indefinitely, but still require nourishment.

Shadow Follower Gu

Rank 2 Concealment

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: 2 eyeballs from any creature (1/4 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you are enveloped in an inky darkness. As long as you are not in direct light, you are invisible.

Sheep Clothes Gu

Rank 2 Concealment

Cost: 8 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Supplementary**]

Effect: Your next Gu activation effect is shrouded in a silhouette. If a Gu Master has not seen and identified the shrouded effect, they must make a **Knowledge (Gu)** skill test with a +30 penalty or else fail to identify the Gu being used.

Soul Cloak Gu

Rank 1-5 Concealment

Cost: 3 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your soul is shrouded and undetectable to [**Investigative**] Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower while sustained.

Split Shadow Gu

Rank 2-5 Manifestation

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A clone of yourself appearing like a black cloud splits from your body to an unoccupied square within 1 meter of you. When it splits from you, you can give it up to {1, 2, 3, 5} Gu from your aperture and any number of portions of primeval essence. The clone goes directly after you in initiative and is controlled by you. The clone shares all of your statistics, except that it has no soul or Strength attributes, has {1, 2, 3, 5} activations, and cannot physically interact with anything in the world. When you stop sustaining Split Shadow Gu, the Gu carried by your clone drop to the ground and you lose whatever primeval essence the clone still had.

Breath Concealment Gu

Rank 3-5 Concealment

Cost: None

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: 1 hour of direct sunlight

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: If your current rank is equal to or below the rank of Breath Concealment Gu, the aura of your primeval essence is suppressed to a rank and stage of your choosing below your own cultivation while sustained. Your primeval essence's outward appearance remains as it was, however, so effects that glimpse inside your aperture will see your true cultivation. Sustaining Breath Concealment Gu does not count towards your number of currently sustained Gu.

Earth Path

Great supporting path, allowing the manipulation of a battlefield. Well balanced between offense and defense.

Crystal Ladybug Gu

Rank 1 Container

Cost: 7 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Small**]

Effect: Crystal Ladybug Gu drinks up to 10 liters of liquid it is submerged in, filling its crystal belly.

Pushing your finger into Crystal Ladybug Gu's head causes it to expel any amount of stored liquid (depending on how hard you press).

[**Upgrade Path: Diaoyu Fortress Gu**]

Stoneflesh Gu

Rank 1 Guard

Next Rank: Stoneskin Gu

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your flesh is transmuted into a dense bedrock. You cannot move or be moved from your square, and whenever you take damage to your hit points, reduce the damage dealt by 15.

Stoneskin Gu

Rank 2 Guard

Previous Rank: Stoneflesh Gu

Next Rank: Mountain Pass Gu

Cost: 16 portions

Range: Self

Health: 80

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your skin is transmuted into a dense bedrock. Stoneskin Gu has invulnerability to rending damage and cannot block sonic damage. Reduce all force damage dealt to Stoneskin Gu by 15.

Mountain Pass Gu

Rank 3 Guard

Previous Rank: Stoneskin Gu

Next Rank: Diaoyu Fortress Gu

Cost: 70 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Choose two 10 meter long, 1 meter wide lines. Large stones burst from the ground in the lines; any creatures that do not dodge are knocked *prone* to a random side of the line. The rocks are 5 meters tall and creatures have a +40 penalty to **Athletics** skill tests made to climb them. Dealing 50 hit points worth of damage to a square filled with rocks destroys them in that square, and the rocks have all damage dealt to them except sonic reduced by 100.

While you remain within 2 meters of the square you originally activated Mountain Pass Gu, reduce all damage dealt to your hit points by 50. The rocks are permanent but the effect ends after 1 hour.

Diaoyu Fortress Gu

Rank 4 Guard

Previous Rank: Mountain Pass Gu

Cost: 120 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**]

Effect: Dense stone walls rise in a 5 meter by 5 meter square perimeter, centered on your square. Any creatures occupying a square the walls rise in that do not dodge are knocked *prone* to a random side of the wall. The walls are 3 meters high and **Athletics** skill tests made to climb them are made with a -10 bonus. While you are within the perimeter, including on top of the walls, you have resistance to all damage except for sonic and reduce all damage dealt to your hit points by 75. The walls are permanent but the effect ends after 1 day.

[**END**]

Granite Bones Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 30 portions

Range: Self

Health: 15

Food: 1 kg granite (2 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: You are assailed with a horrendous pain for 1 hour. You are incapable of taking any actions except to speak for the entire duration. When the process is complete, your **Bones** are permanently transmuted into granite. Your bones can no longer be broken by damage or effects originating from a Gu of Rank 3 or lower. Additionally, reduce all force damage dealt to your hit points by 16.

Granite Knuckle Cockroach Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: The knuckles on your **Hands** are permanently transformed into thick granite plates. Your punching attacks deal an additional 12 force damage, and you gain the following unarmed attack option:

Crush: You slam your fists into either side of the target's head. Make a **Close Combat** skill test. On a success, deal 12 force damage, +1 damage for every 10 points you have in Strength.

Life-retaining Jade Coffin Gu

Rank 5 Manifestation

Cost: 80 portions

Range: Self

Health: 15

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A jade coffin appears around you, sealing you inside. It cannot move on its own and weighs 500 kg in addition to your weight. Damage dealt to you is dealt to the coffin instead. The coffin has 2000 hit points, and all damage dealt to it is reduced by 100. You cannot move or activate Gu while inside, but can still speak. Your lifespan is not consumed over time while inside the coffin, and pushing the lid off the coffin from the inside ends the effect.

Quake Step Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 5 portions

Range: 2 meters

Health: 11

Food: 1 kg mound stone (2 primeval stones)

Effect: You stomp, and the ground quakes; all creatures standing on solid ground within range of you must succeed an **Athletics** skill test with a +10 penalty or else be knocked *prone*.

Rice Pouch Grass Gu

Rank 1 Manifestation

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 15

Food: 1 kg water

Effect: Rice Pouch Grass Gu fills iteself with 5 kg of long blades of rice.

Stealth Rock Gu

Rank 1 Concealment

Cost: 1 portion

Range: Self

Health: 18

Food: 100 g of hard stone (1/4 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your body is invisible, but anything you are wearing or carrying remains visible.

Stone Aperture Gu

Rank 1-3 Catalyst

Cost: 1 portion

Range: Self

Health: 16

Food: {1kg, 10kg, 100kg} of talc ({1, 10, 100} primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: As long as you are of the same rank as Stone Aperture Gu, your **Aperture** walls shatter and are replaced with an unbreakable stone wall. Your cultivation immediately rises to peak stage, but you can no longer raise your rank through cultivation.

Tremor Sense Gu

Rank 1-3 Divination

Cost: 2 portions

Range: {5, 10, 20} meters

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you can sense the exact square a creature within range moves to as long as they are touching the ground. You also gain immunity to the *deafened* condition.

Thousand-Li Earthwolf Spider Gu

Rank 5 Celerity

Cost: 1 portion

Range: Self

Health: 500

Food: 1000 kg of ordinary soil

Keywords: [**Large**], [**Steed**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Thousand-Li Earthwolf Spider Gu has a base movement of 10 meters and can climb on walls and ceilings without making an **Athletics** skill test. Additionally, Thousand-Li Earthwolf Spider Gu has a digging speed of 3 meters in stone or soil. While sustained, Thousand-Li Earthwolf Spider Gu's movement becomes 50 meters and its digging speed becomes 15 meters.

Enslavement Path

Enslavement Path involves the enslavement of many beasts and controlling them to overwhelm an enemy. An army of beasts can be a nearly unstoppable force, but this path notably has 2 weaknesses; the huge logistical cost of feeding the beasts, and the fact that the enslavement path Gu Master will often times be targeted for assassination.

[**Beast**] Enslavement Gu

Rank 1-5 Carver

Cost: {5, 15, 40, 90, 200} portions

Range: 20 meters

Health: 3

Food: {10, 30, 90, 300, 1000} kg of [Beast] Flesh

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: Target a [Beast] that you can see within range. [Beast] Enslavement Gu flies from your aperture in a straight line towards the target. Gu can be activated as a reaction if they make a targeted attack roll to hit [**Beast**] Enslavement Gu en route. If the Enslavement Gu successfully reaches its target, you attempt to dominate its mind, as long as the target's beast classification is at or below the rank of the Enslavement Gu:

- Rank 1: Ordinary Beasts
- Rank 2: Hundred Beast Kings
- Rank 3: Thousand Beast Kings
- Rank 4: Myriad Beast Kings and Mutated Beasts
- Rank 5: Beast Emperors and Mutated Hundred Beast Kings

You and the target have a battle of souls. If your current soul value is greater than the beast's, subtract the beast's current soul value from your own and you successfully permanently enslave it. You can now control its actions with your mind from a distance of up to (Maximum Soul) meters, as long as you can see it.

If the target is willing to be enslaved, they fail the battle of souls automatically and your soul takes no damage.

If your current soul value is less than or equal to the beast's, you fail to enslave it, the beast's current soul value is reduced by your current soul value, and then your current soul value is reduced to 1.

Beholder Gu

Rank 1-3 Divination

Cost: 5 portions

Range: {20, 250, 1,000} meters

Health: 6

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your left eye glows with a blue light as you connect telepathically with a beast enslaved by you that you can see within range. While sustained, you gain all observable information available to the target's left eye as long as they are within range. Your right eye remains normal, and continues intaking visual information in front of you. Your left eye swivels in unison with the target's, moving automatically and sometimes uncomfortably. You have one fewer reaction each turn from focusing on two sets of visual data.

Bonded Collar Gu

A collar made of whispy shadow, it's hard to see exactly where it begins or ends. Once accepted by a creature, an ethereal leash flickers out from the user's hand and ties itself to the collar before both fade and disappear. The creature is embued with some of your own soul, and will never turn against you.

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 60 portions

Range: 2 meters

Health: 3

Food: 1 kg crimson akita wolf flesh (15 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: Target an ordinary beast of CR 24 or lower within range. Your maximum Soul is permanently reduced by 5; the target is enslaved by you (see Enslavement Path, Ch. 3), raised to a Hundred Beast King, and its maximum soul is increased by 5. As part of this process, you may transfer the effect of a Gu with the [**Dao**] keyword from your body to the target's, as long as the target is not under the effect of a [**Dao**] Gu of an incompatible path.

Chain of Command Gu

A queen ant connected via fleshy tendrils to 10 smaller solider ants.

Rank 3-4 Catalyst

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 10 Meters

Health: 3

Food: A living creature kept as a pet for more than 10 days.

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, a chain bursts from your fingertips and latches to a willing creature within range. When you activate Chain of Command Gu and at the start of each of your turns while sustained, you may activate a Gu from your aperture of rank {3, 4} or less without using an activation, treating the effect as if it were activated by the chosen creature. Alternatively, the creature performs a melee attack against a creature you can see within range without using a combat action. Afterwards, the creature takes 3 damage to its soul.

False Aperture Gu

Rank 1-5 Carver

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: The aperture of a rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} Gu Master.

Effect: You create a false aperture and bond it to a creature that you touch. The creature must not have an aperture and cannot awaken an aperture while under the effects of False Aperture Gu.

The false aperture can store {1, 1, 1, 2, 2} Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower, and up to 100 portions of primeval essence of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower. You may infuse the aperture with primeval essence by touching the creature as a combat action and expending the number of portions taken.

After creating a false aperture in this way, False Aperture Gu can no longer be activated until it is fed.

Houndmaster Hivemind Gu

Rank 2-4 Catalyst

Cost: 15 portions

Range: {6, 12, 25} meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Supplementary**]

Effect: Pick a creature enslaved by you that you can see within range. Your next Gu activation this turn costs double the primeval essence. As long as the Gu does not have the [**Expendable**] or [**Steed**] keywords, its effect is duplicated, treating the targeted creature as the source of the second activation. You may pick the target for targeted effects.

Last Breath Gu

A ghastly vulture with ethereal wings and a bloody beak.

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 100 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Low Vitality**]

Effect: Last Breath Gu's beak unhinges as it eats the head of a human or variant human that died due to your direct actions within the last hour. A shadowy maw emerges from the neck as the corpse rises from the dead as a Roaming Zombie (see Bestiary) under your control. The Roaming Zombie can percieve its surroundings in a 10 meter radius despite not having eyes, but permanently has the *deafened* condition. Its bite attacks deal an additional 4 damage to the target's soul.

You may control the Roaming Zombie in the same way as other enslaved creatures. If you do not directly control the Roaming Zombie, it wanders about its surroundings and attacks any creatures besides you that it comes across.

Nurturing Nest Gu

Rank 4 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: 100 g of soul-soothing incense (50 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Aperture** is permanently modified to provide a nurturing environment for the souls of your enslaved creatures. You can store up to 3 enslaved [Medium] or smaller beasts directly within your aperture. While stored, they do not require food and regain hit points at double the natural rate. You may stow or withdraw a beast in an adjacent square as a bonus action.

Pack Leader Gu

Rank 2-5 Attack

Cost: 50 portions

Range: 20 meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You howl, shaking the surroundings. All creatures within range with less than {4, 10, 25, 80} current soul becomes submissive, laying *prone* and ceasing all hostilities. This effect lasts for 1 minute, and ends on a creature if you attack it.

As long as a beast can hear the howl and has classification at or under the rank of Pack Leader Gu, they become frightened and attempt to flee the area, unless they are submissive.

- Rank 1: Ordinary Beasts
- Rank 2: Hundred Beast Kings
- Rank 3: Thousand Beast Kings
- Rank 4: Myriad Beast Kings and Mutated Beasts
- Rank 5: Beast Emperors and Mutated Hundred Beast Kings

If you attempt to enslave a submissive creature using Slavery Gu or [Beast] Enslavement Gu, you only subtract half of the creature's current soul (rounded down) from your current soul.

Powerful Presence Gu

A scorpion, too fat for its legs to reach the ground.

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: A self-portrait of the owner of the Gu

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Brain** is permanently carved with Enslavement Path dao; you find it easier to find the right words in conversation and manipulate others to your point of view. Your Attitude attribute is increased by 10 points.

Slavery Gu

Rank 1-5 Carver

Cost: {20, 50, 120, 250, 400} portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: Target a Gu Master of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or less that you can see within range. Slavery Gu flies from your aperture in a straight line towards the target. Gu can be activated as a reaction if they make a targeted attack roll to hit Slavery Gu at any point en route. If Slavery Gu reaches its target, you both have a battle of souls. If your current soul value is greater than the Gu Master's, subtract the Gu Master's current soul value from your own and you successfully permanently enslave them. You can now directly control their actions with your mind from a distance of up to (Maximum Soul) meters, as long as you can see them. They are still the same person, retaining their memories and general personality, but become wholly devoted to you, willing to do whatever you command to the highest possible standard. While directly controlling them, you can choose to take the target's turns for them; otherwise they act in whatever way they think is most helpful to you.

If the target is willing to be enslaved, they fail the battle of souls automatically and your soul takes no damage.

If your current soul value is less than or equal to the Gu Master's, you fail to enslave it, the Gu Master's current soul value is reduced by your current soul value, and then your current soul value is reduced to 1.

Stealth Pheremone Gu

Rank 3 Concealment

Cost: 3 portions

Range: 4 meters

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, the scents of creatures within range are undetectable to Thousand Beast Kings, Hundred Beast Kings, ordinary beasts, and [**Investigative**] Gu of rank 3 or lower.

Unfinished Business Gu

A purple monarch butterfly.

Rank 1-2 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: 8 Meters

Health: 7

Food: 1 g of determination glass (2 primeval stones)

Effect: Unfinished Business Gu can only be activated as a reaction to a creature you can see making a **Perseverance** attribute test. That creature gains a {-10, -20} bonus to its **Perseverance** attribute test.

Fire Path

Explosive and very offensive. Movement type Gu use quick bursts of movement, and attacks often apply burning or ablaze to bypass shield gu.

Boiling Blood Gu

Rank 2 Tonic

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 8

Food: 1 liter of blood from a fire path beast

Effect: You immediately regain 10 hit points and 2 soul strength.

Blazing Lotus Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 60

Range: Self

Health: 6

Food: 1 blazing lotus petal (150 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Expendable 3**]

Effect: The dao marks carved into your body by Gu with the [**Dao**] keyword are set ablaze. For 1 hour, you are assailed with a burning pain and have a +40 penalty to all skill tests. When the duration elapses, you lose all effects granted by Gu with the [**Dao**] keyword, unless that Gu belongs to Water Path or Ice Path.

Blazing Shield Gu

Rank 2 Manifestation

Cost: 7 portions

Range: Self

Health: 14

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**], [**Medium**]

Effect: While sustained, a shield of obsidian and magma appears in an unoccupied square adjacent to you. If a projectile passes through the shield's square, the shield negates the attack entirely, taking the damage of the attack to its hit points (if the attack deals damage). If the projectile was created by a Gu of rank 3 or higher, the shield is destroyed and does not negate the attack. The shield has 20 hit points and is invulnerable to heat damage.

Burning Heart Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: You permanently etch fire path dao into your **Heart**. You no longer suffer ill effects from cold temperatures and are invulnverable to cold damage. Whenever you take heat damage to your hit points, reduce it by 15.

Changbai Clouds Gu

Rank 2 Manifestation

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 6 meters

Health: 3

Food: 1 kg of obsidian (1/2 primeval stone)

Effect: Choose a square within range. All squares within 2 meters of the chosen square are covered in a scalding, dense, unbreathable smog. Creatures cannot see through the smog, and attacks made against creatures hidden by smog are made with disadvantage. If a creature starts its turn inside the clouds, they take 8 heat damage.

At the start of each of your turns, the smog spreads to nearby squares, increasing its radius by 2 meters, to a maximum of 10. When the radius reaches 10 meters, the smog no longer deals damage. The smog dissipates over the course of 10 minutes, and strong winds can disperse the smog early.

Clearing Heat Gu

Rank 2 Tonic

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Immediately remove all instances of the *poisoned* condition from yourself inflicted by a Gu of rank 2 or lower. You may activate Clearing Heat Gu as a reaction to gaining the *poisoned* condition.

Eight Burning Eyes Gu

Rank 1-3 Divination

Cost: 8 portions

Range: {5, 15, 50} meters

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Six white orbs appear on your face in a spider-eye pattern. While sustained, you can see all creatures with heat signatures within range, even through barriers.

Ember Armor Gu

Rank 2-3 Guard

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: {90, 190}

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Sustained**], [**Shield**]

Effect: A flaming carapace covers your body. While sustained, you are immune to the *burning* and *ablaze* conditions. Heat and rending damage dealt to Ember Armor Gu are reduced by {10, 30}, to a minimum of 0. Ember Armor Gu cannot block sonic damage.

Ember Butterfly Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 16 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 8

Food: 100 g of smoldering stone (1 primeval stone)

Effect: You lob a burst of embers at a square within range. Creatures within 1 meter of the square take 3 heat damage and gain the *burning* condition. Ignites flammable objects in its radius.

Eruption Salamander Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 70 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: All creatures within range with the *burning* condition immediately take 10 heat damage directly to their hit points and gain the *ablaze* condition.

All creatures within range with the *ablaze* condition immediately explode, taking 20 heat damage directly to their hit points. Creatures adjacent to a creature that explodes take 10 heat damage and gain the *burning* condition.

Fire Arrow Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 8 portions

Range: 12 meters

Health: 11

Food: 1 liter of pitch (2 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Piercing**]

Effect: Shoot a flaming arrow at a target within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 10 heat damage and 10 force damage. Ignites flammable objects it hits.

Fire Curtain Gu

Rank 2 Manifestation

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 6 meters

Health: 20

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Manifest a wall of fire 1 meter wide, 2 meters high, and up to 6 meters long in a line originating from a square you can see within range. Creatures in the area take 25 heat damage and gain the *ablaze* condition. Creatures take 25 heat damage and gain the *ablaze* condition if they move into or end their turn in the fire.

Fire Discharge Gu

Rank 1-2 Celerity

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 8

Food: {1, 5} liters of pitch ({1, 5} primeval stones)

Effect: An explosion thrusts you {5, 20} meters in a straight line in a direction of your choice. If a creature is in the square directly opposite the line when you activate Fire Discharge

Gu (i.e. behind you if you are traveling forward), that creature takes {10, 30} heat damage. **Dodge** skill tests made to avoid this attack are made with a +10 penalty.

If you collide with a creature during this movement, you stop at the square before theirs and you both take {3, 10} force damage. As a reaction to colliding with a creature, you may make a melee attack against that creature or activate a Gu with a range of touch, targeting that creature.

Fire Lance Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 5 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 16

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Piercing**]

Effect: Launch a lance of fire at a target within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 10 heat damage, or 25 heat damage if the target is *burning* or *ablaze*.

Fire Pulse Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 20 portions

Range: 8 meters

Health: 13

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You release a pulse of fire in a straight line. All creatures in a 1 meter wide, 8 meter long line take 10 heat damage and gain the *burning* condition.

Fire Spark Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 8 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 7

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You shoot a small spark of fire at a target within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 8 heat damage. Ignites flammable objects it hits.

Fire Step Gu

Rank 1 Celerity

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 9

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your movement is increased by 2 meters and you leave scorched earth in your wake. Every square you pass through while Fire Step Gu is active becomes covered in flames until the start of your next turn, causing any creature that starts their turn in or passes through an affected square to take 5 heat damage and gain the *burning* condition. Ignites flammable objects.

Fireball Gu

A glimmering red icosahedron that dimly radiates heat.

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 8

Food: 100 g of bat guano mixed with sulfur

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: A 4 meter radius sphere, centered on a square you can see within range, blossoms into a roiling fireball. All creatures in the sphere take 8d6 heat damage and gain the *ablaze* condition.

Firebrand Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 60 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 10

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Carve fire path dao into a weapon or creature for 1 hour. The weapon (or the creature's fists) catches fire and deals an additional 10 heat damage on a successful melee attack as well as inflicting the *burning* condition.

Firefly Swarm Gu

Rank 1 Manifestation

Cost: 5 portion

Range: 25 meters

Health: 8

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Manifest a swarm of fireflies in 2x2 square area within range while sustained. The swarm gives off bright light for 25 meters, and can occupy the space of other creatures. If a creature is in the same square as the swarm, they have a +10 penalty to all skill tests. You can move the swarm up to 10 meters to a point within range as a bonus action or activation on your turn.

[**Upgrade Path: Five Door Fire Pagoda Gu**]

Charcoal Gu

Rank 1 Manifestation

Next Rank: Double Decker Stove Gu

Cost: 1 portion

Range: Self

Health: 12

Food: 1 kg charcoal

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you radiate a comfortable heat in a 1 meter radius around you.

Double Decker Stove Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Previous Rank: Charcoal Gu

Next Rank: Three Door Fire Hut Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 2 meters

Health: 15

Food: 10 kg charcoal (1/2 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Sustained**], [**Defensive**]

Effect: While sustained you take 10 heat damage directly to your hit points at the start of each of your turns, and heat damage dealt to you is negated and stored inside Double Decker Stove Gu. At the end of each of your turns, some stored heat bursts from your body, dealing 1/2 the stored damage (rounded down) to all creatures within range. Double Decker Stove Gu can store up to 100 heat damage, but negates heat damage dealt to you even if it is full. When you stop sustaining Double Decker Stove Gu, the stored damage reverts to 0.

Three Door Fire Hut Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Previous Rank: Double Decker Stove Gu

Next Rank: Four Door Fire Tower Gu

Cost: 20 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 15

Food: 1 kg ever-burning coals (300 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A blazing hut with 3 closed doors manifests around you. While sustained, a door opens at the start of each of your turns. You may use an activation to unleash a wave of heat from an open door at a target you can see within range. On a hit, deal heat damage equal to 20 times the number of open doors and apply the *burning* condition. Each door can only attack once per turn.

Four Door Fire Tower Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Previous Rank: Three Door Fire Hut Gu

Next Rank: Five Door Fire Pagoda Gu

Cost: 25 portions

Range: 20 meters

Health: 15

Food: 10 kg ever-burning coals (300 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A translucent square tower with a closed door on each side manifests around you. While sustained, a door opens at the start of each of your turns. You may use an activation to unleash a wave of heat from an open door at a target you can see within range. On a hit, deal heat damage equal to 40 times the number of open doors and apply the *burning* condition. Each door can only attack once per turn.

Five Door Fire Pagoda Gu

Rank 5 Attack

Previous Rank: Four Door Fire Tower Gu

Cost: 20 portions

Range: 50 meters

Health: 15

Food: 100 g imperial phoenix feathers (15,000 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Sustained**], [**Undodgeable**]

Effect: While sustained, a magnificent pagoda with 5 closed doors manifests around you. If at least one door is unopened, target a creature you can see within range at the start of each of your turns. A door opens, and that creature is engulfed in flame, taking heat damage equal to 150 times the number

of open doors and gaining the *ablaze* condition. While all 5 doors are open, multiply heat damage you deal from any source by 5 (not including the attack made by the fifth door).

[**END**]

Flame Binding Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 10

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You attack a target within range with a whip of fire. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 16 heat damage and the target gains the *burning* and *restrained* conditions. As a bonus action on their turn, the affected creature can make an **Athletics** skill test with a -10 bonus. On a success, they lose both conditions applied by Flame Binding Gu.

Flame Tongue Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Cost: 5 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 15

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You lash out with a tongue of flame towards a target within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 30 heat damage and the target gains the *burning* condition.

Flame Veil Gu

Rank 1 Guard

Cost: 1 portion

Range: Self

Health: 10

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A thin veil of flame surrounds you. While sustained, reduce all heat damage dealt to your hit points by 10, to a minimum of 0.

Immolate Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A creature you touch gains the *ablaze* condition.

Kerosene Gu

Rank 1 Manifestation

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 5m

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You lob a ball of kerosene to a square within range. Creatures within 1 meter of the square become splattered in oil until it gets washed off. If a creature covered in oil takes heat damage or gains the *burning* condition, it gains the *ablaze* condition.

Lightning Charged Potato Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

Effect: Lightning Charged Potato Gu must be buried in any kind of soil before activation. It sprouts roots into the nearby earth and becomes firmly lodged in place. After 1 minute of growth, Lightning Charged Potato Gu is armed. If any creature, including you, steps on a square within 1 meter of Lightning Charged Potato Gu, Lightning Charged Potato Gu explodes, instantly dying and dealing 10 force damage, 10 heat damage, and 10 shock damage to creatures within 2 meters of Lightning Charged Potato Gu, increased to 20 force damage, 20 heat damage and 20 shock damage to creatures within 1 meter.

Lightning Charged Potato Mother Gu

Rank 3 Manifestation

Cost: 60X

Range: Self

Health: 25

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Lightning Charged Potato Mother Gu sprouts, creating X Rank 2 Lightning Charged Potato Gu.

Scorch Palm Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Your palm ignites with intense heat. A creature you touch takes 16 heat damage.

Smoldering Cloak Gu

Rank 1 Guard

Cost: 14 portions

Range: Self

Health: 50

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Sustained**], [**Shield**]

Effect: While sustained, a cloak of smoldering embers surrounds you. Any creature that hits you with a melee attack takes 8 heat damage and gains the *burning* condition. You gain immunity to the *burning* and *ablaze* conditions as long as they originate from a Gu of rank 1, and any heat damage dealt to Smoldering Cloak Gu is reduced by 10, to a minimum of 0. Smoldering Cloak Gu cannot block sonic damage.

Sprinting Drake Gu

Rank 2-3 Attack

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: {25, 80}

Food: 1 kg ever-burning coals (30 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Steed**], [**Medium**]

Effect: Sprinting Drake Gu has a speed of 4 meters. While riding it, you can move through hostile creatures' space (but cannot end your turn in their space). If you do, they take 10 heat damage and gain the *burning* condition. When you activate Sprinting Drake Gu while riding it, it immediately sprints up to {5, 20} meters in a straight line; moving through a creature's space with this movement deals 20 heat damage instead of 10 and applies *ablaze* instead of *burning*.

Temper Soul Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Self

Health: 7

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your maximum soul is permanently increased by 8.

[**Upgrade Path: Vengeful Sun Gu**]

Flaming Fist Gu

Rank 1 Catalystk

Next Rank: Coiled Flame Snake Gu

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: 1 liter of boiling blood

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your punching attacks deal an additional 4 heat damage.

Coiled Flame Snake Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Previous Rank: Flaming Fist Gu

Next Rank: Springing Dragon Gu

Cost: 8 portions

Range: 1 meter

Health: 4

Food: 100 g flame snake venom (10 primeval stones)

Effect: Coiled Flame Snake Gu can only be activated as a reaction to being hit by an attack made by a creature in an adjacent square. You immediately counterattack with a springing jump and chop. Make a **Close Combat** skill test with a -20 bonus against the creature that attacked you. On a hit, deal 15 force damage and 15 heat damage, and an additional 1 force damage for every 10 points you have in Strength.

Springing Dragon Gu

A maroon larvae with the beginnings of wings growing under its back.

Rank 3 Attack

Previous Rank: Coiled Flame Snake Gu

Next Rank: Vengeful Sun Gu

Cost: 20 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 3

Food: 1 kg flame drake scales (40 primeval stones)

Effect: Springing Dragon Gu can only be activated as a reaction to being hit by an attack made by a creature within range. You jump to an unoccupied square adjacent to them and deliver a flaming kick. Make a **Close Combat** skill test with a -40 bonus against the creature that attacked you. On a hit, deal 30 force damage and 45 heat damage, and an additional 1 force damage for every 5 points you have in Strength. The target gains the *burning* condition, and if the target is [Large] or smaller, it is knocked backwards a number of meters equal to 1% of your Strength attribute (rounded down, minimum 1), landing *prone*.

Vengeful Sun Gu

A golden cicada that radiates bright light in a 30 meter radius.

Rank 4 Attack

Previous Rank: Springing Dragon Gu

Cost: 40 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 3

Food: 1 flame drake heart (1,500 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

Effect: Vengeful Sun Gu can only be activated as a reaction to being hit by an attack made by a creature within range. A pillar of plasma envelopes them for a split second. They take 200 heat damage and gain the *ablaze* condition.

[**END**]

Food Path

An uncommon path to cultivate, Food Path's greatest strength for mortals is to reduce the financial burden of feeding Gu. That being said, it excels at feeding Gu, humans, and beasts alike, and Food Path Gu Masters are highly sought after by organizations.

Appetizer Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Ingredient**]

Effect: A meal you prepare gains an appetizer. Affected creatures may expend a reaction when they roll for initiative to activate a single Gu.

Bed of Rice Gu

Rank 1-3 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: 1 kg of rice (1/4 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Ingredient**]

Effect: A meal you prepare becomes more filling, allowing it to feed {1, 3, 8} additional creatures.

Big Smoke Tea Gu

Rank 1 Catalyst

Cost: 1 portion

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: You become intoxicated, leaking small amounts of smoke from your mouth and nose. For the next 4 hours, you have a +20 penalty to all skill tests and feel woozy. This effect is harmless but addictive.

Caramelized Roots Gu

Rank 1 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 6

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Ingredient**]

Effect: A meal you prepare is infused with the flavor of caramelized onion and ginger. Affected creatures gain advantage on skill tests made to resist being moved from their square.

Eating Wind Gu

Rank 2 Guard

Cost: 30 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**]

Effect: Eating Wind Gu has no effect unless there are heavy winds around you. If the wind was natural or created by a Gu of rank 2 or lower, the wind is consumed, possibly negating the effect. Eating wind in this manner completely satisfies your appetite.

Eat Strength Gu

Rank 4 Carver

Cost: 50 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: Consume a creature with at least 50 Strength using Eat Strength Gu

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: For the next hour, anything you eat is consumed by Eat Strength Gu. If Eat Strength Gu consumes all the flesh of a creature, its flesh is converted into Strength Path dao and carved into your **Muscular System**. Your Strength attribute is increased by 5% of the consumed creature's Strength attribute (rounded down, to a minimum of 0). You may gain up to 1000 Strength from Eat Strength Gu across any number of uses.

Fillet Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 12 portions

Range: 1 meter

Health: 4

Food: 1 kg of fish bones (1/4 primeval stone)

Effect: A spectral fillet knife appears in your hand as you attempt to prepare cuts of meat from a creature, slicing flesh directly off the bone. Make a called shot attack roll against a creature within range. If you hit, the target takes 20 rending damage. If this damage is dealt to their hit points, you apply an effect depending on where they were hit:

Head: You pluck the target's eyes from their skull. They gain the *blinded* condition until their eyes are restored.

Torso: You slice open the target's belly, allowing their blood to drain. The target gains *bleeding 10*.

Arm: You fillet the target's flesh from their arm. The target must succeed a **Perseverance** attribute test or else fall unconscious. The target gains *bleeding 3* and the arm is unusable.

Hand: You remove the extremity. The target loses the hand and gains *bleeding 5*.

Leg: You fillet the target's flesh from their leg. The target must succeed a **Perseverance** attribute test or else fall unconscious. The target's movement is reduced by 4 meters (minimum of 1) and they gain *bleeding 3*.

Foot: You remove the extremity. The target's movement is reduced by 4 meters (minimum of 1) and they gain *bleeding 5*.

Heavenly Flavor Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Ingredient**]

Effect: A meal that you prepare is imbued with heavenly flavor, improving the moods of everyone that consumes it. Affected creatures have their Attitude attribute increased by 10.

Liquor Worm Gu

Rank 1-4 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: 1 kg wine (1/4 primeval stone)

Effect: Liquor Worm Gu has no effect unless you have rank {1, 2, 3, 4} initial stage, middle stage, or upper stage cultivation. You immediately gain one refined portion of primeval essence of the stage above your own. Keep track of your current refined portions separately from your other portions of primeval essence. The sum of your natural and refined primeval essence can never exceed your maximum primeval essence.

Expending 1 portion of refined primeval essence is equivalent to expending 2 portions of unrefined primeval essence.

If your cultivation increases while you have refined primeval essence, it becomes unrefined primeval essence or disappears if it would exceed your maximum primeval essence.

Omniscient Salad Gu

Rank 5 Catalyst

Cost: 300 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 1

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**], [**Ingredient**], [**Investigative: Detect**]

Effect: You add Omniscient Salad Gu to a meal that you prepare. Affected creatures know everything that happens within 25 meters of themselves. They can react to [**Unreactable**] Gu as if they did not have the [**Unreactable**] keyword

Rabbit Feet Gu

A green stalk, from which grows 3 rabbit feet.

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable 3**], [**Ingredient**]

Effect: You break a rabbit's foot off of Rabbit Feet Gu and add it to a meal that you prepare. Affected creatures gain 1 maximum and current luck point.

Snack Gu

Rank 1-5 Manifestation

Cost: {2, 5, 20, 50, 150} portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Snack Gu secretes a small glob of paste that any Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower can eat. Each glob replaces 5% of the feeding cost of the Gu, up to a maximum of 50% each feeding. If the Gu being fed is of a lower rank than Snack Gu, only one glob is required to replace 50% of the feeding cost.

Spicy Sea Pickle Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Ingredient**]

Effect: A meal you prepare is made spicy and salty. Affected creatures gain the *Fundamental Fire Path Attainment* and *Fundamental Water Path Attainment* talents.

Stave Hunger Gu

Rank 1 Catalyst

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 5

Food: 500 grams of leather

Effect: A Gu that you touch can go 1 extra day without being fed before dying. This effect ends when the Gu is fed, and can not be used on the same Gu more than one time between feedings.

Tactful Tongue Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Brain** is permanently carved with Food Path dao. You gain a -20 bonus to **Knowledge (Gu)** or **Knowledge (Southern Border)** tests to identify the ingredients of anything you taste, and you can immediately detect if something you are eating or drinking is poisoned.

Human Path

Very rare and mysterious. The Legends of Ren Zu, a common myth, is a Human Path inheritance of deep profundity. All ***Refinement*** *skill tests made to create or improve recipes for Human Path Gu are made with a +40 penalty.*

Hope Gu

Hope Gu naturally occur all over the Gu World, gathering by the hundreds in special areas sacred to all Gu Masters.

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: None

Range: Self

Health: 1

Food: Natural primeval essence (does not need fed)

Keywords: [**Expendable**], [**Unrefinable**]

Effect: Hope Gu cannot be activated or refined. Hope Gu attaches to the body of the first human or variant-human it comes across without an aperture. After 1 hour of the first Hope Gu attaching, the creature's aperture awakens with 1% aptitude for every Hope Gu attached to it. The maximum number of Hope Gu that can be attached to a creature is different for every creature and determined by the Gamemaster, with a maximum of 99. If a creature awakens their aperture with 19 or fewer Hope Gu attached to them, the awakening fails, and the creature cannot ever again awaken their aperture using Hope Gu.

Lifespan Gu

Lifespan Gu are extremely rare, produced by Heaven's Will according to the current deficits and surpluses in the world. Lifespan Gu are impossible to refine, and even a rank 1 Lifespan Gu is worth great fights between mortals and immortals alike.

Rank 1-5 Catalyst

Cost: 3 portions

Range: Self

Health: 1

Food: Naturally occuring Heaven Qi (does not need fed)

Keywords: [**Expendable**], [**Unrefinable**]

Effect: Your lifespan is increased by {50, 100, 300, 500, 1000} years.

Man Triumphing Heaven Gu

Rank 5 Catalyst

Cost: 50 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 2

Food: Naturally occuring Human Qi (does not need fed)

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: A human or variant-human that you touch immediately awakens their aperture. The Gamemaster picks an aptitude for the newly awakened aperture. Man Triumphing Heaven Gu has no effect if the target already has an aperture.

Primeval Elder Gu

Primeval Elder Gu appears to be an old man sitting on a cloud meditating. When it contains few primeval stones, it has a frown that slowly grows into a smile as stones are added.

Rank 3-4 Container

Cost: None

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: {1, 10} kg of cloud soil ({40, 400} Primeval Stones)

Effect: You take or stow any number of primeval stones into or out of Primeval Elder Gu. Primeval Elder Gu can hold up to {100,000, 1,000,000} primeval stones.

Relic Gu

A star shaped polyhedron that glints in the light. The color of Relic Gu corresponds to the color of primeval essence of the same rank: Green copper, red steel, white silver, yellow gold, and purple crystal. Relic Gu are extremely valuable, allowing for rapid advancement in cultivation. Relic Gu cannot be refined, and are instead produced by Heaven's Will. While similar to lifespan Gu in that way, Relic Gu are significantly more abundant.

Rank 1-5 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: (Rank) portions of primeval essence

Keywords: [**Expendable**], [**Unrefinable**]

Effect: If your rank is the same as the rank of Relic Gu, and you are currently at initial, middle, or upper stage, your aperture walls immediately shatter as your cultivation rises by one small realm. If not, there is no effect.

Trials and Tribulations Gu

Rank 4 Catalyst

Cost: 100 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: 5 portions of rank 5 primeval essence.

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your current **Predicament Token** count is reset to 0.

Ice Path

Chilling and freezing enemies is of course included, but the true use of Ice Path is to control and move heat. Most methods deal cold damage and apply fatigued, but a few Gu deal heat damage and can even set people on fire. Blend of offense and defense.

Blue Ice Skin Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: 1 kg of permafrost

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Skin** is permanently chilled and turns a pale, wintry blue over the course of an hour. You gain immunity to the *burning* condition and reduce all heat damage dealt to your hit points by 5. Any creature that hits you with an unarmed melee attack takes 2 cold damage.

Cold Lungs Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Self

Health: 6

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Lungs** are permanently modified to exhale sub-zero air. Your breath is always visible as a white mist. As a combat action, you may exhale freezing air in a line 2 meters wide and 5 meters long. All fires in the area are extinguished, and all creatures in the area lose the *burning* and *ablaze* conditions.

Heat Sap Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 8

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you sap the heat of nearby creatures; if a creature starts its turn within range, it takes 20 cold damage. If this damage was dealt to their hit points, they gain the *fatigued* condition.

Heat Transference Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 12 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 6

Food: 100 g of smoldering stone (1 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Undodgeable**]

Effect: You transfer the heat from your own body into a target within range. You take 4 cold damage directly to your hit points.

Creature: They take 15 heat damage directly to their hit points.

Flammable object: It bursts into flames, inflicting the *burning* condition on a creature holding or wearing it.

Metal object: It glows red hot for 1 minute. A creature holding the object must succeed a **Perseverance** attribute test or else drop the object. If the object is worn or carried by a creature, that creature takes 15 heat damage at the start of each of their turns. The object cools down after 1 minute.

Hibernation Gu

Hibernation Gu is a 1 foot tall bear. If it is sleeping, that means someone is under its effects.

Rank 3 Tonic

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 16

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Small**]

Effect: You touch a willing creature and their body chills to subzero temperatures. They fall *unconscious* and Hibernation Gu curls up and goes to sleep. After 24 hours, the creature in hibernation fully restores its hit points, and all of the target's ailments caused by Gu of rank 3 or lower are cleansed. You may reactivate Hibernation Gu at any time to awaken the target. If you are the target, the only action you may take while unconscious is to activate Hibernation Gu and wake yourself up. A target under the effects of Hibernation Gu remains loosely aware of their surroundings. If Hibernation Gu dies, the target awakens immediately.

Ice Muscles Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 50 portions

Range: Self

Health: 9

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: You are assailed with a piercing pain for 1 hour while your **Muscular System** is transfigured into ice muscles. For the duration, you can take no actions except to speak. When the ritual completes, you are permanently immune to the *fatigued* condition if it is being applied to you by an Ice Path Gu or as a result of taking cold damage. Additionally, your Strength attribute is permanently increased by 10, and any rending or force damage dealt to your hit points is reduced by 5.

[**Upgrade Tree: Icicle Gu**] *The signature attack of Ice Path. Rank 1 Icicle Gu launches a sharp chunk of ice at an enemy that deals damage and saps heat from the target. It can be upgraded to the devastating single-target Spiral Ice Lance Gu or to the crowd-slaughtering Spiral Icicle Storm Gu*

Icicle Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Next Rank: Spiral Icicle Gu

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 8

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You launch a sharp icicle at a target within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 5 force damage and 5 cold damage. If the cold damage is dealt to the target's hit points, they gain the *fatigued* condition.

Spiral Icicle Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Previous Rank: Icicle Gu

Next Rank: Spiral Icicle Spear Gu, Spiral Icicle Swarm Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 8

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You launch a spinning icicle at a target within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 10 force damage and 10 cold damage. If the cold damage is dealt to the target's hit points, they gain the *fatigued* condition.

Spiral Ice Spear Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Previous Rank: Spiral Icicle Gu

Next Rank: Spiral Ice Lance Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 25 meters

Health: 10

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You launch a spear made of ice at a target within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 30 force damage and 20 cold damage. If the cold damage is dealt to the target's hit points, they gain the *fatigued* condition. As long as the target is smaller than [**Large**], they are pushed backward 3 meters. If they collide with a wall, they are pinned to it and *restrained*. The spear can be removed by a creature as a combat action with a successful **Athletics** skill test.

Spiral Ice Lance Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Previous Rank: Spiral Ice Spear Gu

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 50 meters

Health: 10

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You launch a large lance of ice at a target within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 100 force damage and 50 cold damage. If the cold damage is dealt to the target's hit points, they gain the *fatigued* condition. The target is pushed backward 8 meters. If they collide with a wall, they are pinned to it and *restrained*. The lance can be removed by a creature as a combat action with a successful **Athletics** skill test.

Spiral Icicle Swarm Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Previous Rank: Spiral Icicle Gu

Next Rank: Spiral Icicle Storm Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 8

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You launch 5 spinning icicles, each at a target of your choice within range. Make an attack roll for each; on a hit, deal 10 force damage and 10 cold damage. If the cold damage is dealt to the target's hit points, they gain the *fatigued* condition.

The icicles are launched sequentially; dodging one icicle does not cause the rest targeting the creature to miss.

Spiral Icicle Storm Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Previous Rank: Spiral Icicle Swarm Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 15 meters

Health: 8

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Pick a square you can see within range. While sustained, a storm of razor sharp icicles and cutting winds is manifested around it. The area is considered *Difficult Terrain* and any creature that starts its turn within 5 meters of the chosen square takes 40 rending damage, 40 force damage, and 40 cold damage. If the cold damage is dealt to a creature's hit points, they gain the *fatigued* condition.

[**END**]

Information Path

Used to create binding agreements between parties as well as to store and display information, whether that be writing or even videos and memories. Very few offensive or defensive methods and typically regarded as a logistical path.

Appraisal Gu

Rank 3 Divination

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You immediately know the approximate cost in primeval stones of a creature, object, or Gu that you touch.

Assessment Gu

A hairless grey jumping spider.

Rank 1-5 Catalyst

Cost: 10 portions

Range: {2, 5, 10, 25, 50} Meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You open your aperture, allowing Assessment Gu to see the target. Roll a d100 with a {+20, 0, -20, -40, -60} modifier; you immediately gain knowledge on the target based on the result:

- **81 and Above:** You know what it looks like.
- **80-61:** You know how many hit points the target has remaining.
- **60-41:** You know the target's maximum and current portions of primeval essence.
- **40-10:** You know how many Gu the target has in their aperture and what ranks they are.
- **9 and Below:** You know the target's immunities, invulnverabilities, resistances, vulnerabilities, damage reductions, and those of any [**Shield**] Gu they currently have activated. All damage dealt by you to the target or a [**Shield**] Gu that they activated ignores 5 damage reduction of each damage type.

You gain all the information from higher results as well.

Encyclopedia Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Brain** is permanently etched with Information Path dao. You have a photographic memory and a -20 bonus on all **Knowledge** skill tests.

Inscription Blade Gu

Rank 1 Manifestation

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 11

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Carves a message or image into a surface, up to a square meter in area. Can be used on living beings to inflict great pain and scar the image into tissue. The image can be of anything you've seen or imagined, but will have less detail if you do not remember the scene perfectly.

Ink Blood Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Blood** is permanently turned into black ink. You can write on any surface using your blood, and the writing cannot be washed away or faded by time.

Known Variable Gu

A wispy grey house spider.

Rank 2-3 Attack

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, whenever a creature makes an attack roll, you may use a reaction to give them an **Analysis**

Token. Skill tests made against creatures gain a {-5, -10} bonus for each **Analysis Token** they have. Creatures lose 1 **Analysis Token** at the end of each day.

Paper Crane Gu

Rank 1 Manifestation

Cost: 12 portions

Range: 10 kilometers

Health: 5

Food: 1 kg of wood pulp (1/4 primeval stone)

Effect: Summon a paper crane. Speak a message of up to 50 words. The paper crane records the spoken words before flying up to 10 kilometers in a direction of your choice.

Photo-audio Gu

Rank 2 Manifestation

Cost: 2 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 9

Food: Light and sound

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, Photo-audio Gu records the surroundings within range. When you stop sustaining Photo-audio Gu, the recorded scene is stored within Photo-audio Gu permanently. While sustaining a Photo-audio Gu with a stored recording, the recording is projected onto the wall in front of you.

The camera angle of the stored scene is always angled from above and behind the user.

Poison Vow Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: Poison Vow Gu begins to glow with a bright green light. You and another creature that you are touching must both recite conditions of a contract in sequence. If at any point during this process you or the target becomes unwilling to make the vow, the effect ends immediately and Poison Vow Gu is lost. If both parties recite their vows, Poison Vow Gu splits in two and attaches to both of your hearts.

If you or the target break the vow through action or inaction, the vow breaker immediately takes 200 poison damage directly to their hit points. The remaining half of Poison Vow Gu disintegrates.

Light Path

Light Path's characteristics are speed and purification. Its attacks are not very powerful but they often have support value attached.

Anonymous Aphid Gu

Rank 3 Concealment

Cost: 8 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Light reflecting off of your body becomes blurred while sustained, rendering it impossible for you to be identified. Your facial features become indistinguishable, and your build shifts between various heights and weights. Attack rolls made against you are made with a +10 penalty.

Aurora Curtain Gu *Rank 3 Guard*

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 10-meter wall

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: You manifest a shimmering curtain of multicolored light while sustained. The curtain takes up a 10 meter long line originating from a square you can see within range. **Ranged Attack** attack rolls made by creatures against a target on the opposite side of the curtain are made with a +30 penalty. Creatures that start their turn in or pass through the curtain gain the *dazed* condition as long as they can see.

Blue Light Shield Gu *Rank 1-5 Guard*

Cost: 18 portions

Range: Self

Health: {80, 200, 500, 1200, 2500}

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: You are surrounded by a translucent, hexagonal barrier of solid blue light while sustained. Whenever Blue Light Shield Gu takes damage, a flash of light bursts from it, and any creatures adjacent to you gain the *blinded* condition until the end of their next turn. Blue Light Shield Gu cannot block cold, heat, shock, or sonic damage.

Bright Pearl Gu

Rank 1-3 Container

Cost: 8 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 8

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Bright Pearl Gu flies around a Gu of rank {1, 2, 3} or lower that you touch, sealing it. While sealed by Bright Pearl Gu, the Gu's feeding threshold does not tick down. If the seal is attacked, the Gu inside is destroyed. Any Gu Master can infuse 1 portion of primeval essence into the seal to deactivate it. The Bright Pearl Gu remains under the original Gu Master's ownership.

Broadsword Light Gu

Rank 3 Manifestation

Cost: 6 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: You manifest a broadsword of sunlight in your hand while sustained. If you are wielding the sword and no other weapons, you may make two weapon attacks each turn instead of one. Melee attacks made with the sword have a range of 1 meter, deal 30 heat and 30 rending damage, and **Dodge** skill tests made to avoid attacks made with it are made with a +30 penalty.

You do not add your strength to damage dealt by Broadsword Light Gu.

Daylight Gu

Rank 1-3 Manifestation

Cost: 1 portion

Range: {10, 25, 100} meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Every square within range is filled with bright light that spreads around corners while sustained.

Dazzling Lights Gu

Rank 2-3 Manifestation

Cost: 12 portions

Range: 12 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Choose {1, 3} unoccupied squares that you can see within range. A brilliant orb of light appears in each. All creatures within 2 meters of a light gain the *dazed* condition immediately, and at the start of each of your turns while sustained.

Creatures with the *blinded* condition or that lack eyes are immune to this effect.

Deafening Flash Gu *Rank 2 Attack*

Cost: 30 portions

Range: 2 meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Light manifests in your hand, and after a short delay, you release a concussive burst in a 3 meter wide, 2 meter long line. Creatures in the area gain the *stunned* condition. **Dodge** skill tests made to avoid this attack are made with a -20 bonus.

If the creature cannot see, they instead gain the *deafened* condition until the end of their next turn.

If the creature cannot hear, they instead gain the *blinded* condition until the end of their next turn.

If the creature cannot see or hear, Deafening Flash Gu has no effect on them.

Flash Blink Gu

Rank 1 attack

Cost: 2 portions

Range: Self

Health: 14

Food: Natural light

Keywords: [**Expendable**], [**Unreactable**]

Effect: You explode with a blinding flash of light. All creatures that can see you immediately become *blinded* until the end of their next turn. Any darkness you can see that was created by a Gu of rank 2 or lower is dispelled, and the source Gu takes 1d4 damage as backlash and cannot be activated again until fed.

Flash Inspiration Gu

Rank 3 Divination

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 10

Food: A handful of fine shattered glass (4 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Deductive**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: You instantaneously perform a *Deduction* action with a -50 bonus. You may also activate Flash Inspiration Gu at any time without using an activation to immediately make a reaction without expending one of your reactions.

Footprint Gu

Rank 1 Divination

Cost: 4 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you can see footprints where any creature has stepped in the last hour. Different creature's footsteps appear as different colors.

Gentle Light Gu *Rank 3-5 Tonic*

Cost: 35 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Light**]

Effect: You emit a cleansing white light. Choose *fatigued*, *poisoned*, *dazed*, *stunned*, *deafened*, or *blinded*. All creatures within range lose the selected condition, unless that condition is *poisoned* and was applied by a Gu of a higher rank than Gentle Light Gu.

Lift Dao Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 30 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Choose one [**Dao**] effect permanently carved into your body and remove it.

Light Source Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 1 portion

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Supplementary**]

Effect: The cost of your next Gu activation is halved (rounded down, to a minimum of 1 portion) if the Gu belongs to Light Path and is rank 3 or lower.

Little Light Gu

Rank 1 Manifestation

Cost: 1 portion

Range: 10 meters

Health: 3

Food: 3 drops of flammable oil.

Effect: Little Light Gu emits 10 meters of bright light at all times. The light defaults to white, but activating Little Light Gu slightly shifts its color along the color wheel until it reaches your desired color.

Moonlight Gu *Rank 1 Attack*

Cost: 6 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 2

Food: 3 moon orchid petals (3 primeval stones)

Effect: You hurl a flat, crescent-shaped beam of light. Make an attack roll against a target within range with a -10 bonus. On a hit, deal 6 rending damage.

One-stretch Golden Light Gu

Rank 1 Guard

Next Rank: Two-stretch Golden Light Gu

Cost: 2 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, a 1 meter radius sphere of light surrounds you and blocks attacks, creatures, and objects from entering (but not exiting). When an attack from outside the sphere hits a creature inside the sphere, the sphere takes the damage instead, though the defender can still dodge the attack. For every point of damage the sphere takes, you lose 1 portion of primeval essence. If the sphere takes more than 15 damage from a single attack, it breaks, the remainder of the damage is dealt to the defender, and One-stretch Golden Light Gu takes 2d6 damage as backlash. The sphere does not block sonic damage.

Rainbow Light Gu

Rank 3 Celerity

Cost: 30 portions

Range: 50 meters

Health: 4

Food: Light from all colors of the rainbow, or light from White Heaven

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Pick a square that you can see within range. You turn into a beam of light and nearly instantaneously move to the target square. You ignore effects that trigger when you move through their area of effect, but can still be stopped by barriers. The speed of travel is so fast that it disorients you and expends all of your reactions.

Rainbow Prism Gu *Rank 1-5 Divination*

Cost: 7 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 8

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Investigative: Sight**]

Effect: A floating prism manifests in a square adjacent to you, casting spectrums of light in a 5 meter radius. Anything within range being disguised or concealed by a Gu of rank

{1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower is revealed, and any bodily fluid stains within range glow a dim blue.

The prism disappears after 1 minute.

Shimmer Gu

Rank 2 Concealment

Cost: 3 portions

Range: Self

Health: 7

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Light bends around your body, making you invisible while sustained.

Solar Flare Gu *Rank 3 Attack*

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 20 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

Effect: You fire a concentrated beam of solar radiation. Make an attack roll against a target within range. On a hit, deal 30 heat damage and the target gains the *poisoned* condition with the following effects:

- You gain a +10 penalty to all skill tests
- You have the *fatigued* condition

Sunlight Pool Gu

Rank 3 Tonic

Cost: 120 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You touch a body of water at least 6 inches deep. In a 100 meter radius centered on you the water glows, casting bright light within 100 meters of it. For the next hour, any creature that enters the water has all negative effects and conditions applied by Gu of rank 3 or lower removed from them, excluding Gu with the [**Dao**] keyword.

Sunspot Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 8 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Sunspot Gu must be activated outdoors. While sustained, a sunbeam envelopes a 2 meter square within range. If a creature starts its turn within the area, it takes 70 heat damage. You may move the sunbeam up to 5 meters to another area within range as a bonus action or activation.

Two-stretch Golden Light Gu

Rank 2 Guard

Previous Rank: One-stretch Golden Light Gu

Cost: 2 portions

Range: Self

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, a 3 meter radius sphere of light surrounds you and blocks attacks, creatures, and objects from entering (but not exiting). When an attack from outside the sphere hits a creature inside the sphere, the sphere takes the damage instead, though the defender can still dodge the attack. For every 2 points of damage the sphere takes, you lose 1 portion of primeval essence. If the sphere takes more than 30 damage from a single attack, it breaks, the remainder of the damage is dealt to the defender, and Two-stretch Golden Light Gu takes 2d6 damage as backlash. The sphere does not block sonic damage.

Zhulong Slither Snake Gu *Rank 3 Celerity*

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 1

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Your base movement is doubled for 3 turns and you gain an additional Reaction each round. After the effect ends, you gain the *fatigued* condition.

Lightning Path

An offensive path with focus on high speed attacks.

Chain Lightning Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Previous Rank: Self Strike Gu

Cost: 25 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 10

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Undodgeable**]

Effect: A bolt of lightning streaks from your outstretched hand towards a creature within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 80 shock damage. The lightning then chains to the closest creature within 3 meters for 40 shock damage. It chains again to the closest creature within 3 meters of the second target (this can be the first target again), dealing 20 shock damage.

Hair Trigger Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Brain**'s instincts are permanently sharpened by Lightning Path Dao, allowing you to act quicker in combat. You gain a -10 bonus to initiative tests and can make an additional reaction each turn.

Jolt Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 2

Food: 100 g of combustion leaves (1 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

Effect: You shoot a thin beam of electricity at a creature within range. Make an attack roll; On a hit, deal 8 shock damage.

Lightning Eye Gu

Rank 3 Divination

Cost: 1 portion

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: To activate Lightning Eye Gu, you must remove an **Eye** and place Lightning Eye Gu in the socket. Upon activation, Lightning Eye Gu replaces the lost eye permanently, and you can see out of it with perfect vision whether or not it is activated.

While you sustain Lightning Eye Gu, your lightning eye can see through obscuring effects such as smoke and illusions produced by Gu of rank 3 or lower, and can see any object within 150 meters in fine detail. You gain immunity to the *blinded* condition, and you can react to [**Unreactable**] Gu so long as the Gu Master is within your line of sight.

Removing Lightning Eye Gu from the socket kills it.

Lightning Gu

When Blazing Glory Lightning Brilliance, the 3rd son of Ren Zu, was trapped in immemorial blue heaven, it was the legendary rank 9 Lightning Gu that helped him escape. Even the mortal variant is a terrifying weapon. It appears as a blue grub with tiny wings.

Rank 3-5 Attack

Cost: 60 portions

Range: 1 kilometer

Health: 1

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

Effect: A crackling bolt of plasma erupts from your finger in a line 1 meter wide and 1 kilometer long. All creatures in the line take {60, 140, 300} shock damage. Creatures in the line or adjacent to it take {10, 25, 60} sonic damage. If the sonic damage is dealt to a creature's hit points, they gain the *deafened* condition for 1 minute.

Lightning Net Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 2 meters

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: You throw a net of electricity at a creature within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, the creature gains the *restrained* condition and takes 8 shock damage at the start of each of its turns while you sustain Lightning Net Gu. Whenever a creature takes shock damage to its hit points from Lightning Net Gu, they gain the *stunned* condition.

A creature can use a combat action to make an **Athletics** test, breaking free and ending this effect on a success.

Lightning Rod Gu

Rank 2 Guard

Cost: 3 portions

Range: 2 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, if a creature within range is dealt shock damage, the shock damage is redirected to you. You gain invulnerability to shock damage. You may activate Lightning Rod Gu as a reaction to a creature within range taking shock damage.

Lightning Shield Gu

Rank 1-5 Guard

Cost: 14 portions

Range: Self

Health: {55, 120, 280, 600, 1500}

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: You summon a semicircle of lightning to protect yourself from 3 sides. Lightning Shield Gu cannot be assigned damage from targeted attacks made from the open side of the shield. Lightning Shield Gu is invulnverable to shock damage and cannot block sonic damage. If a creature deals damage to Lightning Shield Gu with an unarmed attack, they take {4, 10, 25, 60, 150} shock damage.

Lightning Spear Gu

Rank 2-4 Attack

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Piercing**], [**Unreactable**]

Effect: You hurl a spear of lightning at a target within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal {12, 30, 75} shock damage and an additional {4, 10, 25} shock damage directly to their hit points.

Lightning Wings Gu

Rank 3 Celerity

Cost: 30 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Wings of lightning appear on your back. While sustained, you gain a flying speed of 20 meters and can make 3 Maneuvers each turn. If you make a weapon attack, punching attack, or activate a Gu with a range of touch at the end of a dive Maneuver, you may treat the attack as though it had the [**Unreactable**] keyword.

Rumbling Thunder Gu

Rank 2 Celerity

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your movement is increased by 5 meters while sustained. Whenever you move, your footsteps rumble with the sound of thunder, audible up to 5 kilometers away. Ordinary beasts are frightened and flee the sound, but beast kings are sometimes attracted by the noise.

Self Strike Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Next Rank: Chain Lightning Gu

Cost: 20 portions

Range: 6 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

Effect: Choose a creature you can see within range. That creature takes 20 shock damage, and a streak of lightning shoots from them to the nearest creature within 2 meters of the target, dealing 10 shock damage. This process repeats from the second and each subsequent target, dealing 5 shock damage, then 2, and finally 1 before the attack ends (for a total of 5 unique targets). If the attack is not able to chain to a target that has not yet been struck by this activation of Self Strike Gu, it instead chains to you, regardless of distance.

Static Step Gu

Rank 2 Celerity

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 6 meters

Health: 4

Food: 50g of magnetite sand (2 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

Effect: You blink to an unoccupied square within range, leaving a crackle of static in your wake. If a creature makes a melee attack against you, you may activate Static Step Gu as a reaction; the attack automatically misses, and the attacker takes 10 shock damage.

Static Touch Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: A piece of wool

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Hands** permanently carry a static charge. When you touch a creature or hit it with a punching attack, you may choose to release a small spark. This deals 1 shock damage and ignites flammable objects.

Superconductor Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Nervous System** is permanently etched with Lightning Path Dao, making it transmit information nearly instantly between your brain and muscles. You can react to effects even if they have the [**Unreactable**] keyword and gain a -20 bonus to initiative tests.

Thunder Hammer Gu

Rank 5 Attack

Cost: 25 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

Effect: You launch a bolt of lightning and condensed thunder that strikes like a hammer towards a target within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 150 force damage, 150 shock damage, and 50 sonic damage. The target is thrown backwards 20 meters; if it collides with a creature or object, they both take 50 force damage and the target is stopped.

Thunderclap Gu

Rank 2-3 Attack

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 8 meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

Effect: A ball of lightning is fired from your mouth to a square within range. Creatures within 1 meter take {20, 50} shock damage. Activating Thunderclap Gu twice in the same turn overloads it. The area of effect is increased to 2 meters and the damage is increased to {30, 75} shock damage, but Thunderclap Gu dies immediately afterward.

Thunderdome Gu

Rank 4 Manifestation

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 20 meters

Health: 18

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A sphere of electricity is formed in a 10 meter radius centered on you. Creatures inside remain trapped while you sustain Thunderdome Gu. Creatures trapped inside can still act as normal, but the effects of Gu of equal or lesser rank cannot permeate outside the barrier. A creature that touches the sides takes 250 shock damage and can leave the sphere.

Volt Sprint Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Leg Muscles** are permanently transformed by Lightning Path Dao, increasing your movement by 4 meters.

Luck Path

Luck path was created by Giant Sun Immortal Venerable, and exploits a profound "Luck", a formless component of Human Qi that defies the influence of Fate Gu. The existence of luck path is not common knowledge, with what few practitioners exist cultivating in the Northern Plains.

Amplify Luck Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 20 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Can only be activated as a reaction to you or another creature within range expending a luck point on a skill test. If the luck point was used to force a reroll, the target gains advantage on the reroll. If the luck point was used to give a -50 bonus on the skill test, it is instead made with a -80 bonus.

Dumb Luck Gu

A brown cricket with golden wings.

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: 1 object used for gambling (die, gambling rock, etc.)

Effect: Can only be activated as a reaction to rolling a fumble. You may spend 1 luck point to have the roll succeed with 1 degree of success.

Extend Luck Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Can only be activated as a reaction to succeeding a skill test after expending a Luck Point to reroll it. You may reroll your next failed skill test before the end of your next turn.

Luck Cauldron Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your luck point maximum is increased by 1.

Manifest Luck Gu

Rank 3 Manifestation

Cost: 8 portions

Range: 7 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, a tarnished bell appears in an unoccupied square within range, with 0 [Karma]. Whenever you or an ally within range succeed a skill test, the bell gains 1 [Karma], to a maximum of 3. Whenever you or an ally within range fail a skill test, the bell loses 1 [Karma], to a minimum of -3. At the start of each of your turns (even if you decide to stop sustaining Manifest Luck Gu), you may target a creature within range and reset the bell's [Karma] to 0. The creature gains a modifier to the next skill test they make equal to the bell's [Karma] times 10. The bell has 25 hit points and reduces all damage dealt to it by 30, but it cannot be moved from its square by force.

Split Luck Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your maximum Luck is permanently doubled, including any increases to it applied in the future. When you use a luck point to add a bonus to a roll, that bonus is halved.

Metal Path

Similar to Earth Path, but with much more focus on defensive and especially offensive methods.

Aperture Lock Gu

Three golden locks linked together, with their shackles open until the Gu is used. The first locks the aperture walls, preventing cultivation progression. The second locks their Human Qi, preventing the recovery of primeval essence. The last locks the aperture, disabling their use of Gu.

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 75 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: 150 portions of primeval essence. Once attached, feeds off the target's primeval essence.

Effect: You touch a Gu Master with the *restrained* condition, and Aperture Lock Gu hovers above the target's chest. At the end of each of your turns, a lock snaps shut. If the target loses the *restrained* condition at any point, Aperture Lock Gu deactivates and takes 7 damage as backlash.

When the third lock closes, Aperture Lock Gu burrows into the target's aperture, and the target gains the following features while Aperture Lock Gu remains attached.

- Their aperture walls become indestructible.
- Their primeval essence recovery is reduced to 0.
- They cannot activate or refine Gu.

Battle Bone Wheel Gu

A hulking wheel made of sharpened bone, with thick spikes protruding from the walls.

Rank 5 Attack

Cost: 8 portions

Range: 20 meters

Health: 800

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Large**], [**Low Vitality**]

Effect: Battle Bone Wheel Gu charges to a square that you can see within range. If Battle Bone Wheel Gu moves through an occupied square, the occupant takes 200 rending and 200 force damage. If this damage is dealt to a creature's hit points, they gain *bleeding 15*. If this damage is not enough to destroy or kill the occupant of the square, Battle Bone Wheel Gu is stopped in the last unoccupied square it traveled through.

Dodge skill tests made to avoid **Battle Bone Wheel** Gu are made with a +20 penalty.

Low Vitality: Battle Bone Wheel Gu does not regain hit points when fed. Instead, you must set rank 1 Bone Bamboo Gu alight using rank 2 Ghost Fire Gu and hold the burning Gu up to Battle Bone Wheel Gu, consuming the Bone Bamboo Gu. For every Bone Bamboo Gu expended this way, Battle Bone Wheel Gu recovers 10 hit points.

Bleeding Bismuth Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 6

Food: 100 g of bismuth (3 primeval stones)

Effect: Make an attack roll against a creature within range. On a hit, cubes of bismuth pierce their flesh and skin from inside their body, dealing 8 force damage directly to their hit points. If this damage is dealt to their hit points, they gain *bleeding 4*.

Beast Maddening Bullet Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 3 portions

Range: 15 meters

Health: 3

Food: 100 g of will grass ashes (5 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

You fire a tiny shard of metal infused with your will at a beast within range. Make an attack roll with advantage; on a hit, it embeds itself deep into their muscle layer and maintains a semi-permanent link with the user.

If the target was unaware of your attack, they must succeed an **Awareness** skill test with a +10 penalty or else remain unaware of the beast maddening bullet under their skin. The beast maddening bullet can be physically extracted, at which point it loses its effect. If the beast dies, the effect ends.

While a creature is implanted by the beast maddening bullet, activating Beast Maddening Bullet Gu has the following effect:

The implanted beast immediately uses a reaction to make a melee attack against another creature of your choice within range.

Beast Tag Bullet Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 5 portions

Range: 20 meters

Health: 4

Food: 100 g of feather soil (2 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

You fire a tiny shard of metal at a target within range. Make an attack roll with advantage; on a hit, it embeds itself deep into their muscle layer and maintains a link with any beasts enslaved by you.

If the target was unaware of your attack, they must succeed an **Awareness** skill test with a +10 penalty or else remain unaware of the beast tag bullet under their skin. Any beasts enslaved by you can sense the targets exact location as long as they are on the same continent. The beast tag bullet can be physically extracted, at which point it loses its effect. If the target dies, the effect ends.

While a creature is implanted by the beast tag bullet, activating Beast Tag Bullet Gu has the following effect:

Any beasts enslaved by you that can see the target use a reaction to immediately move up to half of their movement towards the target before making a melee attack against the target if they are within range.

Bronze Transmission Gu

Rank 3 Divination

Cost: 16 portions

Range: 1 meter

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: You speak a name aloud and picture the person's face in your mind as Bronze Transmission Gu flies into an object made of bronze within range. The person's face appears in the object as long as they are on the same continent as you, and sounds from either side are transmitted through it. Bronze Transmission Gu leaves the object when you stop sustaining it.

Bullet Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 25 meters

Health: 3

Food: 100 g of smoldering stone (1 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

Effect: You fire a small orb at incredibly high speed at a target within range. Make an attack roll with advantage. On a hit, deal 4 force damage. If this damage is dealt to the target's hit points, they gain *bleeding 1*.

Copper Tendons Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 100 g copper ore (1/2 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Tendons** permanently harden into copper over the course of an hour. Reduce all rending and force damage dealt to your hit points by 2.

Chainsaw Golden Centipede Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Cost: 12 portions

Range: Self

Health: 250

Food: A handful of sharpened iron shards (1/4 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Sustained**], [**Medium**]

Effect: Your arm goes down the Chainsaw Golden Centipede Gu's throat, turning your arm into a long spinning blade. While sustained, you may use Chainsaw Golden Centipede Gu to make melee attacks with a range of 3 meters, dealing 100 rending damage on a hit. If Chainsaw Golden Centipede Gu has 120 or fewer hit points, it instead deals 40 rending damage on a hit.

Golden Aurora Gu

Rank 3 Manifestation

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 14

Food: 10 g of golden phoenix feather (20 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you are surrounded by a shimmering golden aurora. You gain a flying speed of 6 meters and can execute 2 Maneuvers each turn.

Golden Bell Gu

Rank 1 Guard

Cost: 30 portions

Range: 2 meters

Health: 9

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**]

Effect: A bell rings, and all creatures within range are surrounded in golden light until the start of your next turn. All non-sonic damage dealt to affected creatures is reduced by 4.

Golden Breeze Gu

Rank 4 Tonic

Cost: 30 portions

Range: 20 meters

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, a calming breeze flows around you. All creatures within range regain 20 hit points at the end of each of your turns.

Golden Needle Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 25 portions

Range: 15 meters

Health: 9

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Piercing**]

Effect: A cloud of golden needles shoots from your sleeve in a line 15 meters long and 3 meters wide. Creatures in the area take 10 force damage. If this damage is dealt to their hit points, they gain *bleeding 1*.

Grounded Beetle Gu

Rank 1-3 Guard

Cost: 4 portions

Range: {Self, 1 meter, 3 meters}

Health: 12

Food: 1 kilogram of dirt

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained and standing on solid ground, creatures and Gu within range gain invulnerability to shock damage.

Heatsink Gu

Rank 1-2 Guard

Cost: 8 portions

Range: Self

Health: 10

Food: 1 kg copper ore, heated to at least 100 degrees

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, Heatsink Gu negates and stores all heat damage dealt to your hit points, to a maximum of {20, 50}. If you hit a creature with an unarmed melee attack, deal additional heat damage equal to the damage stored inside Heatsink Gu to the target. When you stop sustaining Heatsink Gu, its stored damage reverts to 0.

Ironfist Grappling Gu

Rank 3-5 Attack

Previous Rank: Iron Hand Gu

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 6

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you manifest a [**Medium**] hand made of black iron in an unoccupied square within range. Pick a creature within range. At the end of each of your turns, the hand moves up to 5 meters towards the target and attempts to grab them. If the target does not successfully dodge the grab, they are *restrained* by the hand. A creature can break free by succeeding an **Athletics** skill test with a {+60, +120, +250} penalty.

Iron Hand Gu

Rank 2 Manifestation

Next Rank: Ironfist Grappling Gu

Cost: 3 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your hands are made entirely of a dense and hard iron. They are incredibly durable; if you would take damage to your hit points and that damage is being dealt specifically to your hands (a called shot, or touching something very hot, for example), reduce the damage taken by 80. You gain a -20 bonus to **Close Combat** tests made to parry an attack.

You have advantage on **Athletics** skill tests resulting from the **Grapple** combat action, and your punching attacks deal an additional 5 force damage.

Iron Hook Silver Slash Gu

Rank 5 Attack

Cost: 8 portions

Range: 25 meters

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Piercing**]

Effect: You launch a silver and a steel blade, each at a target within range. On a hit, silver blades deal 140 rending damage, and steel blades deal 70 rending damage directly to the target's hit points.

Iron Needle Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 21

Food: 200 g of needles (1 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Piercing**]

Effect: A cloud of needles bursts from your hand towards a creature within range. Make an attack roll with a -10 bonus. On a hit, deal 2d10 force damage.

Iron Veins Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 30 portions

Range: Self

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Circulatory System** permanently hardens into iron over the course of an hour. Whenever you gain the *bleeding* condition, reduce the number of *bleeding* stacks you receive by 2, to a minimum of 0.

Metal Skin Gu

Rank 1-3 Carver

Cost: 70 portions

Range: Self

Health: 16

Food: 10 g of {iron, steel, titanium} soaked in blood

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: You are assailed with a horrendous pain for 1 hour while your **Skin** molts and is replaced with {iron, steel, titanium}. You are incapable of taking any actions except to speak for the entire duration. When the process is complete, your skin is permanently transmuted into a flexible membrane as strong as the respective metal. Whenever you take damage to your hit points, except shock or sonic, reduce it by {5, 12, 25}, to a minimum of 0. You have vulnerability to shock damage.

Polished Gold Gu

As is the case with most cultivation improving Gu, Polished Gold Gu is exceptionally valuable. Despite only being rank 3, Polished Gold Gu's refinement recipe requires the sacrifice of a precious rank 4 Relic Gu.

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: 1 kg of solid gold (5 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your aptitude is permanently increased by 5%, to a maximum of 99%.

Shape Metal Gu

Rank 2-3 Catalyst

Cost: 30 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You touch a metal object less than {1, 3} cubic meters in volume. That object is reshaped at your will, but must retain its inital volume. The shape can be as detailed as you want; an ornate door, a weapon, or even an instrument (assuming you know how to build it).

Silver Bullet Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 20 portions

Range: 25 meters

Health: 5

Food: 100 g of silver (10 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

Effect: You launch a silver orb at incredibly high speeds. This attack always hits. Deal 10 force damage on a hit. If this damage is dealt to the creature's hitpoints, they gain *bleeding 1*.

[**Upgrade Tree: Silver Lining Gu**] *Silver Lining Gu can be refined into several different rank 2 Gu. Quicksilver Lining Gu provides a speed boost, Steel Lining Gu provides physical defense, and Resurgence Gu pivots to Wood Path to provide additional healing to surrounding allies.*

Silver Lining Gu

Rank 1 Tonic

Next Rank: Quicksilver Lining Gu, Resurgence Gu, Steel Lining Gu

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: 5 g of silver soaked in tears (1 primeval stone)

Effect: Can only be activated as a reaction to getting hit by an attack or missing an attack against another creature. Regain 4 hit points.

Quicksilver Lining Gu

Rank 2 Tonic

Previous Rank: Silver Lining Gu

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: 5 g of silver soaked in mercury (10 primeval stones)

Effect: Can only be activated as a reaction to getting hit by an attack or missing an attack against another creature. Regain 8 hit points. Until the end of your next turn, your movement is increased by 2 meters and you gain a -10 bonus to all **Dodge** skill tests.

Steel Lining Gu

Rank 2 Tonic

Previous Rank: Silver Lining Gu

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: Rank 1 Metal Skin Gu

Effect: Can only be activated as a reaction to getting hit by an attack or missing an attack against another creature. Regain 10 hit points. Until the start of your next turn, your body is covered in a metallic sheen. Reduce any damage except mental or poison dealt to your hit points by 15, to a minimum of 0.

[END]

Steel Bones Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 30 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: You are assailed with a horrendous pain for 1 hour. You are incapable of taking any actions except to speak for the entire duration. When the process is complete, your **Bones** are permanently transmuted into steel. Your bones can no longer be broken by damage or effects originating from a Gu of Rank 2 or lower. Additionally, reduce all force damage dealt to your hit points by 4.

Transmute Tungsten Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 7

Food: 1 cubic centimeter of tungsten (2 primeval stones)

Effect: Transmute an object you touch into tungsten. The object must fit within a cube 1 meter on each side. Tungsten is incredibly dense, so this may cause less sturdy surfaces to collapse. When attempting to transmute an object another creature is holding or wearing, you must make an attack roll. Transmuted clothes become armor for the target with the following stats:

Tungsten Armor DT: 8
HP: 10
Dodge Penalty: +40
Movement Penalty: -4

A creature can expend its combat action to doff the armor.

Poison Path

Applies debilitating conditions to enemies. They may just deal damage or cause extreme symptoms. Some can even spread between creatures.

Berserk Toxin Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 30 portions

Range: 4 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Make an attack roll against a creature within range. On a hit, the target gains the *poisoned* condition with the following effects:

- If a creature moves out of your melee range, you immediately make a weapon or punching attack as an attack of opportunity without using a reaction.
- On your turn, you must move to and use the **Melee Attack** combat action on the closest creature to you. If multiple targets are the closest creature to you, you select one at random.

This effect lasts for 3 turns.

Decorum Erosion Toxin Gu

A fluorescent blue and green pillbug.

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 5

Food: 1 cup of rice wine

Effect: You touch a creature or edible object; The creature touched or any number of creatures that eat affected food gain the *poisoned* condition for 1 day with the following effects:

- You suffer a +10 penalty to **Awareness**, **Deduction**, and **Dodge** skill tests.
- Creatures gain a -10 bonus to **Persuasion** and **Haggle** skill tests made against you.

Mithridatize Gu

Rank 4 Carver

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Circulatory System** is permanently etched with Poison path dao. You gain immunity to the *poisoned* condition from any source of rank 4 or lower. If you recieve the *poisoned* condition from a rank 5 Gu, its duration is reduced to 1 minute if it was longer or permanent. When you lose the *poisoned* condition, you gain immunity to that specific *poisoned* condition.

Poison Affinity Gu

A tiny blue dart frog with purple spots.

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 1 liter of water from a Poison Path swamp (20 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Aperture** is etched with Poison Path dao, and you permanently gain 10% aptitude, to a maximum of 99%. Whenever you activate a Gu of any path other than Poison Path, their cost is doubled. Whenever you activate a Gu of Poison Path, it costs 3 fewer portions, to a minimum of 1. This reduction is applied before the cost is multiplied due to a difference in rank between you and the Gu.

[**Single Gate Poison Gu**]

Close Gate Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: None

Range: Touch

Health: 2

Food: None

Effect: A creature you touch has the *posioned* condition removed if it was inflicted by Single Gate Poison Gu.

Single Gate Poison Gu

When Single Gate Poison Gu is successfully refined, a rank 3 Close Gate Gu is also refined. Close Gate Gu costs no primeval essence and has no effect other than to remove the poisoned condition inflicted by Single Gate Poison Gu.

Rank 3 Attack

Cost: 30 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You touch a creature and they gain the *poisoned* condition with the following effect:

- If it has been at least 7 days since you recieved this condition, you die.

[**END**]

Slowness Toxin Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 12 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A green sickle curves towards an enemy within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 5 poison damage directly to their hit points and apply the *poisoned* condition with the following effect:

- At the end of each of your turns, your Movement is reduced by 2, to a minimum of 1.

This condition lasts for 10 minutes.

Tipped Daggers Gu

Rank 2-4 Attack

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: The fingernails on your **Hands** become 2 inches long. You may forego a punching attack made on your turn to rake the target with your claws. Make a **Close Combat** skill test. On a hit, deal {5, 20, 60} rending damage. If this damage is dealt to the target's hit points, they gain *bleeding {1, 2, 4}* and the *poisoned* condition with the following effects:

- You gain *bleeding {1, 2, 4}* at the start of each of your turns.

Toxic Pore Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 50 milliliters of venom from a Hundred Beast King snake

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Skin** is permanently modified to secrete a mild paralytic toxin. Any creature that grapples with you or makes skin-to-skin contact with you suffers a +20 penalty to all **Close Combat** and **Dodge** tests until the end of their next turn.

Refinement Path

Improves any aspect of gu refinement. Refinement path Gu Masters are often well respected, since they act as factories producing Gu for the clan. Cultivators can often be hired to produce Gu for a significant price.

Blast Shield Gu

Rank 2-4 Guard

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: {15, 40, 100}

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: An invisible barrier protects you from attacks. You cannot be targeted by attacks with a range of touch. Reduce all heat and force damage dealt to Blast Shield Gu by {10, 20, 40}.

You may activate Blast Shield Gu when you fail a **Refinement** skill test. If you do, Blast Shield Gu takes the damage of the backlash instead of you and involved Gu, and you have an opportunity to save the refinement. Make a **Refinement** skill test with a penalty equal to your degrees of failure on the initial **Refinement** skill test times {40, 30, 20}. If you succeed, the refinement succeeds and you must roll the failure die as normal.

Catalog Gu

Rank 4 Container

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: One refinement recipe that you know or have written in front of you is archived in Catalog Gu. You may inspect the contents of Catalog Gu without expending primeval essence, and you gain a -10 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests if the recipe is recorded in a Catalog Gu that you own.

Morphing Colors Gu

A stinkbug with an exterior sheen like an oil slick.

Rank 2-4 Catalyst

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 8

Food: {1, 10, 100} liters of black oil centipede blood

Effect: When following a refinement recipe for a Gu of rank {2, 3, 4} or lower, if the Gu belongs to Transformation or Light Path you may activate Morphing Colors Gu to gain advantage on the **Refinement** skill test.

Reverse Refinement Gu

Rank 1-5 Catalyst

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: You touch a Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower and immediately reverse refine it, turning it into its refinement ingredients. The ingredients produced correspond to the materials used to refine the Gu, or if originally a wild Gu, a number of primeval stones depending on the rank of the target Gu.

Rank 1: 100 primeval stones

Rank 2: 400 primeval stones

Rank 3: 2,000 primeval stones

Rank 4: 10,000 primeval stones

Rank 5: 50,000 primeval stones

Revert Gu

Rank 2-5 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Touch a Gu of rank {2, 3, 4, 5}. If a Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4} is a core material in the targeted Gu's refinement recipe, the targeted Gu is transformed into that Gu. If multiple Gu fulfill the requirement, one is selected at random.

Undefeated Hundred Battles Gu

Rank 5 Catlayst

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**], [**Extinct**]

Effect: You may activate Undefeated Hundred Battles Gu whenever you follow a recipe to refine a Gu. The refinement takes the full duration of the recipe, but you automatically succeed the **Refinement** skill test with a critical success and do not have to roll the failure die.

Rule Path

Very uncommon, rule path Gu have very narrow use cases but can be very helpful for augmenting killer moves.

Aura Filter Gu

Rank 4-5 Guard

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 9

Food: 100 portions of rank {4, 5} primeval essence

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Upon activation, choose any number of ranks {4, 5} or below. While sustained, you are surrounded by an invisible 2 meter radius sphere. Gu Masters of the chosen ranks cannot pass through the bounds of the sphere either way, but attacks can still pass through like normal.

Big Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Supplementary**]

Effect: Make the size of your next Gu activation bigger:

If the Gu or killer move creates an area of effect, increase its size in all dimensions by double.

If the Gu or killer move has the [**Transformation**] keyword, your size is changed to [**Large**]

[**Upgrade Path: Hundred Meter Gu**]

Millimeter Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 1 cubic millimeter of gold

Keywords: [**Supplementary**]

Effect: Change the range of your next Gu activation to a millimeter. Has no effect on Gu with a range of *self*. *Touch* becomes an attack roll against a target you can see within range.

Meter Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Supplementary**]

Effect: Change the range of your next Gu activation to a meter. Has no effect on Gu with a range of *self*. *Touch* becomes an attack roll against a target you can see within range.

Ten Meter Gu

Rank 4 Catalyst

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Supplementary**]

Effect: Change the range of your next Gu activation to 10 meters. Has no effect on Gu with a range of *self*. *Touch* becomes an attack roll against a target you can see within range.

Hundred Meter Gu

Rank 5 Catalyst

Cost: 60 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Supplementary**]

Effect: Change the range of your next Gu activation to 100 meters. Has no effect on Gu with a range of *self*. *Touch* becomes an attack roll against a target you can see within range.

[**END**]

Immobilization Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Cost: 20 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Immobilization Gu flies towards a creature within range. This action is reactable and Immobilization Gu can be hit with attacks while en route. If Immobilization Gu successfully reaches its target, the target gains the *restrained* and *stunned* conditions, and Immobilization Gu falls to the ground. The *restrained* condition lasts for 1 minute.

Inactive Gu

Rank 1-5 Guard

Cost: 50 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You touch a creature. If they are sustaining a Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower, it deactivates and its effect ends. If they are sustaining multiple Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower, one is selected at random. Inactive Gu cannot deactivate Gu being used as part of a killer move.

Sacrifice Gu

Rank 4 Catalyst

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: Can only be activated as a reaction to yourself using an [**Expendable**] Gu of rank 4 or lower. That [**Expendable**] Gu is not destroyed in the process of activation.

Small Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 4 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Supplementary**]

Effect: Make the size of your next Gu activation smaller:

If the Gu or killer move creates an area of effect, reduce its size in all dimensions by half (rounding down to a minimum of 1 meter).

If the Gu or killer move has the [**Transformation**] keyword, your size is reduced to [**Small**]

Tiny Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 8 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Supplementary**]

Effect: Make the size of your next Gu activation smaller:

If the Gu or killer move creates an area of effect, reduce its size in all dimensions to 10% of its original size (rounding down to a minimum of 1 meter).

If the Gu or killer move has the [**Transformation**] keyword, your size is reduced to [**Tiny**]

Soul Path

Difficult to cultivate, soul path methods power is largely reliant on the user's soul strength. Stronger offensively, with few options when it comes to support.

Burial Soul Toad Gu

Rank 3-4 Container

Cost: 30 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 25

Food: {1, 5} human souls

Keywords: [**Large**]

Effect: Burial Soul Toad Gu must be removed from your aperture to be activated. When activated, Burial Soul Toad Gu draws in the souls of all dead creatures within range that have been dead for less than an hour. Absorbed souls burst through the skin on Burial Soul Toad Gu's back, appearing as smooth white eggs 5cm in diameter. Soul eggs can be plucked from Burial Soul Toad Gu's back, but once separated any amount of damage will break the soul egg and release the soul within. Burial Soul Toad Gu can hold up to {100, 1000} souls at a time, not counting any souls removed from its back.

[Beast] Soul Gu

Variants exist for most types of beasts; Wolf Soul Gu, Bear Soul Gu, etc.

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 45 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 1 pound of the respective beast's flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: You may gain the effect of [Beast] Soul Gu up to 15 times. You take 100 unmitigatible damage to your soul. After you've activated [Beast] Soul Gu 15 times across any period, you have the [Beast] soul, and henceforth take only half the regular damage (rounded down) to your soul when enslaving or controlling [Beast]s of the same type as your soul. Additionally, you may now safely increase your soul's maximum hit points beyond 1,009.

If your soul has already been refined at least once by another Gu, [Beast] Soul Gu has no effect.

Eat Soul Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 80 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: You eat a soul, either from a container Gu or the corpse of a creature that died less than a minute ago. Your maximum soul is increased by 10% of their current soul when they died.

Elusive Ghost Gu

Rank 4 Celerity

Cost: 4 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: You become ethereal while sustained and your movement is 4 meters. You may move in any direction, including up and down, and can move through physical barriers. You are no longer a valid target for Gu with a range of *Touch* unless that Gu belongs to Soul Path. Melee attacks made by or against you automatically miss, and you can not physically interact with the world. You can still be hit by and affected by Gu.

General Soul Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 45 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: You may gain the effect of General Soul Gu up to 15 times. You take 100 unmitigatible damage to your soul. After you've activated General Soul Gu 15 times across any period, you have the General soul; Whenever you would take damage to your soul from directing a creature or effect to act, reduce the damage by 1. Additionally, you may now safely increase your soul's maximum hit points beyond 1,009.

If your soul has already been refined at least once by another Gu, General Soul Gu has no effect.

Ghost Eye Gu

Rank 2-3 Divination

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Investigative: Detect**]

Effect: A spectral, invisible ghost eye appears next to you. You see through it as if it were your third eye, and can direct it to move up to 10 meters as an activation. The eye can move through walls and obstacles, as well as barriers created by Gu of rank {1, 2} or lower. The eye disappears {at the end of your next turn, after 1 hour}.

Ghost Fire Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Your palm erupts in a pale blue flame as you touch a creature. They take damage to their soul equal to 5% of your current soul (rounded down), with a minimum of 1 and a maximum of 20. They also gain the *burning* condition.

Ghost Soldier Gu

Rank 2-4 Manifestation

Cost: 30 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: You manifest {1, 3, 8} ghost soldiers while sustained, each in an unoccupied square within range. At the end of each of your turns, you may move each of them up to 4 meters and make an attack roll with each soldier. For every soldier you move, you take 1 damage to your soul. For every soldier you make an attack with, you take 2 damage to your soul. On a hit, deal 25 rending damage to the target and 4 damage to the target's soul.

Ghostly Touch Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 3 human souls

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Skin** is carved with Soul Path dao. You can physically touch ethereal creatures and objects as if they were solid matter, and your unarmed attacks deal an additional 2 damage to the target's soul.

Guts Gu

Small stones that only grow on Dang Hun Mountain, a secluded domain of Heaven and Earth. Currently, Dang Hun Mountain is in the control of Hu Land Spirit. Since Guts Gu degenerate when taken away from Dang Hun Mountain, they must be transported using special container Gu, and thus their market price is between 5 and 10 thousand primeval stones. The only market in Southern Border that regularly stocks them is in Shang Clan City.

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 1 portion

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: Natural primeval essence (does not need fed)

Keywords: [**Expendable**], [**Unrefinable**]

Effect: Your current and maximum soul are permanently increased by 10.

Ironclad Soul Beetle Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 1 human soul

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**], [**Extinct**]

Effect: Your soul develops an exoskeleton of Soul Path dao. Whenever your soul is dealt damage by an attack or refinement backlash, reduce that damage by 2.

Piercing Shriek Gu

A dark purple cocoon warped to shape a shrieking face.

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 12 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You scream. Enemies that can hear you within range take damage to their soul equal to 5 + 10% of your current soul (rounded down). Your voice is exhausted, only allowing you to speak in a whisper until you sleep for at least 4 hours. If you activate Piercing Shriek Gu again before resting your voice, you are permanently mute afterwards.

Soul Armor Gu

Rank 1-5 Guard

Cost: 7 portions

Range: Self

Health: {10, 25, 60, 150, 450}

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your soul is shrouded in a dense shield that blocks it from attacks. Soul Armor Gu cannot block any damage. Whenever you would take damage to your soul from an external source, you may instead assign it to Soul Armor Gu.

External source just means the damage originated from somewhere other than you. This means Soul Armor Gu can't block damage from refinement, cultivation, backlash, directing enslaved creatures, or Gu that you activate that deal damage to your own soul.

Soul Fly Gu

Rank 4 Celerity

Cost: 6 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: You gain a flying speed equal to 2 + (2% current soul) meters (rounded down) and can make 3 Maneuvers each turn while sustained.

Soul Sense Gu

Rank 3 Divination

Cost: 2 primeval essence

Range: Self

Health: 11

Food: 5 maximum soul strength from a creature with a soul

Keywords: [**Investigative: Detect**]

Effect: You immediately sense the precise location of any creature with a soul, so long as the creature is within (5 + creature's current soul strength) meters of you.

Soul Strength Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your Strength attribute is permanently reduced by 5. Your maximum Soul is permanently increased by 5. Soul Strength Gu's effect can stack any number of times.

Spirit Incubating Flea Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 9

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You transfer your soul into Spirit Incubating Flea Gu. Your body enters a catatonic state and effectively dies. If another Gu Master places Spirit Incubating Flea Gu into their aperture, you may converse with them in their head.

Wicked Kiss Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Cost: 80 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 1

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Creatures have a -20 bonus to **Dodge** skill tests made to dodge your kiss. A creature you kiss has their soul drained. Their maximum soul is reduced by 10, and you gain 1 maximum and current soul.

Sound Path

Sound based investigative methods and attacks make up much of sound path. Its attacks are weaker than other offensive paths, but many shield Gu are unable to block sonic damage.

Clairaudiance Gu

Rank 1 Divination

Cost: 20 portions

Range: 250 meters

Health: 4

Food: 100 g Autumn Voice Grass (4 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Investigative: Hearing**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your hearing grows extremely sensitive. You can hear all noises made within range and judge their exact location. You have vulnerability to sonic damage.

Copper Warhorn Gu

Rank 1 Manifestation

Cost: 4 portions

Range: 1 km

Health: 10

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: The deafening sound of a horn fills the area within range for a few seconds. The sound is harmless.

Dampen Acoustics Gu

A fluffy ball of pink cotton.

Rank 3-5 Guard

Cost: 8 portions

Range: {4, 6, 8} meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Reduce all sonic damage dealt within range by {15, 40, 100} while sustained. No sounds can be produced within range, and all creatures within range gain the *deafened* condition.

Echo Gu

Rank 2-4 Guard

Cost: 16 portions

Range: Self

Health: {45, 100, 280}

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Whenever Echo Gu takes damage while sustained, all other creatures within 2 meters of you take half of the damage dealt (rounded down) as sonic damage.

Heart Sound Gu

When Heart Sound Gu is refined, two are created. They both appear like spiral conch shells, one is red and the other blue. If either dies, the Gu becomes useless.

Rank 2 Divination

Cost: 2 portions

Range: 100 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You concentrate your thoughts and transmit them to the holder (not owner) of the Heart Sound Gu paired with this Heart Sound Gu. The message can be up to 20 words long. The voice is tuned, allowing the reciever to determine gender but not age.

Heaven and Earth Magnificent Sound Gu

Rank 5 Attack

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 25 meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Your voice erupts with a beautiful but ear-piercing melody. All other creatures within range take 120 sonic damage.

Tripwire Gu

An infinitesmally thin worm that attaches itself to the wall and alerts the user when a creature passes through. Its biggest weakness is that there is no way to know which one was tripped if the user has multiple Tripwire Gu set up.

Rank 1 Divination

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 10

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You attach one end of Tripwire Gu to a wall, and the other end to another wall within 1 meter, forming a tripwire. Tripwire Gu becomes invisible and intangible, and if a creature passes through it you hear the sound of a bell in your head that wakes you up if you are sleeping.

Space Path

Teleportation is the essence of space path, but some offensive and defensive methods exist.

Archer's Paradox Gu

A cockroach, continuously folding in on itself

Rank 3, 5 Celerity

Cost: {10, 35} portions

Range: {10, 100} Meters

Health: 3

Food: {1, 100} kg of honey from a black pitch bee hive ({100, 10,000} primeval stones)

Effect: Archer's Paradox Gu can only be activated as a reaction to a projectile being used. Using your reaction to activate Archer's Paradox Gu ignores the [**Unreactable**] keyword.

- **Rank 3:** The projectile takes twice as long to hit, giving reacting creatures a -40 bonus to **Dodge** skill tests made to dodge it.
- **Rank 5:** The projectile is locked in place in the square of the user and is frozen. At the end of your next turn, the projectile continues as if it were just used, in a line towards the square its target was in when it was used, hitting the first creature in the line.

Dimensional Lock Gu

One of the signature methods of space path, Dimensional Lock Gu is very effective at preventing escapes and attacks. No teleportation Gu below rank 6 can pierce its effects. It appears as a floating glass box containing within the starry sky of black heaven.

Rank 4-5 Manifestation

Cost: 200 portions

Range: Self

Health: 24

Food: {10, 100} kg Emptiness Iron ({250, 2500} primeval stones)

Effect: For {1 hour, 1 day}, a {5, 15} meter cube, centered on the square you activated Dimensional Lock Gu on, becomes dimensionally locked. Creatures cannot teleport to any space inside the cube from outside of it. Creatures inside the cube cannot teleport at all. The cube is barely visible, and awareness checks made to see its edges have a +30 penalty.

Formless Space Gu

A hand-sized bowl made of wood. Looking inside reveals an inky black expanse.

Rank 1-4 Container

Cost: None

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Formless Space Gu cannot be activated. Items smaller than 50 cubic centimers can be placed inside Formless Space Gu, shrinking to fit if they are larger than the bowl. Formless Space Gu can contain up to {2, 5, 15, 40} kilograms of items. When a creature reaches inside Formless Space Gu, they immediately know exactly what items are inside and can withdraw an item as a bonus action.

Trip Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 4 portions

Range: 2 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Undodgeable**]

Effect: Trip Gu can only be activated as a reaction to a creature you can see within range moving. The space behind their leg is twisted to pull it out from under them. The target must succeed an **Athletics** test or else fall *prone*.

Strength Path

Strength Path is a dying path, with little advancement being made as time passes. Despite it being a bit weaker than other paths at higher ranks, many Gu Masters choose to cultivate it due to its relatively cheap cost. Gu Masters that are skilled at hand-to-hand combat will typically get the most out of strength path, but some longer-range methods do exist.

All-Out Effort Gu

A Rhinocerous Beetle with a long, black carapace, All-Out Effort Gu is an extinct Gu from the Olden Antiquity Era, when Strength Path flourished. Now, only a few still exist in the world.

Rank 1-5 Catalyst

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 15

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Extinct**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, whenever you roll to activate a beast phantom from a Strength Path Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower, you may forego the roll and trigger the beast phantom automatically.

[**Beast Strength**] *Many Gu of Strength Path belong to the beast strength archetype; Gu that, over many uses, permanently grant the user the strength of a particular beast. Curiously, it also enables users to sporadically summon beast phantoms with their unarmed attacks, increasing their potency.*

*While Beast Strength Gu do carve dao into the entire muscular system, they are still compatible with other muscle transformation [**Dao**] Gu, as long as that Gu is of a path compatible with Strength Path.*

Bear Strength Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of bear flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently increases by 10. For 24 hours, you cannot gain strength from Bear Strength Gu. Once you've gained 50 strength from Bear Strength Gu, activating Bear Strength Gu further has no effect on you, but you permanently gain the following feature:

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d6. If you roll a 1, a bear phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 5 force damage.

Beastman Strength Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of beastman flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently increases by 50. For 24 hours, you cannot gain strength from Beastman Strength Gu. Once you've gained 250 strength from Beastman Strength Gu, activating Beastman Strength Gu further has no effect on you, but you permanently gain the following feature:

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d10. If you roll a 1, a beastman phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 60 force damage.

Blobfish Strength Gu

A fat pink grub.

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: 10 kilograms of blobfish flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently decreases by 4 and you reduce all force damage dealt to your hit points by 1. For 24 hours, you cannot reduce your Strength attribute or gain damage reduction from Blobfish Strength Gu. Once you have lost 20 Strength and gained 5 damage reduction, further activations have no effect, but you permanently gain the following feature:

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d4. If you roll a 1, a blobfish phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 0 force damage and applying the *dazed* condition.

Boar Strength Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of boar flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently increases by 5. For 24 hours, you cannot gain strength from Boar Strength Gu. Once you've gained 25 strength from Boar Strength Gu, activating Boar Strength Gu further has no effect on you, but you permanently gain the following features:

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d4. If you roll a 1, a boar phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 2 force damage.

If you have enough movement to put yourself into a square adjacent to a target at least 3 meters away, you gain the following unarmed attack option:

Charge: You move at least 2 meters in a straight line towards a target. You and the target make an opposed **Close Combat** skill test. If you win, the target takes 1 force damage, +1 damage for every 10 points you have in Strength, and the target is knocked *prone*.

Crane Strength Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 kilograms of crane flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently increases by 2, and your **Flying** skill permanently increases by 2. For 24 hours, you cannot gain strength or **Flying** from Crane Strength Gu. Once you've gained 10 Strength and 10 **Flying** from Crane Strength Gu, activating Crane Strength Gu further has no effect on you, but you permanently gain the following features:

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d10. If you roll a 1, a Crane phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 2 force damage.

If this phantom triggers, you may immediately move 1 meter without triggering attacks of opportunity.

Crocodile Strength Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of crocodile flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently increases by 5. For 24 hours, you cannot gain strength from Crocodile Strength Gu. Once you've gained 25 strength from Crocodile Strength Gu, activating Crocodile Strength Gu further has no effect on you, but you permanently gain the following features:

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d4. If you roll a 1, a crocodile phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 2 force damage.

Your bite attacks deal an additional 10 rending damage.

Deer Strength Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of deer flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently increases by 4. For 24 hours, you cannot gain strength from Deer Strength Gu. Once you've gained 20 strength from Deer Strength Gu, activating Deer Strength Gu further has no effect on you, but you permanently gain the following features:

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d4. If you roll a 1, a deer phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 2 force damage.

Your movement is increased by 2 meters.

Elephant Strength Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of elephant flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently increases by 15. For 24 hours, you cannot gain strength from Elephant Strength Gu. Once you've gained 75 strength from Elephant Strength Gu, activating Elephant Strength Gu further has no effect on you, but you permanently gain the following features:

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d6. If you roll a 1, an Elephant phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 5 force damage.

When you hit a *prone* creature with a kicking attack, the attack automatically crits.

Leviathan Strength Gu

Rank 5 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of leviathan flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently increases by 100. For 24 hours, you cannot gain strength from Leviathan Strength Gu. Once you've gained 500 strength from Leviathan Strength Gu, activating Leviathan Strength Gu further has no effect on you, but you permanently gain the following features:

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d12. If you roll a 1, a leviathan phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 200 force damage.

You can breathe underwater and your body can withstand extreme pressure. Reduce all force damage dealt to your hit points by 200.

Serpent Strength Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of sea or land serpent flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently increases by 25. For 24 hours, you cannot gain strength from Serpent Strength Gu. Once you've gained 125 strength from Serpent Strength Gu, activating Serpent Strength Gu further has no effect on you, but you permanently gain the following features:

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d8. If you roll a 1, a serpent phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 15 force damage.

When you deal damage to a creature's hit points with a bite attack, apply the *poisoned* condition with the following effect:

- You take 5 poison damage at the start of each of your turns.
- Your movement is reduced by 1 and you have disadvantage on all **Dodge**, **Close Combat**, and **Ranged Attack** skill tests.

Shark-fin Wolf Strength Gu

Rank 4 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of shark-fin wolf flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently increases by 50. For 24 hours, you cannot gain strength from Shark-fin Wolf Strength Gu. Once you've gained 250 strength from Shark-fin Wolf Strength Gu, activating Shark-fin Wolf Strength Gu further has no effect on you, but you permanently gain the following features:

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d10. If you roll a 1, a shark-fin wolf phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 60 force damage.

When your hit points are reduced below half their maximum you gain *bloodlust*; You can sprint as a bonus action if another creature you can see has the *bleeding* condition.

Tanuki Strength Gu

A squirming brown worm with leather-like skin

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: 10 kilograms of Tanuki flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently increases by 3. Once you've gained 15 Strength from Tanuki Strength Gu, further activations have no effect, but you permanently gain the following features:

When you spend a luck point to reroll or gain a bonus to an unarmed attack, you gain an additional -20 bonus to the roll.

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d6. If you roll a 1, a Tanuki phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 5 force damage.

Tortoise Strength Gu

A washed out green beetle with a dense exoskeleton.

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 kilograms of turtle flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength and Fortitude attributes permanently increase by 1. For 24 hours, you cannot gain Strength or Fortitude from Tortoise Strength Gu. Once you have gained 5 Strength and Fortitude from Tortoise Strength Gu, further activations have no effect, but you permanently gain the following features:

When not in combat and struck by an attack, you may use a reaction to turn your back and reduce the damage of the attack by 5.

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d4. If you roll a 1, a Tortoise phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 2 force damage.

Wolf Strength Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 kg of wolf flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**]

Effect: Your **Muscular System** is carved with Strength Path dao; Your Strength attribute permanently increases by 5. For 24 hours, you cannot gain strength from Wolf Strength Gu. Once you've gained 25 strength from Wolf Strength Gu, activating Wolf Strength Gu further has no effect on you, but you permanently gain the following features:

Whenever you deal damage to a creature with an unarmed melee attack, roll 1d4. If you roll a 1, a wolf phantom appears behind you, increasing the damage of the attack by 2 force damage.

Your movement is increased by 1 meter.

[**END**]

Big Strength Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Your Strength attribute is increased by 50 for 3 turns.

Bitter Strength Gu

Bitter Strength Gu is a beetle with a oval and palm-sized body. Lumps grow on its back.

Rank 2-4 Catalyst

Cost: 8 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your Strength attribute is increased by {5, 10, 25} * your missing hit points.

Brute Force Longbeetle Gu

Rank 1 Catalyst

Cost: 30 portions

Range: Self

Health: 7

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Until the end of your next turn, your Strength attribute is increased by 100. If your Fortitude attribute is lower than 40, your Strength attribute is permanently reduced by 5 at the end of this effect.

Exert Strength Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 10

Range: 10 meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: You immediately make an **Athletics** skill test to lift, push, or pull an object within range, or you immediately make a **Grapple** or **Throw** combat action against a creature within range. If you successfully grapple a creature, they are *restrained* in their square while you sustain Extert Strength Gu. At the end of each of their turns, they can make an **Athletics** skill test with a +(10% of your Strength) (maximum of +40) penalty, deactivating Extert Strength Gu on a success.

Ivory Armor Gu

Rank 2-4 Guard

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: {70, 160, 350}

Food: 1 kg of elephant hundred beast king tusk (40 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Ivory armor begins to grow around your body. Ivory Armor Gu has no effect until the start of your next turn. All damage dealt to Ivory Armor Gu is reduced by 10% of your Strength attribute, rounded down. Ivory Armor Gu cannot block cold or sonic damage. The armor remains when you stop activating Ivory Armor Gu and has the following stats:

Ivory Armor	—
DT	6
HP	12
Dodge Penalty	+10
Movement Penalty	-1

The armor can be broken with a bonus action.

Normal Force Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: A number of portions equal to the total damage of the triggering attack

Range: Self

Health: 9

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Unreactable**]

Effect: Can be activated as a reaction to dealing damage with a punching or kicking attack. The force of the target's body that would resist your attack is instead redirected back towards the target. Double the damage dealt by the triggering attack. If the triggering attack was a kicking attack, the distance the target is knocked backwards is doubled.

[Path] Strength Gu

A series of Gu worms that exists for most paths, save for Human and Heaven. Used to augment attacks from other paths with your own strength.

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Supplementary**]

Effect: If the next Gu you activate before the end of your turn belongs [Path], add 10% of your Strength attribute, rounded down, to any damage dealt by it. When used as a supplementary Gu for a killer move with a core [Path] Gu that deals damage, add 10% of your Strength attribute, rounded down, to the damage dealt by the killer move.

Self Reliance Gu

A black cockroach with buzzing wings on its back

Rank 1-3 Tonic

Cost: 30 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: Natural primeval essence (none)

Effect: Immediately regain hit points equal to {2, 5, 10}% of your Strength attribute, rounded down.

Thunderclap Gu

Rank 2-4 Attack

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: {1, 10, 100} snap pebbles ({10, 100, 1,000} primeval stones)

Effect: You clap your hands together and a deafening noise shakes your surroundings. All creatures except for you within 3 meters of you take {2, 8, 25} + {1, 2, 5}% of your Strength attribute (rounded down to a minimum of 1) sonic and force damage. If the sonic damage is dealt to their hitpoints, they gain the *dazed* condition.

Toughen Up Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 80 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Torso** is carved with Strength Path dao, permanently increasing your maximum hit points by 25.

Sword Path

Pioneered by the legendary pseudo-venerable Bo Qing, sword path boasts some of the strongest attacks in the Gu world. Sword path's defensive methods are by comparison very weak.

Aegis Gu

Rank 2-3 Guard

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: {50, 120}

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Sustained**], [**Shield**]

Effect: While sustained, a spectral sword and shield manifest in front of you. Whenever a creature makes a **Close Combat** roll against you, you may use a reaction to have the sword swing at the attacker, dealing {35, 80} rending damage on a hit. Reduce all rending damage dealt to Aegis Gu by {5, 15}. Aegis Gu cannot block sonic damage.

Consecutive Slash Gu

Rank 2-4 Attack

Cost: 14 portions

Range: {1, 2, 3} meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You slash a target within range with a burst of sword qi. Make an attack roll; on a hit deal {15, 40, 90} rending damage, increased by {15, 40, 90} for each time you've hit the target with Consecutive Slash Gu this turn.

Flash Sword Gu

Rank 4 Celerity

Cost: 18 portions

Range: Self

Health: 11

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your movement is increased by 8 meters and you gain a -40 bonus to **Dodge** skill tests. You may forego your movement to instead fly in a straight line of up to 30 meters. If you move through an occupied square, that creature takes 120 rending damage. **Dodge** skill tests made to avoid this attack are made with a +40 penalty.

Pierce Gu

Rank 1-3 Attack

Cost: 25 portions

Range: {5, 10} meters

Health: 6

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Piercing**]

Effect: A piercing light shoots from your finger at a target within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit deal {5, 10, 30} force damage directly to their hit points.

Sabre Gu

A silver stickbug with a rear section shaped like a hilt.

Rank 2 Manifestation

Cost: 7 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: You manifest an invisible sabre in one of your free hands while sustained. If you used the first activation on your turn to activate Sabre Gu, you may expend your remaining activations to make a melee attack against an adjacent creature as part of the *Activate Gu* combat action. Melee attacks made with the sabre deal 30 rending damage and 20 force damage. If this damage is dealt to the target's hit points, they gain *bleeding 2.*

You don't add your Strength to the damage dealt by Sabre Gu.

Separate Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 8 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Splits an inanimate object of up to 1 cubic meter in volume perfectly in half. You can pick what direction it

splits as long as splitting it that way would create 2 halves of equal volume.

Sole Sword Gu

Rank 4-5 Carver

Cost: 4 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Carves sword dao into a weapon or Gu that deals rending damage. If rending damage from the weapon or Gu is assigned to a Gu of rank {4, 5} or less with the [**Shield**] Keyword, the defending [**Shield**] Gu is killed before the damage of the attack is assigned. After 24 hours, the weapon or Gu affected by Sole Sword Gu crumbles into dust.

[**Upgrade Path: Split Mountain Gu**]

Cut Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Next Rank: Slash Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 5

Food: A handful of ordinary grass

Effect: You throw an invisible and sharp crescent at a creature within range. Make an attack roll. On a hit, deal 5 rending damage. If this damage is dealt to a creature's hit points, they gain *bleeding 1*. **Dodge** skill tests to avoid this attack are made with a +20 penalty.

Slash Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Previous Rank: Cut Gu

Next Rank: Rend Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 8 meters

Health: 4

Food: 1 kg of shattered glass (1/4 primeval stone)

Effect: You throw a 1 meter wide curved blade in an 8 meter long line. All creatures in the area take 15 rending damage. If this damage is dealt to a creature's hit points, they gain *bleeding 2*.

Rend Gu

Rank 3 attack

Previous Rank: Slash Gu

Next Rank: Split Hill Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 20 meters

Health: 3

Food: 1 kg of sharpened blades of any size (1/2 primeval stone)

Effect: You throw a 1 meter wide curved blade in a 20 meter long line. All creatures in the area take 60 rending damage. If this damage is dealt to a creature's hit points, they gain *bleeding 3*.

Split Hill Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Previous Rank: Rend Gu

Next Rank: Split Mountain Gu

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 100 meters

Health: 3

Food: 10 Slash Gu

Effect: You throw a 3 meter wide blade of supercondensed sword qi in a 100 meter long line. All creatures in the area take 200 rending damage. If this damage is dealt to a creature's hit points, they gain *bleeding 5*. **Dodge** skill tests to avoid this attack are made with a +10 penalty.

Split Mountain Gu

Rank 5 Attack

Previous Rank: Split Hill Gu

Cost: 40 portions

Range: 500 meters

Health: 3

Food: 50 Rend Gu

Effect: You launch an enormous burst of sword qi in a line 5 meters wide, 10 meters tall, and 500 meters long. All creatures in the area take 600 rending damage. If this damage is dealt to a creature's hit points, they gain *bleeding 20*. **Dodge** skill tests to avoid this attack are made with a +20 penalty.

Discovered by Lord of Swords Jin Chang, Split Mountain Gu is named for his sundering of Mount Cao. To this day, a

great ravine splits the mountain in two, with the Jin and Cao clans living on either side.

[**END**]

Sharpen Gu

Rank 2-5 Carver

Cost: 35 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 11

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: Carves sword dao into a weapon or Gu that deals rending damage. If damage from an attack made with the weapon or Gu is assigned to a Gu of rank {2, 3, 4, 5} or less with the [**Shield**] Keyword, the defending [**Shield**] Gu takes rending damage equal to its hit points before the damage of the attack is assigned. If Sharpen Gu is used on a weapon, the effect is permanent. If used on a Gu, the effect lasts until the next time you activate the Gu.

Sword Sheath Gu

Rank 2-4 Guard

Cost: 8 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Whenever you are targeted by an attack from a Sword Path Gu or a physical weapon within range, you may activate Sword Sheathe Gu as a reaction to cover the Gu or weapon in a formless sheath, negating the triggering attack. The Gu or weapon cannot be forced out or used and the sheath has {10, 30, 120} hit points. It remains sheathed until the sheath is broken.

Theft Path

Theft path was invented by Thieving Heaven Demon Venerable, and contains great profundities of heaven. Mortal Theft Path methods are dangerous and hard to counter, but in return theft path has poor offensive capabilities.

Borrow {Ten, One Hundred} Jun Gu

Rank 3-4 Attack

Cost: 45 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: You touch a creature and violently extract their physical power. Their Strength attribute is reduced by {10, 100} (to a minimum of 0), and your Strength attribute is increased by {10, 100} while sustained.

Grand Thief Hand Gu

The pinnacle of Theft Path's extraction. A ghostly hand that bypasses defenses to plunge directly into an enemy's aperture.

Rank 5 Attack

Cost: 80 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A ghostly hand materializes and plunges into the aperture of a Gu Master you can see within range. A Gu from their aperture is grabbed and teleported into your aperture. If you can see inside their aperture, you may pick a Gu; one is selected at random otherwise.

Gu Laundering Gu

A shiny green dung beetle.

Rank 1-5 Catalyst

Cost: 10 * target Gu rank

Range: Touch

Health: 5

Food: Activating Gu Laundering Gu counts as feeding it.

Effect: Gu Laundering Gu devours a target Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower. Over the course of an hour, it spins a silk sac and implants it with a number of primeval stones based the the devoured Gu's rank:

Rank	Primeval Stones
1	50
2	200
3	1,000
4	5,000
5	25,000

Identity Theft Gu

Rank 4 Concealment

Cost: 60 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: You touch a human or variant human, or a corpse belonging to a human or variant human. Your face, body, voice, and even blood are permanently transformed to perfectly match theirs. You are completely indistinguishable from the target, fooling all [**Investigative**] Gu of rank 4 or lower. You retain your own attributes, skills, and memories.

If you interact with a creature that knew the target, the GM may call you to make an opposed skill test of your **Deception** against that creature's **Insight**; You and the creature both gain a bonus or penalty depending on how well you each knew the target's mannerisms:

Familiarity	Bonus/Penalty
Never met	+40
Met a few times	+20
Familiar	0
Friends	-20
Close friends	-40
Extremely close; family or spouse	-60

If you lose the skill test, the creature becomes suspicious of you. If you had 4 or more degrees of failure or rolled a fumble, they realize you are an impostor.

Invade Aperture Gu

Rank 4 Divination

Previous Rank: Size Up Gu

Cost: 40 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Investigative: Detect**]

Effect: Choose a Gu Master that you can see within range. You can sense everything in their aperture and their locations while sustained.

Least Resistance Gu

A silver stickbug.

Rank 3 Divination

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Deductive**]

Effect: Your thoughts bubble above your head. When you use Least Resistance Gu to make a *Deduction* action, you gain a -30 bonus to **Deduction** skill tests made to plan a stealthy infiltration.

Leech Life Gu

A vibrant orange and black carrion beetle.

Rank 2 Tonic

Cost: 5 portions

Range: 3 Meters

Health: 6

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: When you kill a creature, you may activate Leech Life Gu as a reaction to regain hit points equal to 10% of the dead creature's maximum hit points (rounded down to a minimum of 1).

Plagiarism Gu

A pillbug with gold leaf skin.

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: 5 written Gu recipes (not made by you)

Keywords: [**None**]

Effect: When following a Gu refinement recipe, you may activate Plagiarism Gu to destroy another Gu of the same rank as the one you are attempting to refine. Gain a -10 bonus to the **Refinement** skill test, stacking up to 5 times.

Plunder Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 5 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you wiggle your finger and attempt to pull a random Gu from the aperture of a Gu Master within range at the start of each of your turns. **Dodge** skill tests made to avoid this you pull a random Gu from their aperture and into your own. If you leave your current square for any reason while sustaining Plunder Gu, it deactivates and takes 1d4 damage.

Size Up Gu

A tiny beetle with a pattern like shattered glass on its carapace.

Rank 3 Divination

Next Rank: Invade Aperture Gu

Cost: 8 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Investigative: Detect**]

Effect: Choose a creature that you can see within range. You immediately know how many Gu are in their aperture as well as the highest rank between all Gu in their aperture.

Smuggler's Den Gu

Rank 1-5 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: A small pocket of Theft Path dao is placed within the primeval sea of your **Aperture**. [**Investigative**] Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} and lower that glimpse inside your aperture cannot see the pocket or anything inside of it. You can stow or withdraw an object or Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower from the pocket as a bonus action. If an object, it must be smaller than 50 cubic centimeters in volume; the

pocket can store up to {2, 5, 12, 30, 80} kilograms worth of objects and any number of Gu.

Steal Luck Gu

Rank 1 attack

Cost: 30 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 8

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Undodgeable**]

Effect: Choose a target you can see within range. If the target currently has a luck point and your luck points are below their maximum, you steal 1 luck point from the target.

[**Upgrade Path: Steal Sense Gu**]

Steal Touch Gu

Rank 1 Tonic

Next Rank: Steal Hearing Gu, Steal Sight Gu

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A creature you touch loses their sense of touch and taste while sustained. They gain advantage on **Perseverance** attribute tests made to overcome pain, such as from the *ablaze* condition and when they roll to see if they enter *Final Stand*.

Steal Hearing Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Previous Rank: Steal Touch Gu

Next Rank: Steal Sense Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A creature you touch loses their sense of hearing. They gain the *deafened* condition while sustained.

Steal Sight Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Previous Rank: Steal Touch Gu

Next Rank: Steal Sense Gu

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 1

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A creature you touch loses their sense of sight. They gain the *blinded* condition while sustained.

Steal Sense Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Previous Rank: Steal Hearing Gu, Steal Sight Gu

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A creature you touch loses all their senses while sustained. They gain the *blinded* and *deafened* conditions and gain advantage on **Perseverance** attribute tests made to overcome pain, such as from the *ablaze* condition and when they roll to see if they enter *Final Stand*.

[**END**]

Transfer Momentum Gu

Rank 2 Guard

Cost: 4 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Can only be activated as a reaction to a creature missing you with a melee attack. You steal the momentum of their strike, stopping them in their tracks and making you immediately move a number of meters equal to 2% of the triggering creature's Strength attribute (rounded down to a minimum of 1) in a straight line without triggering attacks of opportunity. If you hit a wall or creature, you and the wall or creature take force damage equal to 2% of the triggering creature's Strength attribute.

Void Pocket Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 50 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: A stolen Gu

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: A small fold is permanently etched into your **Head** in the space behind your ear. This void pocket can store one Gu or object smaller than 10 cubic centimeters. Items stored here cannot be detected by [**Investigative**] Gu of rank 1 and do not count toward your carried weight.

Time Path

Manipulates the River of Time to speed up, slow down, and even stop the passage of time. Time Path methods and refinement materials are very rare, and the refinement cost and market price of Time Path Gu is quadruple the normal price that would be paid for the same rank of Gu.

Acceleration Fruit Gu

A bunch of grey berries that burst into freshwater when chewed.

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: None

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable 5**]

Effect: Eating a berry from Acceleration Fruit Gu counts as activating it once. You may eat a berry from Acceleration Fruit Gu as a bonus action. When you do, you may make an additional combat action this turn. Eating multiple berries on a single turn has no effect beyond the first.

Autumn Cicada Gu

Rank 5 Attack

Cost: 80 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: Water from the River of Time (does not need fed)

Effect: A creature that you touch immediately loses 5 years of their lifespan.

Backtrack Gu

Rank 4-5 Divination

Cost: 80 portions

Range: 50 meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Backtrack Gu projects a hologram in front of you displaying the area within range. It begins by displaying the surroundings as they appeared {3 days, 1 year} ago, and you can speed up and slow down the video feed at will, displaying what occured in the area at any time within the duration. The video feed shows creatures concealed by Gu of rank {3, 4} or lower.

Gu as Before Gu

Rank 4-5 Tonic

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A Gu or Gu corpse of rank {4, 5} or lower that you touch is returned to the state it was in 1 minute ago. This effect resurrects dead Gu if they were killed less than a minute ago.

Man as Before Gu

Rank 5 Tonic

Cost: 90 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A creature or corpse within range is transported up the River of Time to their state exactly 5 minutes ago. This effect resurrects a corpse as long as they have been dead for less than 5 minutes and their soul has not been destroyed.

Mountain as Before Gu

Rank 5 Tonic

Cost: 70 portions

Range: 100 meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A mountain that you can see within range is transported up the River of Time and reverted to the state it was in 1 year ago.

Rewind Gu

Rank 1-5 Guard

Cost: 90 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Rewind Gu can only be activated as a reaction to another creature you can see within range activating a Gu of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower. The effect of that Gu is negated. Rewind Gu cannot be used to negate the effect of a killer move.

River as Before Gu

Rank 5 Tonic

Cost: 50 portions

Range: 100 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A river that you can see within range is transported up the River of Time and reverted to the state it was in 1 year ago. This effect reverts all portions of the river within 100 kilometers of you.

Self Acceleration Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Previous Rank: Acceleration Fruit Gu

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You gain an additional combat action this turn. At the end of your turn, if you aren't under the effect of any [**Dao**] Gu belonging to Time Path, your body becomes chronologically confused and you gain the *fatigued* condition. If you already had the *fatigued* condition, you instead gain the *stunned* condition.

Slow Down Gu

Rank 3 Guard

Cost: 8 portions

Range: 20 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Slow Down Gu can only be activated as a reaction to an object you can see within range being thrown or launched. The object slows significantly, and **Dodge** tests made to avoid it can be made without expending a reaction and automatically succeed.

Slow Steps Gu

Rank 1-3 Attack

Cost: 20 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Choose up to {1, 2, 5} creatures that you can see within range. While sustained, each target is slowed while they remain within range; their movement is reduced to half (rounded down to a minimum of 1), they have 1 fewer reaction each turn, and they gain a +20 penalty to all **Dodge** skill tests and attack rolls.

Split Second Gu

A fuzzy old Mayfly.

Rank 1-5 Celerity

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: 1 lb of fine sand

Effect: Split Second Gu can be activated without using a reaction when an [**Unreactable**] Gu is activated by another creature you can see. You make a reaction against it as normal. Skill tests made as part of the reaction have a {+80, +60, +30, +10, -10} modifier.

Spring Cicada Gu

Rank 5 Guard

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: Water from the River of Time (does not need fed)

Effect: Spring Cicada Gu can only be activated as a reaction to gaining a condition (including *dying* and *final stand*). Your body swims upwards on the River of Time to restore itself to a state before it received the condition, removing the condition and restoring your hit points to the number they were at before the triggering effect. Other creatures can still be affected by the original attack, and you can still be affected by its lingering effects.

Time Concealment Gu

Rank 3-4 Concealment

Cost: 9 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, creatures that perceive you instead see the area at a different point in time when you were not there. You are undetectable to [**Investigative**] Gu of rank {3, 4} or lower, unless that Gu belongs to Time Path.

Time Luck Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 1

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Time Luck Gu can only be activated as a reaction to making or failing a skill test. You expend 6 months of your lifespan and gain a -50 bonus to the triggering skill test if you hadn't yet rolled it, or reroll the skill test if you had.

Third Watch Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: None

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: 100 g of silver (50 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: A silver triangle tattoo permanently appears on your **Torso**. Your body and aperture now flow 3 times as quickly down the River of Time. Your natural primeval essence recovery speed is tripled, you may expend triple the normal maximum primeval essence when breaking through small realms through cultivation, the required time to break through large realms through cultivation is divided by 3 (rounded up), and every year that passes, your remaining lifespan is reduced by 3 years.

Transformation Path

Changing the users body temporarily. Transformation Path Gu Masters rely on acquiring a full set of Gu for a particular transformation. When using all component Gu together, they form a killer move that the Gu Master does not need to deduce. Transformation Path is very balanced, but each transformation has strengths and weaknesses.

[**Azure Wolf Transformation**]

Azure wolves are a nearly extinct mutated beast that grow more energetic the longer they battle.

Azure Wolf Bite Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your head transforms into an Azure Wolf head. While sustained, you gain the following features:

Your sense of smell is vastly improved, and you can now make **Awareness** skill tests to identify and follow scents.

Your bite attacks deal an additional 50 rending damage.

Azure Wolf Claw Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Cost: 4 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your hands and feet become paws, complete with razor sharp claws. Your movement is increased by 4 meters while on all fours and your punching and kicking attacks deal an additional 30 rending damage. If this damage is dealt to the target's hit points, they gain *bleeding 5*.

Azure Wolf Skin Gu

Rank 4 Guard

Cost: 12 portions

Range: Self

Health: 600

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, thick Azure Wolf hairs sprout all over your body, covering you in a protective coat. Azure Wolf Skin Gu cannot block sonic damage.

[**End**]

Big Teeth Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 7 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: 1 kg of mountain sabertooth tusks

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your canine teeth grow into 8 cm long razor-sharp fangs. Your bite attacks deal an additional 20 rending damage.

Black Mane Gu

Rank 2 Guard

Cost: 14 portions

Range: Self

Health: 100

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your body is covered in a dense thicket of black fur while sustained. Using Black Mane Gu dyes your hair black, which slowly fades over the course of a month. Black Mane Gu cannot block sonic damage.

Bone Wings Gu

Rank 4 Manifestation

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Over the course of an hour, your vertebrae sprout new bone that pierces outwards from your **Torso** to form

wings made of bone. You have a flying speed of 8 meters and can execute 4 Maneuvers each turn.

Cold Blood Gu

Rank 1 Concealment

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 6

Food: 100 milliliters of reptile blood (1/4 Primeval Stone)

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Blood** becomes cold, completely erasing your heat signature. You gain vulnerability to cold damage and reduce all heat damage dealt to your hit points by 4.

Frog Legs Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 35 portions

Range: Self

Health: 12

Food: 1 kg of frog legs (1 Primeval Stone)

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Leg Muscles** grow thick and fibrous. Whenever you jump, double your jump distance upwards or forwards. You no longer take fall damage from falls of 15 meters or less. Falls of more than 15 meters deal 3 damage for every meter you fell more than 15.

Jade Skin Gu

Rank 1-5 Guard

Cost: 16 portions

Range: Self

Health: {55, 120, 250, 525, 1100}

Food: {1, 4, 9, 16, 25} jade stones

Keywords: [**Sustained**], [**Defensive**], [**Shield**]

Effect: Your body is shrouded in jade while sustained. You are not a valid target for Gu with a range of *Touch.*

[**Lava Crocodile Transformation**]

Lava Crocodile Cannon Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 25 portions

Range: 8 meters

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you can shoot a ball of molten rock from your mouth to a square you can see within range as an activation. The magma explodes at the location; creatures within a 1 meter radius of the target square take 15 force damage, 15 heat damage, and gain the *burning* condition.

A 1 meter radius centered on the target square is filled with lava and considered *Difficult Terrain*; creatures that move into or end their turn in the area take 10 heat damage and gain the *burning* condition. The magma cools into an ordinary stone surface after 1 hour or after being doused.

Lava Crocodile Jaw Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 6 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your teeth grow red hot and your saliva boils from your mouth while sustained. Your bite attacks deal an additional 10 heat damage.

Lava Crocodile Scales Gu

Rank 2 Guard

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 80

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Obsidian scales cover your body while sustained. Lava Crocodile Scales Gu has invulnerability to heat damage and vulnerability to cold damage. Lava Crocodile Scales Gu cannot block sonic damage.

Lava Crocodile Tail Gu

Rank 1 Celerity

Cost: 2 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you no longer consider water or lava to be *Difficult Terrain.*

[**END**]

Longarm Gu

Rank 1 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 8

Food: 5 kg of monkey flesh (1 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your arms grow dramatically in length, increasing the range of your punching and weapon attacks by 1 meter while sustained. Your touch range also increases by 1 meter.

Ram's Head Gu

A red and off-white reindeer horn beetle.

Rank 3 Manifestation

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 1 Skull of a horned mammal (3 Primeval Stones)

Effect: You grow blunt horns and gain the following melee attack:

- **Ram's Horns:** You headbutt a creature in an adjacent square. Make a **Close Combat** skill test. On a hit, deal 10 force damage, +1 damage for every 10 points you have in Strength. If the target is under the effect of a Gu with the [**Shield**] keyword, this damage is doubled. After using this melee attack, your horns fall off.

[**Upgrade Path: Flying Zombie Gu**]

Roaming Zombie Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Next Rank: Hairy Zombie Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health:

Food: 10 kg rotting human flesh

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Sustained**], [**Transformation**]

Effect: While sustained, your body transforms into that of a roaming zombie, granting you the following effects:

Your maximum hit points are 80.

You regain 8 hit points at the start of each of your turns.

Your brain is your only vital organ.

You gain immunity to the *bleeding*, *fatigued*, and *posioned* conditions.

You gain vulnerability to heat and shock damage.

While exposed to direct light, you suffer a +20 penalty to all skill tests.

Your lifespan is not consumed over time.

At the start of each of your turns, make a **Perseverance** attribute test. On a failure, you gain a **Livor Mortis Token**. If you gain your tenth **Livor Mortis Token** from Roaming Zombie Gu, your body is permanently transformed into a mindless zombie and you die.

As long as you have 9 or fewer **Livor Mortis Tokens**, every month you go without gaining a **Livor Mortis Token** reduces the number of **Livor Mortis Tokens** you have by 1.

Hairy Zombie Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Previous Rank: Roaming Zombie Gu

Next Rank: Hopping Zombie Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Sustained**], [**Transformation**]

Effect: While sustained, your body transforms into that of a hairy zombie, granting you the following effects:

Your maximum hit points are 125.

You regain 15 hit points at the start of each of your turns.

Your brain is your only vital organ.

You gain immunity to the *bleeding*, *fatigued*, and *posioned* conditions.

You gain vulnerability to heat and shock damage.

While exposed to direct light, you suffer a +20 penalty to all skill tests.

Your lifespan is not consumed over time.

At the start of each of your turns, make a **Perseverance** attribute test with a +10 penalty. On a failure, you gain a **Livor Mortis Token**. If you gain your tenth **Livor Mortis Token** from Hairy Zombie Gu, your body is permanently transformed into a hairy zombie. Your natural primeval essence recovery rate is reduced to 0.

As long as you have 9 or fewer **Livor Mortis Tokens**, every month you go without gaining a **Livor Mortis Token** reduces the number of **Livor Mortis Tokens** you have by 1.

Hopping Zombie Gu

Rank 4 Carver

Previous Rank: Hairy Zombie Gu

Next Rank: Asura Zombie Gu, Blood Wight Zombie Gu, Earth Chief Zombie Gu, Heavenly Demon Zombie Gu, Nightmare Zombie Gu, Plague Zombie Gu

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Sustained**], [**Transformation**]

Effect: While sustained, your body transforms into that of a hopping zombie, granting you the following effects:

Your maximum hit points are 200.

You regain 25 hit points at the start of each of your turns.

Your jumping distance is doubled.

Your brain is your only vital organ.

You gain immunity to the *bleeding*, *fatigued*, and *posioned* conditions.

You gain vulnerability to heat and shock damage.

While exposed to direct light, you suffer a +20 penalty to all skill tests.

Your lifespan is not consumed over time.

At the start of each of your turns, make a **Perseverance** attribute test with a +20 penalty. On a failure, you gain a **Livor Mortis Token**. If you gain your tenth **Livor Mortis Token** from Hairy Zombie Gu, your body is permanently transformed into a hopping zombie. Your natural primeval essence recovery rate is reduced to 0.

As long as you have 9 or fewer **Livor Mortis Tokens**, every month you go without gaining a **Livor Mortis Token** reduces the number of **Livor Mortis Tokens** you have by 1.

Asura Zombie Gu

Rank 5 Carver

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Sustained**], [**Transformation**]

Effect: While sustained, your body transforms into that of an Asura Zombie, granting you the following effects:

Your maximum hit points are 600.

You regain 50 hit points at the start of each of your turns.

You gain 6 additional arms.

Your brain is your only vital organ.

You gain a flying speed of 6 meters and can execute 4 Maneuvers each turn.

You gain immunity to the *bleeding*, *fatigued*, and *posioned* conditions.

You gain vulnerability to heat and shock damage.

While exposed to direct light, you suffer a +20 penalty to all skill tests.

Your lifespan is not consumed over time.

At the start of each of your turns, make a **Perseverance** attribute test with a +40 penalty. On a failure, you gain a **Livor Mortis Token**. If you gain your tenth **Livor Mortis Token** from Asura Zombie Gu, your body is permanently transformed into an Asura Zombie. Your natural primeval essence recovery rate is reduced to 0.

As long as you have 9 or fewer **Livor Mortis Tokens**, every month you go without gaining a **Livor Mortis Token** reduces the number of **Livor Mortis Tokens** you have by 1.

Blood Wight Zombie Gu

Rank 5 Carver

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao: Blood**], [**Sustained**], [**Transformation**]

Effect: While sustained, your body transforms into that of a Blood Wight Zombie, granting you the following effects:

Your maximum hit points are 400.

You regain 100 hit points at the start of each of your turns.

Your brain is your only vital organ.

You gain a flying speed of 8 meters and can execute 3 Maneuvers each turn.

You gain immunity to the *bleeding*, *fatigued*, and *posioned* conditions.

You gain vulnerability to heat and shock damage.

While exposed to direct light, you suffer a +20 penalty to all skill tests.

Your lifespan is not consumed over time.

At the start of each of your turns, make a **Perseverance** attribute test with a +40 penalty. On a failure, you gain a **Livor Mortis Token**. If you gain your tenth **Livor Mortis Token** from Blood Wight Zombie Gu, your body is permanently transformed into a Blood Wight Zombie. Your natural primeval essence recovery rate is reduced to 0.

As long as you have 9 or fewer **Livor Mortis Tokens**, every month you go without gaining a **Livor Mortis Token** reduces the number of **Livor Mortis Tokens** you have by 1.

Earth Chief Zombie Gu

Rank 5 Carver

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao: Earth**], [**Sustained**], [**Transformation**]

Effect: While sustained, your body transforms into that of an Earth Chief Zombie, granting you the following effects:

Your maximum hit points are 1000, and your base movement is 5 meters.

You regain 30 hit points at the start of each of your turns.

Your brain is your only vital organ.

You gain a flying speed of 6 meters and can execute 2 Maneuvers each turn.

You gain immunity to the *bleeding*, *dazed*, *fatigued*, *posioned*, and *stunned* conditions and cannot be knocked prone.

You gain vulnerability to heat damage.

While exposed to direct light, you suffer a +20 penalty to all skill tests.

Your lifespan is not consumed over time.

At the start of each of your turns, make a **Perseverance** attribute test with a +40 penalty. On a failure, you gain a **Livor Mortis Token**. If you gain your tenth **Livor Mortis Token** from Earth Chief Zombie Gu, your body is permanently transformed into an Earth Chief Zombie. Your natural primeval essence recovery rate is reduced to 0.

As long as you have 9 or fewer **Livor Mortis Tokens**, every month you go without gaining a **Livor Mortis Token** reduces the number of **Livor Mortis Tokens** you have by 1.

Heavenly Demon Zombie Gu

Rank 5 Carver

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao: Light**], [**Sustained**], [**Transformation**]

Effect: While sustained, your body transforms into that of a Heavenly Demon Zombie, granting you the following effects:

Your maximum hit points are 300.

You regain 30 hit points at the start of each of your turns.

Your brain is your only vital organ.

You gain a flying speed of 10 meters and can execute 3 Maneuvers each turn.

You gain immunity to the *bleeding*, *fatigued*, and *posioned* conditions.

You gain vulnerability to heat and shock damage.

While exposed to direct light, you gain a -20 bonus on all **Dodge**, **Flying**, **Close Combat** and **Ranged Attack** skill tests.

While not exposed to direct light, you gain a -20 bonus on all **Awareness**, **Cultivation**, **Deduction**, and **Refinement** skill tests.

Your lifespan is not consumed over time.

At the start of each of your turns, make a **Perseverance** attribute test with a +40 penalty. On a failure, you gain a **Livor Mortis Token**. If you gain your tenth **Livor Mortis Token** from Heavenly Demon Zombie Gu, your body is permanently transformed into a Heavenly Demon Zombie. Your natural primeval essence recovery rate is reduced to 0.

As long as you have 9 or fewer **Livor Mortis Tokens**, every month you go without gaining a **Livor Mortis Token** reduces the number of **Livor Mortis Tokens** you have by 1.

Nightmare Zombie Gu

Rank 5 Carver

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao: Dark**], [**Sustained**], [**Transformation**]

Effect: While sustained, your body transforms into that of a Nightmare Zombie, granting you the following effects:

Your maximum hit points are 300.

You regain 30 hit points at the start of each of your turns.

Your brain is your only vital organ.

You gain a flying speed of 10 meters and can execute 3 Maneuvers each turn.

You gain immunity to the *bleeding*, *fatigued*, and *posioned* conditions.

You gain vulnerability to heat and shock damage.

While exposed to direct light, you suffer a +20 penalty to all skill tests.

When you hit a creature with a melee attack, they take 50 damage to their soul.

Your lifespan is not consumed over time.

At the start of each of your turns, make a **Perseverance** attribute test with a +40 penalty. On a failure, you gain a **Livor Mortis Token**. If you gain your tenth **Livor Mortis Token** from Nightmare Zombie Gu, your body is permanently transformed into a Nightmare Zombie.

As long as you have 9 or fewer **Livor Mortis Tokens**, every month you go without gaining a **Livor Mortis Token** reduces the number of **Livor Mortis Tokens** you have by 1.

Plague Zombie Gu

Rank 5 Carver

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao: Poison**], [**Sustained**], [**Transformation**]

Effect: While sustained, your body transforms into that of a Plague Zombie, granting you the following effects:

Your maximum hit points are 800.

You regain 10 hit points at the start of each of your turns.

Your brain is your only vital organ.

You gain a flying speed of 5 meters and can execute 3 Maneuvers each turn.

You gain immunity to the *bleeding*, *fatigued*, and *posioned* conditions.

You gain vulnerability to heat and shock damage.

While exposed to direct light, you suffer a +20 penalty to all skill tests.

Your lifespan is not consumed over time.

At the start of each of your turns, make a **Perseverance** attribute test with a +40 penalty. On a failure, you gain a **Livor Mortis Token**. If you gain your tenth **Livor Mortis Token** from Plague Zombie Gu, your body is permanently transformed into a Plague Zombie.

As long as you have 9 or fewer **Livor Mortis Tokens**, every month you go without gaining a **Livor Mortis Token** reduces the number of **Livor Mortis Tokens** you have by 1.

If another creature starts their turn within 3 meters of you, they gain the *Poisoned* condition with the following effects:

- You take 50 poison damage at the end of each of your turns.
- You have disadvantage on all skill tests.

[**END**]

Wide Knuckle Gu

Rank 1 Catalyst

Cost: 7 portions

Range: Self

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your hands grow to double their original size. You gain a -10 bonus to **Close Combat** skill tests on punching attacks and your punching attacks deal an additional 2 force damage.

[**Wind Scythe Bird Transformation**]

Wind Scythe Birds are a terrifyingly fast predator from Northern Plains. Their feathers are sharp as razors, and their diminutive size paired with extreme speed makes them very difficult to hit.

Wind Scythe Bird Plumes Gu

Rank 2 Guard

Cost: 3 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your body sprouts razor sharp feathers while sustained. Creatures take 10 rending damage whenever:

- They hit you with an unarmed melee attack
- You successfully grapple them

If this damage is dealt to their hit points, they gain *bleeding 2.*

Wind Scythe Bird Wings Gu

Rank 3 Celerity

Cost: 18 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your arms transform into wings with razor sharp feathers. While sustained, you have a flying speed of 15 meters and can make 3 Maneuvers every turn. You can no longer make punching attacks, but gain the following unarmed melee attack option:

Wings: Make a **Close Combat** skill test against a creature within 1 meter of you. On a hit, deal 20 rending damage, increased to 50 rending damage if performed at the end of a *Dive* Maneuver. If this damage is dealt to the target's hit points, they gain *bleeding 4.*

[**End**]

Water Path

Manipulates water and fluids. More defensive, but water path attacks can still be devastating.

Blood to Water Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: 1 kg of dried blood from a water path myriad beast king (500 primeval stones)

Effect: A creature you touch has their blood transmuted into water. In most cases, this kills the creature.

Blue Farm Slug Gu

A blue slug, larger than

Rank 3 Container

Cost: 4 portions

Range: Self

Health: 350

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Huge**], [**Steed**]

Effect: You place items up to a cubic meter in volume inside of Blue Farm Slug Gu. Blue Farm Slug Gu can hold objects, Gu, and creatures, but creatures cannot breathe while inside. You may remove items from Blue Farm Slug Gu by reaching inside. Blue Farm Slug Gu can hold up to 2,000 kilograms.

Blue Farm Slug Gu cannot be stored in an aperture and has a speed of 3 meters.

Carapace Gu

Rank 2 Guard

Cost: 12 portions

Range: Self

Health: 6

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: A sleek turtle shell forms around your torso. Whenever you are hit by an attack roll that was not a called shot, there is a 50% chance it hits your torso. Reduce all damage dealt to your torso by 40. If your torso takes more than 40 damage from a single attack, Carapace Gu deactivates and takes 1d6 damage as backlash.

Dilute Poison Gu

Rank 4-5 Tonic

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A creature you touch has all instances of the *poisoned* condition removed if it was applied by a Gu of rank {4, 5} or lower.

Drown Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Cost: 75 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You touch a creature and its lungs fill with water. It must spend its entire next turn doubled over coughing and cannot use movement, combat actions, or bonus actions. If the creature is unable to, like if it were unconscious for example, it dies.

Faucet Gu

Rank 1 Manifestation

Cost: 4 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 10

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: 5 liters of fresh water pours from your fingertip. If poured on a creature, they gain the *doused* condition.

Fish Scales Gu

Rank 1-3 Guard

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: {45, 100, 225}

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your skin turns into layered scales while sustained. Reduce all cold damage dealt to Fish Scales Gu by {5, 12, 30}. Fish Scales Gu cannot block sonic damage.

Flow Gu

Rank 2 Celerity

Cost: 3 portions

Next Rank: Water Trace Gu

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 1 liter of distilled water

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your movement is increased by 1 meter. You no longer consider swimming in water to be *Difficult Terrain*.

Geyser Gu

A white horsefly with oversized wings.

Rank 3 Manifestation

Cost: 25 portions

Range: 10 Meters

Health: Food: 10 lbs of waterfall water

Effect: A 1 meter radius geyser, centered on a square you can see within range, spouts 15 meters high. Creatures in the area gain the *doused* condition, and [Large] or smaller creatures in the area are thrown 15 meters up, becoming *airborne*. If already *airborne*, they must pass an **Athletics** or **Flying** skill test with a +25 penalty or fall as if they failed a dive Maneuver.

Jelly Bubble Gu

Rank 2 Guard

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 140

Food: 1 kg of mashed fruits (1/4 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you're surrounded by a bubble of viscous jelly. You cannot breathe, move, dodge, or make melee attacks, and you gain immunity to the *ablaze*, *burning*, and *doused* conditions. You are not a valid target for Gu with a range of *Touch*. Reduce all force and sonic damage dealt to Jelly Bubble Gu by 10.

Land Becomes Sea Gu

Rank 3-4 Manifestation

Cost: 160 portions

Range: {5, 20} meters

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: All earth, soil, and stone within range is transmuted into an equal volume of water.

Liquid Flesh Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: You are assailed with the feeling of your flesh and bones melting and reincorporating. Your **Muscles** and **Bones** are permanently carved with Water Path dao, becoming more malleable. Reduce all force damage dealt to your hit points or dealt by your unarmed attacks by 10. You can squeeze through gaps as small as 5 centimeters.

Spiral Water Arrow Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Cost: 12 portions

Range: 7 meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: An arrow of water spinning at breakneck speed is launched from your palm at a target within range. Make an attack roll; on a hit, deal 70 force damage and the target gains the *doused* condition.

Spring Rain Gu

Rank 3 Tonic

Cost: 40 portions

Range: 50 meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Spring Rain Gu has no effect unless activated outside. Clouds form high above you in the sky and a light rain falls within range. All creatures touched by the rain immediately regain 5 hit points. At the start of each of your turns while sustained, all creatures within range regain 5 hit points.

Steam Burst Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 8 portions

Range: 2 meters

Health: 3

Food: 100 g of smoldering stone (1 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A cloud of steam surrounds you in a 2 meter radius while you sustain Steam Burst Gu. Creatures cannot see through the steam; all creatures inside gain the *blinded* condition and have a +20 penalty to **Dodge** skill tests while in the steam. When a creature moves into or starts their turn in the steam (including you), they take 10 heat damage.

Creatures in the area are immune to the *burning* condition (but not *ablaze*).

Stream Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 2 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 7

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You fire a pressurized stream of water from your index finger at a target within range. Make an attack roll with a -30 bonus. On a hit, deal 3 force damage.

Undertow Gu

An upturned helmet, full of sloshing mud

Rank 2-3 Manifestation

Cost: 20 portions

Range: {4, 8} Meters

Health: 3

Food: 1 lb of River Moss

Effect: Water rushes from the earth in a line {4, 8} meters long and {4, 8} meters wide. This puts out fires and applies the *doused* condition, deals {5, 20} force damage, and forces creatures standing in *Difficult Terrain* to pass an **Athletics** skill test or be knocked prone. If the ground in the line is made of soil, it becomes a thick mud and is considered *Difficult Terrain.*

Water Armor Gu

Rank 3 Guard

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Self

Health: 300

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: A thin membrane of water envelopes your body while sustained. You are no longer a valid target for Gu with a range of *Touch*, and you gain immunity to the *burning* and *ablaze* conditions.

Reduce all sonic damage dealt to Water Armor Gu by 15. Water Armor Gu is vulnerable to shock and rending damage and has resistance to heat damage.

Water Trace Gu

Rank 3 Celerity

Cost: 4 portions

Previous Rank: Flow Gu

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your movement is increased by 2 meters while sustained. You no longer consider swimming in water to be *Difficult Terrain* and can move 3 meters in water for every 1 meter of movement expended.

Wind Path

Manipulation of air currents and storms. Wind path methods usually need to be sustained several turns before they reach full strength. It is very rare for a wind path Gu Master to not also be a master of flying.

Air Resistance Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 4 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your movement makes no sound, including jumping, climbing, and sprinting. You also fall at a rate of 10 meters per turn (at the start of each of your turns) and take no damage from falling. You may activate Air Resistance Gu as a reaction when you're sent *airborne.* If you have a flying speed greater than 10 meters, it is reduced to 10 meters.

Cloud Rope Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Cost: 20 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 4 Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You condense a rope of clouds. You may throw the rope like a lasso at a creature within range as a bonus action. Make an attack roll; on a hit, the creature gains the *restrained* condition. If you miss, the effect ends. The creature can use a combat action to attempt to break free by making an **Athletics** skill test with a +10 penalty. If they succeed, this effect ends.

As an activation, you may duplicate the cloud rope. Doing so increases the penalty on the **Athletics** test by +10, stacking up to a total of a +100 penalty.

Cyclone-Lung Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 8

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Lungs** are permanently expanded to hold massive amounts of air. You can hold your breath for up to 1 hour. As a combat action you can take a deep breath and blow the air from your lungs. All [Medium] or smaller creatures in a 3 meter long line must succeed an **Athletics** test or else be knocked 2 meters backward. They do not take additional damage from colliding into creatures or objects.

Feather Step Gu

Rank 1 Celerity

Cost: 2 portions

Range: Self

Health: 8

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your movement makes no sound.

Free Spirit Gu

A small blue gnat.

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 5 portions

Range: 10 Meters

Health: 2

Food: 1 kg honey cactus flesh (15 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your movements are implacable and flow easily. Your movement doesn't trigger attacks of opportunity and you gain advantage on skill tests made against enemy **Grapple** combat actions.

Fierce Wind Gu

Rank 2 Guard

Next Rank: Hurricane Gu

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**]

Effect: Winds pick up in a 2 meter radius, centered on the square you were in when you activated Fierce Wind Gu. **Ranged Attack** attack rolls made against any creature

within the area are made with a +20 penalty. The winds disperse after one minute.

Flying Cloud Gu

Rank 3 Manifestation

Cost: 35 portions

Range: 1 meter

Health: 4

Food: 1 kg of cloud soil (40 primeval stones)

Effect: You manifest a [**Medium**] fluffly cloud in an adjacent square that you can ride atop. While riding the cloud, you have a flying speed of 10 meters and can make 1 Maneuver each turn. You also gain a +20 penalty to **Flying** skill tests. The cloud disappears after 2 hours.

Hurricane Gu

Rank 3 Manifestation

Pervious Rank: Fierce Wind Gu

Cost: 35 portions

Range: 500 meters

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: Galeforce winds begin spinning within range. While sustained, the winds grow stronger at the start of each of your turns. **Ranged Attack** attack rolls made by creatures within range are made with a +10 penalty, with an additional +10 penalty for every time the winds have grown stronger (maximum of +30). If the attack roll originates from a Gu of wind path, it instead gains a -10 bonus, with an additional -10 bonus for every time the winds have grown stronger (maximum of -30). If used in conjunction with large volumes of water, such as over a lake or using a Gu that produces large amounts of water, that water is spread over the area, causing flooding.

Strength Gust Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 12 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 3

Food: 100 g of feather soil (2 primeval stones)

Effect: A huge gust of wind forces all [Large] or smaller creatures in a 3 meter wide, 5 meter long line to make an **Athletics** skill test. On a failure, they are pushed 2 meters away in the direction of the line and land *prone.*

Wind Sense Gu

Rank 1 Carver

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: 1 dandelion seed

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Skin** is carved with Wind Path dao, permanently making your hairs extremely sensitive to air currents. You can ignore the *blinded* condition when attacking a creature within 5 meters of you and can sense the exact location of any creature or object that moves within 5 meters of you. You also gain a -5 bonus to **Dodge** tests.

Wind Sword Gu

Rank 2-4 Attack

Cost: 7 portions

Range: Self

Health: 2

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A sword of condensed wind protrudes from your hand. At the start of each of your turns while sustained, the sword grows larger and more violent. You can make melee weapon attacks with the sword with a range of 1 meter, and an additional meter of range for every time the sword has grown larger (maximum of 4 meters). On a hit, deal {10, 25, 60} rending damage, and an additional {10, 25, 60} rending damage for every time the sword has grown larger (maximum of {30, 75, 180} bonus damage).

Wisdom Path

Invented millions of years ago by Star Constellation Immortal Venerable, wisdom path is scarce in the modern Gu world. Inheritances are few in number and kept out of reach, for the strength of Wisdom path is to subdue your enemy without them knowing you even made a move.

Armchair General Gu

A winged ant with large mandibles.

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 30 portions

Range: 6 Meters

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you project your plan into the head of a willing creature within range. They gain a bonus to attack rolls made against creatures within your line of sight equal to -(your Cognition attribute). You may also communicate simple ideas nonverbally using Armchair General Gu.

Awake Gu

Rank 1-3 Catalyst

Cost: 6 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 7

Food: Consumes dreams when the owner sleeps

Effect: Awaken a sleeping target. Can be activated as a reaction to you or a creature within range falling to 0 hit points to give them a -{20, 40, 60} bonus to their **Perseverance** attribute test.

Awaken Cloud Gu

Rank 4 Catalyst

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 15

Food: 1 liter of pure water

Keywords: [**Deductive**]

Effect: A cloud of thoughts rumbles above your head, granting you advantage on your next **Deduction** skill test.

Awaken Soul Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 100 g of soul stricken grass (6 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your maximum soul is increased by 4.

Battle Will Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 8

Food: Battle Thoughts (Gu Master must think about fighting for 1 hour)

Effect: All creatures within range, including yourself, become agitated and more prone to violence, and gain a -30 bonus to **Perseverance** attribute tests for 10 minutes.

Blazing Thoughts Gu

Rank 2 Divination

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Deductive**]

Effect: Thoughts of roiling flame appear above your head. As an activation, you can touch a creature to apply the *ablaze* condition and end this effect.

When you use Blazing Thoughts Gu to make a *Deduction* action, you gain a -5 bonus to **Deduction** skill tests and a -10 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests made to create or improve Fire, Light, and Lightning Path Gu recipes.

Blazing thoughts disappear after 1 hour. Activating Blazing Thoughts Gu while you already have blazing thoughts has no effect.

Brain Explosion Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Cost: 55 portions

Range: 10 meters

Health: 12

Food: 1 Human Brain

Effect: Brain Explosion Gu flies towards a creature within range. This can be reacted to and attacked. If Brain Explosion Gu successfully reaches the target, it burrows into their mind and becomes dormant, no longer requiring food to sustain itself. If the creature makes a Cultivation, Deduction, Knowledge, or Refinement test, the Brain Explosion Gu detonates, instantly killing Brain Explosion Gu and the creature. If the creature is forced by some other effect to make one of these tests, they may elect to automatically fumble it and not detonate the Brain Explosion Gu.

Careful Gu

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 7

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: Activate before rolling the failure die of a refinement recipe for a Gu of rank 3 or lower. Increase the die by one stage (d2 -> d4 -> d6 -> d8 -> d10 -> d12 -> d20 -> d100) to a maximum of a d100.

Deep Mind Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [Dao], [Expendable]

Effect: A blinding migraine grips you for 1 hour as your brain physically expands and Wisdom Path Dao is carved directly into your skull and grey matter. You are incapacitated for the duration, and when complete, your Cognition attribute is permanently increased by 10. The first time you fail a Deduction skill test each day, the dao marks correct your train of thought, allowing you to reroll the test.

Detection Gu

Rank 1-5 Divination

Cost: 35 portions

Range: {2, 5, 20, 60, 200} meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Investigative: Detect**]

Effect: You immediately detect the exact location of any Gu within range that are outside of an aperture.

Enamor Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Make an attack roll against a creature within range. On a hit, the creature feels a strong bond of love between themselves and you. The affected creature cannot make any attacks against you, and will try its best to protect you, even risking its own life. If you are being attacked by the creature's allies, the creature will try to protect you without harming either side. At the end of each of its turns, the affected creature can make an **Insight** skill test, ending the effect on a success.

Detective Thoughts Gu

Rank 3-4 Divination

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Deductive**]

Effect: Thoughts like blue and purple question marks float above your head. When you use Detective Thoughts Gu to make a *Deduction* action, you gain a {-20, -40} bonus to **Deduction** skill tests made to determine the perpetrator of a crime.

Freezing Thoughts Gu

Rank 2-4 Divination

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Deductive**]

Effect: Thoughts of freezing clouds appear above your head. As an activation, you may end this effect to freeze your surroundings; all other creatures within {1, 2, 4} meters of you take {8, 20, 50} cold damage. If this damage is dealt to their hit points, they gain the *fatigued* condition

When you use Freezing Thoughts Gu to make a *Deduction* action, you gain a {-5, -10, -15} bonus to **Deduction** skill tests and a {-10, -15, -20} bonus to **Refinement** skill tests made to create or improve Ice, Water, and Wind Path Gu recipes.

Freezing thoughts disappear after 1 hour. Activating Freezing Thoughts Gu while you already have freezing thoughts has no effect.

Give Up Gu

Rank 3 Attack

Cost: 25

Range: 3 meters

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: All creatures within range lose their motivation to go on. They become far more likely to give up on their goals and have a +40 penalty to **Perseverance** attribute tests made within the next hour. Give Up Gu has the most effect on creatures that already have fear or doubts about what they're doing, but creatures will not give up if their life is on the line (unless they were already inclined to do so).

Human Secret Gu

The mortal variant of Heavenly Secret Immortal Gu, Human Secret Gu resembles a roiling purple cloud.

Rank 3-5 Divination

Cost: 40 portions

Range: {1, 5, 20} meters

Health: 1

Food: 10 g of clear minded jade (150 primeval stones)

Effect: You glow with a bright yellow light and read the thoughts of nearby people. If activated during a deduction, your deduction benefits from the combined knowledge of all humans and variant humans within range instead of just information available to you personally. Can also be used outside of deductions to read the thoughts of all humans and variant humans within range until the start of your next turn. While active, you may react to the thoughts of humans and variant humans, including the activation of Gu, even if they are [**Unreactable**]. Additionally, you gain a -50 bonus to all tests made to parry, dodge, or attack humans and variant humans within range.

Kind Thoughts Gu

Rank 2-4 Divination

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Deductive**]

Effect: {1, 2, 5} kind thoughts appear harmoniously above your head. You may expend any number of kind thoughts as an activation to restore 15 hit points for each kind thought expended to yourself or a creature you touch.

When you take the *Deduction* action, you may expend up to {1, 2, 5} kind thoughts to gain a -5 bonus to **Deduction** skill tests for each kind thought expended. Kind thoughts disappear after 1 hour.

Lightning Thoughts Gu

Rank 3-4 Divination

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Deductive**]

Effect: {2, 5} lightning thoughts appear crackling above your head. Whenever a creature you can see activates a Gu with the [**Unreactable**] keyword, you may expend a lightning thought to ignore the [**Unreactable**] keyword for that activation. You may also expend a lightning thought to make a reaction without expending one of your reactions.

When you take the *Deduction* action, you may expend up to {2, 5} lightning thoughts to halve the time required to make the deduction for each lightning thought expended. Lightning thoughts disappear after 1 minute.

Little Will Gu

Rank 1-3 Catalyst

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Self

Health: 6

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords [**Expendable**]

Effect: You take {1, 2, 6} damage to your soul and create {2, 8, 30} Little Wills. Little Wills are linked to you psychically and can help you multitask. When you take the *Activate Gu* combat action, you may consume any number of Little Wills to gain 1 Activation per Little Will consumed in this way.

When you activate or sustain a Gu with the [**Sustained**] keyword, you may expend a Little Will. The Gu will remain sustained until the start of your next turn and does not count towards your current number of sustained Gu.

Little Wills can also be left pretty much anywhere along with a Gu. When a condition, set by you when you leave the Little Will, is fulfilled, the Little Will consumes itself to activate the Gu in a manner of your choosing.

Little Wills can exist for up to 6 months before vanishing.

Longing Thoughts Gu

Rank 1-5 Divination

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Deductive**]

Effect: Your thoughts appear like curling white clouds above your head. When you use Longing Thoughts Gu to make a *Deduction* action, you gain a {-10, -20, -30, -40, -50} bonus to **Deduction** skill tests made to deduce subjects with a physical location that is at least 100 kilometers away from you. You must have seen the location or a detailed image of the location before.

Malicious Thoughts Gu

Rank 1-5 Divination

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Deductive**]

Effect: Maroon thoughts like bubbles with protruding spikes appear above your head. When you use Malicious Thoughts Gu to make a *Deduction* action, you gain a {-10, -20, -30, -40, -50} bonus to **Deduction** skill tests made to deduce plans to foil or sabotage the plans of others.

Martial Art Mantis Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 12 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: 10 g of Purple Autumn Grass (3 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, your unarmed **Close Combat** attack rolls gain a (–5 × your maximum activations) bonus.

Mind Fortress Gu

Rank 1-5 Guard

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: {8, 25, 60, 150, 400}

Food: 5 hours of intense thinking; the thoughts are consumed and cannot be used for deductions.

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, if an effect would manipulate your thoughts, emotions, or will, and originates from a source of rank {1, 2, 3, 4, 5} or lower, it is negated on you. Mind Fortress Gu cannot block any damage. Whenever you take damage to your soul while sustained, you may instead assign that damage to Mind Fortress Gu. Mind Fortress Gu can be activated as a reaction to taking damage to your soul, with the triggering damage being redirected to Mind Fortress Gu.

One Mind Gu

Rank 2-5 Catalyst

Cost: 10X portions

Range: Self

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: You gain X activations until the end of your turn. Once you use an activation before the end of your turn, your subsequent activations must be used for the same effect,

i.e. activating the same Gu. If your next activation is used on a Gu of a higher rank than One Mind Gu, One Mind Gu has no effect.

Future Market Gu

A primeval stone with a sea-green hue.

Rank 4 Divination

Cost: 25 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: Rank 4 Year Gu

Keywords: [**Extinct**]

Effect: You touch an object, Gu, or creature and can immediately ascertain the future supply and demand of it across the continent you are in a week from today. The supply appears as a blue pillar of light, and the demand as a red pillar of light, brighter and taller the greater each is. Using both metrics you can ascertain what the market price of the item will be a week from today.

Placebo Gu

Rank 1 Tonic

Cost: 5 portions

Range: 4 meters

Health: 8

Food: 100 g of sugar

Effect: A creature of your choice within range regains 2 hit points.

Sensitivity Gu

Rank 3 Divination

Cost: 35 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Deductive**]

Effect: Your emotional intelligence is vastly improved for an hour. You gain a -30 bonus to all **Insight** skill tests. If you take the **Deduction** action using Sensitivity Gu, you gain a -20 bonus to **Deduction** skill tests made to deduce the motivations of a creature.

Shared Sense Gu

Rank 3 Divination

Cost: 90 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You touch a creature and implant Shared Sense Gu on their body. This process is painless and impossible to feel, and Shared Sense Gu is undetectable by Gu of rank 3 or below. While implanted, you may use your combat action to close your eyes and connect with Shared Sense Gu, immediately learning the exact location of the target and switching from using your senses to theirs. You can see, smell, hear, feel, and taste whatever the target is while sharing their senses, and can end the effect at any time.

Sharp Intent Gu

Rank 3-4 Manifestation

Cost: 20 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 10

Food: {3, 15} blades of Cutting-Edge Grass ({90, 450} primeval stones)

Effect: You condense your will into swords, taking {3, 10} damage to your soul and manifesting {1, 5} Intent Blades. As an Activation, you can make an attack roll against a target within range with an Intent Blade, dealing {35, 100} rending damage on a hit. Each Intent Blade can only be used for one attack every turn. They may also be wielded as a melee weapon with a range of 1 meter, dealing {35, 100} rending damage on a successful melee attack. Intent Blades vanish after 1 minute.

Whenever you make an attack roll from a Gu effect, you may consume an Intent Blade to gain a -30 bonus to that attack roll.

The main recipe for Rank 3 Sharp Intent Gu combines Rank 2 Sabre Gu with many Rank 1 Little Will Gu

Space Thoughts Gu

Rank 1-5 Catalyst

Cost: 30 portions

Range: Self

Health: 12

Food: {1, 4, 9, 16, 25} kilograms of phantom soil

Keywords: [**Deductive**]

Effect: Your thoughts appear as pitch black bubbles above your head. If you use Space Thoughts Gu to deduce or improve a refinement recipe, you gain a {-10, -20, -30, -40, -50} bonus on the test if you own the Gu whose recipe you are deducing or improving. The Gu must also be of the appropriate rank; you do not gain the bonus if you are deducing a rank 3 recipe but only own the rank 2 version of the Gu.

If the recipe belongs to Space Path, you gain the bonus whether or not you own the Gu.

Thinking Twice Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You gain a -20 bonus on your next **Deduction** or **Knowledge** skill test if it is your second time attempting it.

Third Eye Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 60 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**], [**Investigative: Sight**]

Effect: A vertical **Eye** is permanently opened on your forehead, allowing you to see through it at all times, even when you're asleep.

Truthful Bone Gu

Rank 2 Divination

Cost: None

Range: 2 meters

Health: 4

Food: Honest statements

Effect: If a lie is told within range of Truthful Bone Gu, it detonates and dies. Truthful Bone Gu cannot hear lies from inside of an aperture. Activating Truthful Bone Gu has no effect.

{Two, Three, Four, Five} Tasks at Once Gu

Rank 2-5 Catalyst

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 10

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained you can sustain an additional number of Gu every turn equal to your activations multiplied by {1, 2, 3, 4} without incurring damage to your soul. Additionally, whenever you take damage to your soul due to giving orders to hordes, roll {1d10, 1d8, 1d6, 1d4} instead of 1d12.

Vajra Arms Gu

Rank 2 Manifestation

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 11

Food: 1 hour of thoughts related to punching or souls.

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you have an additional two arms sprouting from your waist. They are a spectral blue color, and punching attacks made with them deal an additional 2 damage to the target's soul.

Vajra Thoughts Gu

Rank 1-5 Divination

Cost: 12 portions

Range: 25 meters

Health: 8

Food: {1, 4, 9, 16, 25} liters of Monkey Leaf Tea

Keywords: [**Deductive**]

Effect: Manifest {3, 6, 20, 50, 100} Vajra Thoughts. Vajra Thoughts appear as shining golden spheres, and can be manifested inside your mind or outside your body. Any number of Vajra thoughts can be transferred between your mind and outside your body as a bonus action.

When making the *Deduction* action, you may consume a number of Vajra thoughts up to your Cognition attribute to gain a bonus equal to -(Vajra thoughts consumed) on **Deduction** skill tests made to deduce killer moves. The thoughts consumed must be inside your mind.

As an Activation, you can shoot a Vajra thought at any target within range. You may only shoot Vajra thoughts that exist outside your body in this way. Make an attack roll; on a hit, each Vajra thought deals 2 force damage directly to the targets hit points.

Vajra thoughts vanish after 1 hour.

Warrior's Intuition Gu

A soldier ant with an a bulbous head and ridged thorax.

Rank 1 Catalyst

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: After hitting a creature with an attack, you may activate Warrior's Intuition Gu without using an Activation. You gain a -10 bonus to the first skill test made as part of a reaction against that creature before the start of your next turn.

Wood Path

Wood Path was discovered by Genesis Lotus Immortal Venerable. It generally encompasses methods involving plants, and excels at support and healing, having marginal defense and lower attack power than other paths.

Bark Skin Gu

Rank 1 Guard

Cost: 4 portions

Range: Self

Health: 15

Food: 5 kg of bark

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: While sustained, you skin grows a thick bark as strong as stone. When you take rending or force damage to your hit points, reduce the amount of damage taken by 3, to a minimum of 0. Additionally, reduce any amount of damage taken from the *bleeding* condition by 1, to a minimum of 0. You have vulnerability to heat damage.

Become Tree Gu

A really convincing stick bug. Awareness tests made to discover it is not a stick are made with a +50 penalty

Rank 3 Concealment

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: A sapling

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Transformation**]

Effect: You transform into a tree of your height, granting you the following features:

Your maximum hit points are 25, and your base movement is 0 meters.

You are not affected by any [**Dao**] Gu applied to specific body parts.

You gain the *blinded* and *deafened* conditions.

You gain resistance to cold, force, rending, shock, and sonic damage.

As a bonus action, you may transform back into your original form and end this effect.

Blood Root Armor Gu

Rank 3 Guard

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 270

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Defensive**], [**Shield**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Your body is covered in wooden armor, and roots sprout from it into your blood vessels. While sustained, if you gain the *poisoned* condition from a Gu of rank 4 or lower, immmediately remove it and Blood Root Armor Gu regains hit points equal to the rank of the Gu applying the condition times 10. Blood Root Armor Gu cannot block heat or sonic damage.

Bone Bamboo Gu

Rank 1 Manifestation

Cost: 4 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A strong stalk of bamboo with a dense bone inside grows from the ground that you touch. The bamboo stalk is 1.5 meters long and can be wielded as a staff with a range of 2 meters and a base damage of 10 force damage.

Branching Wings Gu

Rank 2 Manifestation

Cost: 75 portions

Range: Self

Health: 9

Food: 10 portions of rank 2 primeval essence

Effect: 4 huge wooden wings sprout from your back. They each have 25 hit points and vulnerability to rending damage. You gain a flying speed equal to 2 times the number of wooden wings you have and can execute 2 Maneuvers each turn. As a bonus action or activation, you can quickly sprout a branch from one at a creature within 3 meters. If the creature is unwilling, make an attack roll. On a hit, the branch fuses with their spine or sternum, and you carry the creature with you while flying. Creature's attached to your wings this way have a +30 penalty to all attack rolls and are *restrained*.

Branching Wings Gu can carry 1 [**Medium**] or smaller creatures on each wing. If a wing is destroyed, it falls off your back and any creature attached to it is freed.

Creatures have to be cut off their branch as a combat action to be freed (or it can be destroyed as part of an attack, with 1 hit point). This leaves a wooden cap attached to the body that can be safely cut away over the course of an hour.

[**Upgrade Path: Burning Canopy Blessing Gu**]

Photosynthesis Gu

Rank 2 Tonic

Next Rank: Clorophyl Armor Gu

Cost: 14 portions

Range: Self

Health: 12

Food: Direct sunlight for 1 hour

Effect: Can only be activated while in direct sunlight. At the end of each of your turns, you regain 12 hit points. This effect ends if you take damage to your hit points or leave direct sunlight. Photosynthesizing for 1 hour a day replaces your need to eat.

Clorophyl Armor Gu

Rank 3 Tonic

Previous Rank: Photosynthesis Gu

Next Rank: Phoenix Mantle Gu

Cost: 6 portions

Range: Self

Health: 14

Food: Direct sunlight for 8 hours

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A scaly green armor covers your body. While sustained, you regain 15 hit points at the end of each of your turns as long as you're in direct sunlight. Force and rending damage are dealt to the armor instead of your hit points. The armor has 80 hit points, and once it is broken, the effect ends.

Phoenix Mantle Gu

Rank 4 Tonic

Previous Rank: Clorophyl Armor Gu

Next Rank: Burning Canopy Blessing Gu

Cost: 8 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: 10 g of Imperial Phoenix feathers (1,500 primeval stones)

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A shawl of light wraps around your head, shedding sunlight in a 30 foot radius. While sustained, if your hit points would be reduced to 0, instead the shawl bursts into flames and your hit points are restored to their maximum. Phoenix Mantle Gu takes 1d4 damage and cannot be activated again for 24 hours.

Burning Canopy Blessing Gu

Rank 5 Tonic

Previous Rank: Phoenix Mantle Gu

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 18

Food: Direct sunlight for 6 months

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: A miniature sun manifests 5 meters above your head, illuminating a 250 kilometer sphere around it. The light does not pierce objects, but it is extremely bright. All creatures within 10 meters of the sun are *blinded*. All creatures within 1 kilometer of the sun are *blinded* while it is within their line of sight.

While sustained, you return to your maximum hit points, heal all diseases, and regenerate all missing body parts at the end of each of your turns. You are also invulnerable to rending and force damage.

[**END**]

Cactus Pointer Gu

Rank 3 Divination

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: You pluck the flower atop Cactus Pointer Gu. Cactus Pointer Gu withers and dies, and a word appears on the plucked flower. The word is chosen by the Gamemaster, and will be related to your current goal, pointing you in the right direction. It can be a name, object, or place, but must be a single word, or a single name if the name is more than one word.

Chloroplast Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Skin** is permanently carved with Wood Path dao, taking on a permanent green tint and becoming capable of photosynthesis. As long as you spend at least 4 hours in direct sunlight each day, you do not need to eat. While in sunlight, you regain 1 hit point at the start of each of your turns. If you are standing in light produced by a Gu, you regain hit points at the start of each of your turns equal to the rank of the Gu.

Creamy Sap Gu

Rank 1 Tonic

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 8

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A creamy orange sap is secreted by your fingertips. You can rub it into a creature's wounds as a bonus action. Doing so heals them 6 hit points and removes the *bleeding* condition.

Dark Moss Gu

Rank 1 Concealment

Cost: 4 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 6

Food: 5 kg of moss

Effect: You or a creature you touch sprout a thick moss for 1 hour that blends in with forestry. While in a wooded or grassy area, they are invisible.

Earth Communication Ear Grass Gu

A large ear with roots growing from the eardrum. After a Gu Master replaces one of their ears with it, Earth Communication Ear Grass Gu slowly shrinks to fit their face and become more unassuming.

Rank 1 Divination

Cost: 2 portions

Range: 20 meters

Health: 8

Food: 1 kilogram of grass and 1 kilogram of soil

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Investigative: Hearing**], [**Sustained**]

Effect: Before being activated, the user of Earth Communication Ear Grass Gu must cut off one of their **Ears** and allow Earth Communication Ear Grass Gu to take its place. While sustained, roots extend from the replaced ear and allow you to hear all noises, big or small, made within range. If you put the ear to the ground, the roots connect to it and extend the range to 100 meters, but you can only hear things on top of or in the earth.

Flowerbud Gu

Rank 2 Container

Cost: None

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: Sunlight

Effect: You may take or stow an object in Flowerbud Gu at will. Flowerbud Gu can hold up to 100 kilograms of items, but each item can be no larger than 30 cubic centimeters in volume.

Fragrant Daisy Gu

Rank 3 Concealment

Cost: 10 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A large daisy grows out of a chunk of soil or stone that you touch, emitting a powerful fragrance in a 1 kilometer radius centered on the daisy. All **Awareness** skill tests or Gu effects that rely on smelling automatically fail if used within the area. Nothing inside the area can be located by scent either, except for the daisy emitting the fragrance. The daisy has 20 hit points and vulnerability to heat damage; if it is killed or uprooted the effect ends. The fragrance does not cling to creatures that leave the area.

Growing Power Gu

A huge green striped brown grub.

Rank 3 Catalyst

Cost: 5 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: 5 kg of seeds

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: When you activate Growing Power Gu and at the start of each of your turns while sustained, you gain 2 Fortitude, 20 Strength, and heal 2 hit points. At the end of each of your turns while sustained, your movement is reduced by 1. Growing Power Gu can increase your Fortitude and Strength and decrease your movement up to 10 times, at which point sustaining Growing Power Gu only serves to extend the duration.

Healing Sprout Gu

Rank 1 Tonic

Cost: 7 portions

Range: Self

Health: 7

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Healing Sprout Gu sprouts a healing leaf. The leaf can be plucked from Healing Sprout Gu and never expires. A creature can eat a healing leaf as a bonus action to regain 4 hit points.

Heavenly Essence Treasure Lotus Gu

To refine the Heavenly Essence Treasure Lotus Gu, a Gu Master must use 3 fresh spirit springs as refinement materials. Spirit springs produce vast amounts of primeval stones, so few are willing to make that sacrifice.

Rank 3 Manifestation

Cost: None

Range: Self

Health: 4

Food: Natural primeval essence (none)

Effect: Cannot be activated. Passively sprouts 50 primeval essence stones every day at midnight. Up to 50 primeval stones can remain attached to Heavenly Essence Treasure Lotus Gu at a time.

Paper Tiger Gu

Rank 2 Concealment

Cost: None

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: 1 kg wood pulp (1/4 primeval stone)

Keywords: [**Sustained**]

Effect: As long as you are rank 2, the aura of your primeval essence is increased to rank 3 and a stage of your choice while sustained. Your primeval essence's outward appearance remains as it was, however, so effects that glimpse inside your aperture will see your true cultivation. Sustaining Paper Tiger Gu does not count towards your number of currently sustained Gu.

Primeval Roots Gu

Rank 2 Carver

Cost: 40 portions

Range: Self

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: Your **Feet** are permanently carved with Wood Path dao, sprouting tiny organic tendrils. As a bonus action, you can root yourself into natural soil or stone. While rooted, you cannot be moved by force and you regain a number of portions of primeval essence each hour dependent on your rank:

Your Rank	PE/Hour
1	40
2	10
3	3
4	1
5	1

Primeval Tree Heart Gu

Rank 1-5 Catalyst

Cost: None

Range: Self

Health: 7

Food: Natural primeval essence (none)

Keywords: [**Expendable**]

Effect: You immediately regain 50 primeval essence. This essence is of the same rank as Primeval Tree Heart Gu; if

that rank is below your own, you instead gain only 1 primeval essence. If that rank is above your own, multiply the amount of primeval essence gained by 4 for each rank above your own.

Problem Nipped in the Bud Gu

Rank 4 Attack

Cost: 20 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 4

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: You touch a Gu Master with the *restrained* condition between their eyes, and Problem Nipped in the Bud Gu attaches to their head. At the end of each of your turns, a random Gu is extracted from their aperture and the will inside is obliterated, turning the Gu wild. If the target loses the *restrained* condition, Problem Nipped in the Bud Gu deactivates.

Regrowth Gu

Rank 1 Tonic

Cost: 35 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 3

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Touch a creature within range. That creature regrows a single severed limb instantaneously.

Resurgence Gu

Rank 2 Tonic

Previous Rank: Silver Lining Gu

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Can only be activated as a reaction to getting hit by an attack or missing an attack against another creature. You and any number of creatures of your choice within range regain 15 hit points.

Rot Gu

Rank 2 Catalyst

Cost: 10 portions

Range: 3 meters

Health: 22

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Target a corpse or undead creature within range. If it is a corpse, it quickly spoils and rots before the skin and flesh sloughs off the bones and the skeleton disintegrates. If an undead creature is targeted, it rots at a slower rate, and takes 1/3 of its maximum hit points (rounded up) in force damage directly to its hit points. While sustained, the target takes another 1/3 of its maximum hit points (rounded up) at the start of your turn.

Sapping Toxin Gu

Rank 1-3 Tonic

Cost: 8 portions

Range: Touch

Health: 6

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A creature you touch has a single instance of the *poisoned* condition removed as long as it was applied by a Gu of rank {1, 2, 3} or lower.

Scarecrow Gu

Rank 1 Manifestation

Cost: 15 portions

Range: 1 meter

Health: 12

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: A 1 meter tall scarecrow manifests in an unoccupied square adjacent to you. The scarecrow has 50 hit points and regains 10 hit points at the start of each of your turns. Hiding behind it counts as partial cover.

If within a 2x2 area there are 3 or more scarecrows, hiding behind them instead counts as full cover.

Stranglewood Gu

Rank 2 Attack

Cost: 14 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 14

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Select a 2 meter radius circle within range. Roots and vines burst forth from the ground, and creatures in the area must succeed an **Athletics** skill test with a +20 penalty

or else be *restrained* for 1 minute. A *restrained* creature can remake the test as a combat action on its turn to free itself.

Thorn Burst Gu

Rank 1 Attack

Cost: 25 portions

Range: 5 meters

Health: 28

Food: 500 g of roses

Effect: A cloud of thorns bursts from your outstretched hand in a 3 meter wide, 5 meter long line. Creatures in the area take 6 force damage.

[**Upgrade Path: Three Star Cave Gu**]

This Gu appears to be an acorn of brown color at rank 1, getting darker as it is upgraded. Rank 3 Three Star Cave Gu is pitch black.

One Star Cave Gu

Rank 1 Container

Cost: 50 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: One Star Cave Gu must be planted in any kind of soil to be activated. A 3 meter radius tree containing a single room is manifested above One Star Cave Gu. It has a door on one side of your choice. The owner of One Star Cave Gu can touch any part of the tree and spend 1 portion of primeval essence as an activation to instantly revert One Star Cave Gu back to its original form.

The tree has 50 hit points and vulnerability to heat and rending damage. If the tree is reduced to 0 hit points, this effect ends.

Two Star Cave Gu

Rank 2 Container

Cost: 50 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Two Star Cave Gu must be planted in any kind of soil to be activated. A two-story tall, 3 meter radius tree is manifested above Two Star Cave Gu. It has a door on one side of your choice and a ladder leading to the second floor. Each floor has a single room, furnished in a manner of your choice. Two Star Cave Gu can only manifest basic wooden furniture such as tables, chairs, and cabinets. The owner of Two Star Cave Gu can touch any part of the tree and spend 1 portion of primeval essence as an activation to instantly revert One Star Cave Gu back to its original form.

The tree has 250 hit points and vulnerability to heat and rending damage. If the tree is reduced to 0 hit points, this effect ends.

Three Star Cave Gu

Rank 3 Container

Cost: 50 portions

Range: Self

Health: 5

Food: <!– TODO ->

Effect: Three Star Cave Gu must be planted in any kind of soil to be activated. A three-story tall, 5 meter radius tree is manifested above Three Star Cave Gu. It has a door on one side and a staircase leading to the second and third floors. Each floor has a single room, furnished in a manner of your choice. Three Star Cave Gu can manifest wood, cloth, and stone furniture such as counters, chairs, and beds. The owner of Three Star Cave Gu can touch any part of the tree and spend 1 portion of primeval essence as an activation to instantly revert One Star Cave Gu back to its original form.

The tree has 1000 hit points and vulnerability to heat and rending damage. If the tree is reduced to 0 hit points, this effect ends.

[**END**]

Wardrobe Gu

Rank 2 Container

Cost: 1 portion

Range: Self

Health: 25

Food: 1 kg of silk (5 primeval stones)

Effect: Wardrobe Gu can store up to 50 kg of clothes and armor. Upon activation, a set of clothes stored inside Wardrobe Gu of your choice replaces whatever you are wearing, while the clothes you were wearing are stored within Wardrobe Gu. If you do not choose an outfit, you merely store the clothes you are wearing.

Wine Sack Flower Gu

Rank 1 Manifestation

Cost: 15 portions

Range: Self

Health: 9

Food: 1 kg rice (1/4 primeval stone)

Effect: Wine Sack Flower Gu blooms, forming a bowl made of petals containing 3 kg of rice wine.

Wood Charm Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 2 portions

Range: Self

Health: 8

Food: Natural primeval essence (none)

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Sustained**], [**Transformation**]

Effect: While sustained, you transform into a tree spirit and gain the ability to absorb primeval essence from the surroundings.

You have 300 hit points.

You are [Large].

You are not affected by any [**Dao**] Gu applied to your **Blood**, **Circulatory System**, **Heart**, or **Skin**.

If you take heat damage, you gain the *burning* condition.

You reduce all rending and force damage dealt to your hit points by 10.

At the end of each of your turns, you and any creatures in a square adjacent to you regain 10 portions of primeval essence.

At the start of each of your turns, make a **Perseverance** attribute test with a +10 penalty. On a failure, you gain a **Wood Charm Token** and your body becomes slightly more tree-like. If you ever have 10 **Wood Charm Tokens**, your body is permanently transfigured into a small tree and you die.

As long as you have 9 or fewer **Wood Charm Tokens**, every month you go without activating Wood Charm Gu reduces the number of **Wood Charm Tokens** you have by 1.

Wood Origin Gu

Rank 3 Carver

Cost: 50 portions

Range: Self

Health: 15

Food: <!– TODO ->

Keywords: [**Dao**], [**Expendable**]

Effect: You carve Wood Path dao into your **Torso**, gaining a **Wood Dao Token**. For every **Wood Dao Token** you have, you gain a -5 bonus to **Refinement** skill tests made to follow, create, or improve wood path Gu recipes and reduce the amount of primeval essence used to activate Wood Path Gu by 1 portion (to a minimum of 1). Additionally, each **Wood Dao Token** you have reduces your base movement by 1 as your skin and flesh hardens into bark and wood. You cannot have more than 5 **Wood Dao Tokens**.

Cheat Sheet

- **Skill Test:** Roll d100
  - 99 or 100 = Fumble (auto-fail).
  - <= 1/10 of skill value = Critical (auto-success).
  - Degrees of success/failure: Every 10 above/below skill value.
- **Penalties/Bonuses:** Add/subtract from roll.
  - +80: Nearly Impossible, 0: Challenging, -60: Trivial.
- **Advantage:** Roll extra td10, take lower tens. Stackable from different sources.

Opposed Tests

- Both roll skill test; compare degrees of success/failure.
- Critical beats non-critical; fumble loses to non-fumble.
- Tie: Lower roll wins; if still tied, reroll.

Combat

- **Initiative:** Roll Close Combat (if enemy <= 3m) or Ranged Attack. Most degrees of success acts first. In the case of ties, the lower number on the die goes first.
- **Turn:** 10 seconds.
  - Actions: 1 Combat Action, 2 Reactions, 1 Bonus Action, Movement.
- **Movement:** Move meters = movement stat. Jumping costs half movement.
- **Flying:** Use Flying skill for maneuvers (Take Flight, Fly, Dive, Evade, Land).
- **Melee Attack:** Roll Close Combat vs enemy in range. Damage = weapon + 1 per 10 Strength.
- **Grapple:** Opposed Athletics. Restrained if you win.
- **Absorb Primeval Stones:** 5 essence per stone, 1 stone per free hand.
- **Hold Action:** Specify action & trigger; use reaction when triggered.
- **Sprint:** Triple movement for turn.

Reactions

- **Activate Shield Gu:** As reaction to being hit, before damage.
- **Dodge:** Dodge test; When you succeed a Dodge test, you MUST move at least 1 meter and at most 1/2 your movement (rounded down) in any direction. If you are unable to move, you are also unable to take the dodge reaction. If 1/2 of your movement is insufficient to escape an area of effect attack, you are struck by the attack regardless.
- **Parry:** Opposed Close Combat (+10 penalty); counterattack if successful.
- **Detonate Gu:** Instantly destroy any owned/refined Gu.
- **Trigger Held Action:** Use held action when trigger occurs.
- **Attack of Opportunity:** Attack creature leaving melee range with melee attack.

Damage & Status

- **Damage Types:** Force, Rending, Cold, Heat, Poison, Shock, Sonic, Direct.
- **Bleeding X:** X direct HP loss per stack at start of turn.
- **Burning:** 4 direct heat damage per turn. Remove by water or rolling as a combat action.
- **Ablaze:** 15 direct heat damage per turn. **Perseverence** test at the end of each turn they take damage or fall unconscious. Remove by being submerged.
- **Dazed:** 2 fewer activations per turn. Removed at the end of your turn.
- **Restrained:** Movement 0, auto-fail Dodge/Flying.
- **Stunned:** No actions or reactions. Is removed at the end of your turn and replaced with *dazed*
- **Prone:** +30 penalty to all skill tests. **Close Combat** tests made to hit a *prone* creature gain a -10 bonus. **Ranged Attack** tests made to hit a *prone* creature gain a +10 penalty. Expend half movement to stand up.
- **Poisoned:** Poison can have any number of effects, and a creature can gain multiple instances of the *poisoned* condition so long as each is unique.
- **Final Stand:** Can only activate Gu or hold action. Any damage = Dying.
- **Dying:** Unconscious. Perseverance test each turn; 3 Perseverance Tokens (successes) = Final Stand, 3 Predicament Tokens (fails) = Death.
- **Instant Death:** Damage >= 2× max HP from one source.

Cultivation & Progression

- **Small Realm:** Spend primeval essence to reduce aperture wall health.
- **Large Realm:** Walls regenerate over time. Compare wall recovery to your primeval essence recovery; must be positive to break through.
- **Cultivation Test:** Roll once per hour with {-50, -40, -20, -10, 0} bonus; fail = soul damage equal to degrees of failure (min 1).

Gu Basics

- **Rank:** 1–5 (higher = rarer, stronger).
- **Activation Cost:** If Gu rank > user, cost ×4 per rank above. If Gu rank < user, cost = 1.
- **Feeding Threshold:** {3 days, 7 days, 30 days, 250 days, 10 years}
- **Refinement:** Roll Refinement test (penalty/bonus by recipe). On success: Roll failure die (1 = fail). On failure: Soul and Gu damaged by (degrees of failure * rank).
- **Vital Gu:** First refined Gu; if it dies, you die. Cannot die from refinement backlash.

Gu Keywords

- **Deductive:** Unlocks Deduction action.
- **Dao:** User cannot be affected by [**Dao**] Gu of different paths at same time.
- **Defensive:** Can activate as a reaction.
- **Expendable X:** Destroyed after X uses (usually 1).
- **Low Vitality:** Does not heal when fed.
- **Piercing:** Ignores non-dao barriers.
- **Shield:** Absorbs damage meant to hit the user.
- **Size:** Tiny (Insect), Small (child), Medium (adult), Large (bear), Huge (elephant+).
- **Steed:** Can be ridden.
- **Supplementary:** Alters subsequent activations.
- **Sustained:** Pay cost each turn; soul damage if # sustained > Activations.
- **Unreactable:** Reactions delayed until after effect.
- **Vital:** If it dies, the owner dies.